THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

Revision Notes

English Grammar Workbook · Part 1

Classes 5 to 8 — Complete Grammar with Exercises and Answer Key · CBSE / RBSE

HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

Each chapter follows the textbook's own order of sections, so you can read straight through. Bold words are keywords you must be able to define. Tables compare and classify; shaded boxes hold definitions, formulas and key facts. The navy Key Takeaways box at the end of every chapter is your last-two-minutes revision.

CH.	CHAPTER TITLE	CORE THEME
1	Parts of Speech	
2	Nouns	
3	Pronouns	
4	Determiners	
5	Adjectives and Degrees of Comparison	
6	Adverbs	
7	Verbs	
8	Tenses	
9	Subject-Verb Agreement	
10	Modals: Can, May, Must, Should and Their Friends	
11	Non-finites: Infinitive, Gerund and Participle	Infinitives, gerunds and participles
12	Prepositions: Linking Words that Show Relationship	Prepositions of place, time, direction, agent; dependent prepositions
13	Conjunctions and Connectors	Joining words and linkers for contrast, reason, result, condition, time, addition
14	Relatives: Who, Whom, Whose, Which, That, Where	Relative pronouns and adverbs; defining and non-defining clauses

CH.	CHAPTER TITLE	CORE THEME
15	Conditionals: If Sentences and Their Cousins	Zero, first, second, third and mixed conditionals; unless, wish, as if
16	Active and Passive Voice	Active and passive voice across all tenses; special structures
17	Reported Speech (Direct and Indirect)	Direct to indirect speech: statements, questions, commands, exclamations
18	Sentences, Phrases, Clauses and Punctuation	Sentence types, phrases and clauses, transformation, word order, punctuation
19	Vocabulary and Word Usage	Synonyms, antonyms, one-word substitutes, idioms, homophones, word formation, phrasal verbs
20	Topic-wise Practice (Classes 5–8)	
21	Exam-pattern Question Types (Classes 5–8)	
22	Mixed Practice Tests	
23	Complete Answer Key	

CHAPTER 01 · FOUNDATIONS · CLASSES 5–8

Parts of Speech

Every word in a sentence does a job. Words are sorted into eight groups, called parts of speech, according to the job they do. A word can change its part of speech when its job changes: light is a noun in 'switch on the light', an adjective in 'a light bag' and a verb in 'light the lamp'. Always ask: ***what is this word doing here?***

1.1 The Eight Parts of Speech at a Glance

NOTE

Grade guide: Classes 5–6 learn the eight parts with simple examples. Classes 7–8 must also identify a word's part of speech from its use in the sentence, and know the interjection and the finer kinds.

Part of speech	Job it does	Examples
Noun	Names a person, place, animal, thing, idea or feeling	Meena, Jaipur, tiger, table, honesty, joy
Pronoun	Takes the place of a noun	he, she, it, they, who, myself
Adjective	Describes or limits a noun or pronoun	tall boy, three pens, this book
Verb	Shows an action, a state or being	run, think, is, seem
Adverb	Tells more about a verb, adjective or another adverb	quickly, very, always, here
Preposition	Shows the relation of a noun/pronoun to another word	in, on, under, between, after
Conjunction	Joins words, phrases or clauses	and, but, because, although
Interjection	Expresses a sudden feeling	Oh! Hurrah! Alas! Wow!

1.2 Noun

A **noun** is a word that names a person, place, animal, thing, quality, idea or feeling. Nouns are the 'naming words' of a sentence and usually act as subject or object.

- Person: *teacher, Rahul, doctor*
- Place: *school, Delhi, market*
- Animal: *elephant, parrot*
- Thing: *pencil, mountain, river*
- Quality / idea / feeling: *bravery, freedom, anger, childhood*

Nouns are divided into proper, common, collective, material and abstract nouns (see Chapter 2).

1.3 Pronoun

A **pronoun** stands in place of a noun so that we need not repeat the noun again and again. Compare: *Ravi lost Ravi's bag, so Ravi asked Ravi's friend to help Ravi.* with *Ravi lost his bag, so he asked his friend to help him.*

Pronouns are personal (*I, you, he*), reflexive (*myself*), demonstrative (*this, those*), interrogative (*who, what*), relative (*who, which, that*), indefinite (*someone, none*), distributive (*each, either*) and reciprocal (*each other*). Details in Chapter 3.

1.4 Adjective

An **adjective** describes or limits a noun or pronoun. It answers: *What kind? How many? How much? Which one?*

Kind	Question it answers	Example
Quality	What kind?	a **brave** soldier, **cold** water
Quantity	How much?	**much** time, **enough** food
Number	How many?	**five** books, **several** birds
Demonstrative	Which one?	**this** pen, **those** boys
Possessive	Whose?	**my** bag, **their** house
Interrogative	Which / what / whose?	**Which** road? **Whose** coat?

Position: usually before the noun (*a red rose*), or after a linking verb (*The rose is red*). Full treatment in Chapter 5.

1.5 Verb

A **verb** is a word that shows an action (*write, jump*), a state (*know, belong*) or being (*is, are, was*). Every complete sentence has at least one verb.

- Action verbs: *The girl **sings** well.*
- State verbs: *I **know** the answer.*
- Linking verbs: *The soup **tastes** good.*
- Helping verbs: *She **has** finished. They **will** come.*

Verbs change form to show tense, number and person (Chapters 7–9).

1.6 Adverb

An **adverb** tells more about a verb, an adjective or another adverb. It answers *How? When? Where? How often? How much?*

- Verb: *She walked **slowly**.*
- Adjective: *a **very** tall tree*
- Adverb: *He ran **quite** fast.*

Many adverbs end in **-ly** (*quickly, softly*) but not all (*fast, well, soon, often*), and not every -ly word is an adverb (*friendly, lovely, lonely* are adjectives).

1.7 Preposition

A **preposition** is placed before a noun or pronoun (its object) to show its relation to another word in the sentence: place, time, direction, cause, means. *The book is **on** the table. We left **after** lunch. She is fond **of** music.*

> **IMPORTANT**
> A pronoun after a preposition must be in the object form: *between you and **me*** (not *between you and I*); *for **him**, with **us***.

1.8 Conjunction

A **conjunction** joins words, phrases or clauses.

Kind	Job	Examples
Coordinating	Joins equal parts	and, but, or, so, yet, for, nor
Subordinating	Joins a dependent clause to a main clause	because, although, if, when, while, since, unless, that
Correlative	Works in pairs	either…or, neither…nor, both…and, not only…but also

Examples: *Tea **or** coffee? I stayed home **because** it was raining. **Although** he was tired, he finished the work.*

1.9 Interjection

An **interjection** is a word or short phrase that bursts out of strong feeling. It is not grammatically linked to the rest of the sentence and is followed by an exclamation mark (or a comma when the feeling is mild).

Feeling	Interjections
Joy	Hurrah! Wow! Yippee!
Sorrow	Alas! Oh dear!
Surprise	Oh! Ha! What!
Approval	Bravo! Well done!
Pain	Ouch! Ah!
Greeting / attention	Hello! Hey! Hush!

Hurrah! We have won the match. Alas! The old tree has fallen.

1.10 How to Identify the Part of Speech

Step 1 — Find the verb
Look for the action or being word. Everything else is organised around it.

Step 2 — Find the doer and receiver
The naming words that do or receive the action are nouns or pronouns.

Step 3 — Ask questions of the other words
Does it tell *what kind/how many*? Adjective. *How/when/where*? Adverb. Does it link a noun to another word? Preposition. Does it join clauses? Conjunction.

Step 4 — Test by substitution
Can you replace it with 'he/it/they'? Then it is a noun group. Can you put 'very' before it? Then it is an adjective or adverb.

IMPORTANT

Common mistakes: (1) *friendly, lovely, silly* look like adverbs but are adjectives. (2) Words after linking verbs (*seems, looks, feels, becomes*) are adjectives, not adverbs: *She looks **happy**.* (3) 'Good' is an adjective, 'well' is usually an adverb: *He sings **well**.*

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- There are eight parts of speech: noun, pronoun, adjective, verb, adverb, preposition, conjunction, interjection.
- The job of a word in the sentence decides its part of speech.
- Adjectives describe nouns; adverbs describe verbs, adjectives and adverbs.
- Prepositions need an object; conjunctions join; interjections stand apart with an exclamation mark.
- After linking verbs use adjectives, not adverbs.

Nouns

A noun is the word we use to name anything we can see, touch, think of or feel. This chapter covers kinds of nouns, countable and uncountable nouns, number (plural rules, including irregular plurals), gender, case (especially the possessive) and collective nouns with their group names.

2.1 Kinds of Nouns

NOTE

Grade guide: Classes 5–6: proper, common, collective, material, abstract; singular/plural; masculine/feminine. Classes 7–8: countable/uncountable, case, possessive rules, nouns that change meaning, compound nouns, noun-forming suffixes.

Kind	Meaning	Examples
Proper noun	Particular name of a person, place or thing; begins with a capital letter	Gandhi, Rajasthan, Ganga, Diwali, Monday
Common noun	Name shared by all persons/things of one class	boy, city, river, festival
Collective noun	Name of a group taken as one whole	team, crowd, flock, bunch
Material noun	Name of the substance something is made of	gold, wood, milk, cotton, iron
Abstract noun	Name of a quality, state, action or idea; cannot be touched	courage, poverty, childhood, laughter

▸ Forming abstract nouns

From	Abstract noun	Examples
Adjective	-ness, -ty, -th, -dom, -ce, -cy	kind → kindness, brave → bravery, wise → wisdom, long → length, strong → strength, free → freedom, patient → patience, brief → brevity
Verb	-tion, -ment, -al, -ure, -ance	act → action, move → movement, arrive → arrival, fail → failure, enter → entrance
Common noun	-hood, -ship, -dom	child → childhood, friend → friendship, king → kingdom

2.2 Countable and Uncountable Nouns

Countable nouns can be counted (*one book, two books*), so they have singular and plural forms. **Uncountable nouns** (mass nouns) cannot be counted one by one; they have no plural and take a singular verb.

Countable	Uncountable
a pen, three pens	ink, water, rice, sugar, sand
an apple, many apples	advice, information, news, furniture
a chair, several chairs	luggage, homework, knowledge, music, weather

- Use *many / few / a few / number of* with countable nouns: *many chairs, a few friends*.
- Use *much / little / a little / amount of* with uncountable nouns: *much water, a little sugar*.
- *A / an* is never used with an uncountable noun. Say *a piece of advice*, *a loaf of bread*, *an item of news*, *a glass of milk*.

IMPORTANT

Common mistake: *furnitures, informations, advices, luggages, homeworks, knowledges, scenerys, equipments, news are* are all WRONG. Correct: *furniture, information, advice, luggage, homework, knowledge, scenery, equipment; the news is*.

2.3 Number: Singular and Plural

▸ Regular plural rules

Rule	Singular → Plural
Most nouns: add -s	book → books, boy → boys, day → days
Ending in s, x, z, ch, sh: add -es	bus → buses, box → boxes, church → churches, dish → dishes, quiz → quizzes
Consonant + y: change y to -ies	baby → babies, story → stories, city → cities
Vowel + y: add -s	key → keys, monkey → monkeys, toy → toys
Ending in f / fe: change to -ves	leaf → leaves, wolf → wolves, knife → knives, wife → wives, life → lives, half → halves, shelf → shelves, thief → thieves
Some f-words simply add -s	roof → roofs, chief → chiefs, cliff → cliffs, proof → proofs, handkerchief → handkerchiefs, belief → beliefs
Consonant + o: usually -es	hero → heroes, potato → potatoes, tomato → tomatoes, mango → mangoes (also mangos)
Vowel + o, or music/short words: -s	radio → radios, zoo → zoos, photo → photos, piano → pianos, video → videos

▸ Irregular plurals

Type	Singular → Plural
Vowel change	man → men, woman → women, foot → feet, tooth → teeth, goose → geese, mouse → mice, louse → lice
-en ending	ox → oxen, child → children, brother → brethren (in a religious sense)
Same in singular and plural	sheep, deer, fish, series, species, aircraft, salmon, Chinese, Japanese
Always plural (no singular)	scissors, trousers, jeans, spectacles, pliers, binoculars, clothes, thanks, riches, belongings, congratulations, savings, outskirts, earnings
Looks plural, takes singular verb	news, mathematics, physics, economics, politics, measles, mumps, billiards, ethics, summons
Latin / Greek	crisis → crises, analysis → analyses, basis → bases, phenomenon → phenomena, criterion → criteria, datum → data, medium → media, bacterium → bacteria, curriculum → curricula, appendix → appendices
Compound nouns	mother-in-law → mothers-in-law, passer-by → passers-by, commander-in-chief → commanders-in-chief, step-son → step-sons; but spoonful → spoonfuls, handful → handfuls
Different meaning in plural	custom → customs (duty at the border), good → goods (merchandise), ground → grounds (reasons), arm → arms (weapons), letter → letters (literature), colour → colours (flag), manner → manners (etiquette), spectacle → spectacles (glasses)

IMPORTANT

Common mistakes: *childs, mans, sheeps, foots, mouses* are wrong. Correct: *children, men, sheep, feet, mice*. 'Scissors' and 'trousers' take a plural verb: *These scissors are sharp.* Say *a pair of scissors* to count them: *Two pairs of trousers are on the bed.*

2.4 Gender

Gender tells whether a noun is male, female, neither or either. There are four genders: **masculine** (male), **feminine** (female), **neuter** (things with no life) and **common** (could be either).

Masculine	Feminine	Masculine	Feminine
boy	girl	host	hostess
king	queen	actor	actress
lion	lioness	emperor	empress
bridegroom	bride	hero	heroine
nephew	niece	prince	princess
bull	cow	horse	mare
peacock	peahen	fox	vixen
steward	stewardess	widower	widow
god	goddess	tiger	tigress
landlord	landlady	wizard	witch
cock	hen	drake	duck
monk	nun	sir	madam

Common gender nouns suit both sexes: *teacher, student, doctor, child, parent, cousin, friend, baby, singer, pupil*. **Neuter**: *table, book, school*. Ships and countries are often referred to as 'she' in formal or poetic English.

> **NOTE**
> Modern usage prefers gender-neutral job titles: *chairperson, police officer, firefighter, flight attendant, businessperson, spokesperson*. Animals whose sex we do not know are called 'it'.

2.5 Case of Nouns

Case shows the relation of a noun with other words in the sentence. English has three cases in practice.

Case	Job	Example
Nominative (subject)	Noun that does the action	**Rita** sings.
Objective (object)	Noun that receives the action, or follows a preposition	Rita sings **a song**. He gave a book **to Rita**.
Possessive	Shows ownership/relation	**Rita's** song, the **boys'** hostel

Objects are of two kinds: the **direct object** (what?) and the **indirect object** (to/for whom?). *The teacher gave **us** (indirect) **homework** (direct).*

2.6 The Possessive Case

Rule	Examples
Singular noun: add 's	the girl's bag, Ravi's pen, the cat's tail
Plural ending in -s: add only an apostrophe	the girls' school, the students' room, the birds' nests
Plural not ending in -s: add 's	children's park, men's wear, women's college, people's choice
Singular name ending in -s: 's (or ') both accepted	James's book / James' book, Charles's friend

Rule	Examples
Compound nouns: 's on the last word	my brother-in-law's car, the Prime Minister's speech
Joint ownership: 's on the last name	Ram and Shyam's shop (one shop); Ram's and Shyam's shops (two shops)
Time, distance, measure: use 's	a week's holiday, two years' time, a stone's throw, a day's work

For **things without life**, prefer 'of': *the leg of the table, the door of the room, the roof of the house*. Exceptions: *the earth's surface, the sun's rays, the moon's light*.

> **IMPORTANT**
> Do not confuse: *its* (possessive) and *it's* (= it is / it has). *The dog wagged **its** tail. **It's** raining.* Similarly *whose* (possessive) vs *who's* (who is), *their* vs *they're*.

2.7 Collective Nouns

A **collective noun** names a group of persons, animals or things as a single unit. With a singular sense (group acting as one) the verb is singular: *The team **is** winning.* When members act separately, a plural verb is used: *The team **are** wearing their new kits.*

Group of	Collective noun	Group of	Collective noun
people	crowd, mob, audience, class, staff, committee	ships	fleet
players	team, squad	sheep	flock
cattle	herd	birds	flock, flight
fish	shoal, school	bees	swarm, hive
wolves	pack	lions	pride
stars	constellation, cluster	flowers	bunch, bouquet
grapes, bananas	bunch	keys	bunch
soldiers	army, troop, regiment	singers	choir
musicians	band, orchestra	stairs	flight
books	library, set	rubbish	heap, pile
thieves	gang	puppies	litter
pilgrims	caravan	directors	board

2.8 Nouns Used as Other Parts of Speech; Compound Nouns

Compound nouns join two words: *toothbrush, mother-in-law, post office, bus stop, schoolbag, rainbow*. Some are written solid, some hyphenated, some as two words; check a dictionary. Nouns can act as adjectives: *a **stone** wall, a **school** bus, a **gold** ring*.

> **IMPORTANT**
> Common mistakes: (1) 'The scenery of hills are beautiful' → *is*. (2) 'He gave me many advices' → *a lot of advice*. (3) 'Two dozens eggs' → *two dozen eggs* (no -s after a number when the noun follows); but *dozens of eggs*. (4) 'Hundreds / thousands / millions *of*' when no number precedes: *three hundred*, *hundreds of*.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Five kinds of nouns: proper, common, collective, material, abstract.
- Uncountable nouns (advice, furniture, news) have no plural and take a singular verb.
- Know the plural rules: -s, -es, -ies, -ves, -oes, and irregular forms such as children, feet, sheep.
- Possessive: singular 's, plural -s' only, irregular plural 's; use 'of' for non-living things.
- Collective nouns take a singular verb when the group acts as one.

CHAPTER 03 · WORDS THAT REPLACE NOUNS · CLASSES 5–8

Pronouns

A pronoun takes the place of a noun. Pronouns avoid repetition and make speech smooth, but they must be used with care: each pronoun must clearly refer to one noun (its antecedent) and agree with it in number, person and gender, and take the correct case.

3.1 Kinds of Pronouns

NOTE

Grade guide: Classes 5–6: personal, possessive, demonstrative, interrogative, reflexive. Classes 7–8: relative, indefinite, distributive, reciprocal, emphatic; case table; common errors with 'one', 'either/neither', 'each other/one another'.

Kind	Function	Examples
Personal	Stands for the speaker, listener or person spoken about	I, we, you, he, she, it, they; me, us, him, her, them
Possessive	Shows ownership (without a noun after it)	mine, ours, yours, his, hers, theirs
Reflexive	Action turns back on the doer; object	myself, yourself, himself, herself, itself, ourselves, yourselves, themselves
Emphatic	Adds emphasis; can be removed	I **myself** saw it. The Principal **himself** came.
Demonstrative	Points out	this, that, these, those, such, the same
Interrogative	Asks a question	who, whom, whose, which, what
Relative	Joins a clause to a noun/pronoun	who, whom, whose, which, that, what
Indefinite	Refers to no particular person/thing	one, someone, anybody, nobody, none, all, some, any, many, few, several, everyone, something
Distributive	Refers to members of a group one by one	each, every one, either, neither
Reciprocal	Shows mutual action	each other, one another

3.2 Personal Pronouns: Person, Number, Gender, Case

Person	Subject (nominative)	Object (objective)	Possessive adjective	Possessive pronoun	Reflexive
1st singular	I	me	my	mine	myself
1st plural	we	us	our	ours	ourselves
2nd (sing. & pl.)	you	you	your	yours	yourself / yourselves
3rd singular m.	he	him	his	his	himself
3rd singular f.	she	her	her	hers	herself
3rd singular n.	it	it	its	—	itself

Person	Subject (nominative)	Object (objective)	Possessive adjective	Possessive pronoun	Reflexive
3rd plural	they	them	their	theirs	themselves

First person = the speaker (I, we); **second person** = the one spoken to (you); **third person** = the one spoken about (he, she, it, they, any noun).

▸ Order of pronouns

When several pronouns come together the polite and usual order is: **2nd – 3rd – 1st** (*You, he and I*) for good things, and **1st – 2nd – 3rd** (*I, you and he*) for admitting a fault. *You and I must go. I and my friends were late (fault).*

3.3 Subject and Object Forms: Where Students Go Wrong

- After prepositions use the object form: *between you and **me**; for **him** and **her**; with **us** boys*.
- After 'let' use the object form: *Let **him** go. Let **us** (let's) go.*
- After 'than/as' the form depends on the unstated verb: *She is taller than **I** (am). / He likes you more than **me** (than he likes me).*
- After the linking verb 'be', formal English uses subject form: *It is **I**.* (informal: *It's me*.)
- 'Who' is subject, 'whom' is object: *Who called you? Whom did you call?* (informal English uses 'who' for both).

> **IMPORTANT**
> Common mistakes: *Me and him went* → **He and I went.** *Give it to he and I* → **to him and me.** *Everyone must bring their own pen* is accepted in modern English, but in exams prefer *his or her own pen* or rewrite in the plural.

3.4 Possessive Adjectives and Possessive Pronouns

Possessive adjective (before a noun)	Possessive pronoun (stands alone)
This is my bag.	This bag is **mine**.
Their house is big.	The big house is **theirs**.
Is that your pen?	Is that pen **yours**?
Her dress is red.	The red dress is **hers**.

> **IMPORTANT**
> Never use an apostrophe: *yours, hers, ours, theirs, its*. Wrong: *your's, her's, our's, their's*. *It's* always means 'it is / it has'.

3.5 Reflexive and Emphatic Pronouns

A **reflexive pronoun** (-self/-selves) is used when the subject and object are the same person: *He hurt **himself**. We enjoyed **ourselves**.* It cannot be omitted. An **emphatic pronoun** looks the same but only stresses, and can be left out: *I **myself** cooked dinner.*

- Plural is -selves: *themselves, ourselves, yourselves* (never *themself, hisself, theirselves*).
- With 'by': *by myself* = alone. *She lives by herself.*
- Some verbs take reflexive objects: *enjoy, hurt, cut, help (help yourself), pride, avail, absent, behave (behave yourself)*. Do not add a reflexive to verbs like *wash, dress, shave, relax, hide* unless emphasis is needed: *He dressed quickly* (not *dressed himself*).

3.6 Demonstrative Pronouns

	Near	Far
Singular	this	that
Plural	these	those

This is my pen. Those are your books. Other demonstratives: *such* (*Such is life.*), *the same* (*I will have the same.*). Used before a noun, these words are demonstrative **adjectives** (Chapter 4).

3.7 Interrogative Pronouns

Pronoun	Use	Example
who	people, as subject	**Who** broke the glass?
whom	people, as object	**Whom** did you meet?
whose	ownership	**Whose** is this scarf?
which	choice from a known set (people/things)	**Which** do you prefer, tea or coffee?
what	things, no choice implied	**What** is your name?

3.8 Relative Pronouns

A relative pronoun begins a **relative clause** that gives more information about a noun (the antecedent). Full rules are in the Relatives chapter.

Relative pronoun	Used for	Example
who / whom / whose	people	The boy **who** won the prize is my cousin. The man **whom** you met is a doctor. The girl **whose** bag was lost is crying.
which	animals and things	The book **which** I bought is old. The dog, **which** was hungry, barked.
that	people, animals, things (restrictive)	The pen **that** I lost was new.
what	= 'the thing that'	I know **what** you mean.

3.9 Indefinite and Distributive Pronouns

- **Indefinite**: *Someone is at the door. Nobody knows. Everybody was present. None of the boys was/were late. Many were absent.*
- Words ending in -body, -one, -thing take a **singular verb**: *Everyone **has** come. Something **is** wrong.*
- **Distributive** pronouns take a singular verb: *Each of the girls **has** a book. **Either** of the two roads **is** safe. **Neither** of them **was** present.*
- **One** means 'any person'; keep the same pronoun throughout: *One should do **one's** duty* (or *his/her duty*). Not *One should do their duty.*

3.10 Reciprocal Pronouns: Each Other and One Another

Use **each other** for two, **one another** for more than two (the distinction is fading, but exams still follow it): *The twins love **each other**. The students help **one another**.*

3.11 Pronoun Agreement and Clear Reference

1. A pronoun agrees with its antecedent in **number**: *The girls took **their** books.*

2. … in **gender**: *Rita lost **her** pen.*
3. … in **person**: *If you work hard, **you** will succeed* (not *one will…*).
4. Make the reference **clear**: *Raju told Mohan that **he** was late* is ambiguous. Write: *Raju told Mohan, 'You are late.'*
5. Collective nouns: singular pronoun when acting as a unit: *The team has won **its** match.*

IMPORTANT

Common mistakes: (1) *Each of the boys have taken their book* → **has taken his book**. (2) *He and myself went* → **He and I went.** (3) *I did it myself own* → **I did it on my own / by myself.** (4) *Those kind of books* → **That kind of book / Those kinds of books.**

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Pronouns replace nouns and must agree in number, person and gender with them.
- Learn the subject/object/possessive/reflexive forms; never write your's, her's, it's (possessive).
- Use object forms after prepositions: between you and me.
- Everyone, nobody, each, either, neither take a singular verb.
- Use each other for two, one another for more than two.

Determiners

A determiner is a word placed before a noun to show which one, whose, how many or how much. Determiners include articles (a, an, the), demonstratives (this, that), possessives (my, your), quantifiers (some, many, few) and numbers (one, first). This is topic 1 of the Grammar syllabus and a favourite area for gap-filling and editing questions.

4.1 What Determiners Are

NOTE

Grade guide: Classes 5–6: a/an/the basics, this/that/these/those, my/your etc., some/any/much/many. Classes 7–8: all article rules including omission, little/a little/the little, few/a few/the few, each/every, either/neither, numbers and ordinals.

Type of determiner	Words
Articles	a, an, the
Demonstratives	this, that, these, those
Possessives	my, our, your, his, her, its, their (and nouns like Ravi's)
Quantifiers	some, any, no, much, many, a lot of, little, few, several, enough, all, both, half, each, every, either, neither, more, most, less, least, another, other
Numbers	one, two, … (cardinal); first, second, … (ordinal)
Interrogative	which, what, whose (Which road? Whose book?)

A noun usually has only one determiner before it: *the boy, my pen, this book*. Do not write *the my book* or *a this pen*. But exceptions: *all the boys, both my sisters, half the cake, such a man* (pre-determiners).

4.2 Articles: A, An and The

There are two kinds of article: the **indefinite article** (*a, an*) refers to any one member of a class; the **definite article** (*the*) points to a particular, known one.

▸ Choosing 'a' or 'an' (by SOUND, not spelling)

Use	Rule	Examples
a	before a consonant SOUND	a boy, a university (yoo-), a European (yoo-), a one-rupee note (w-), a useful book, a unit
an	before a vowel SOUND	an apple, an hour (silent h), an honest man, an heir, an honour, an MLA, an X-ray, an umbrella

▸ Uses of the indefinite article 'a / an'

1. With a singular countable noun mentioned for the first time: *I saw **a** cat.*
2. To mean 'one': *a dozen, a hundred, a thousand, a pair*.
3. In the sense of 'per': *twice **a** day, ₹50 **a** kilo, 60 km **an** hour*.
4. With a profession or nationality (class): *She is **a** doctor. He is **an** Indian.*
5. With an unknown/general person, to mean 'any': *A child needs love.*
6. In certain expressions of quantity: *a few, a little, a lot of, a great deal of, a number of*.

7. In exclamations: *What **a** beautiful day! Such **a** pity!*
8. With 'many' + singular: *Many **a** boy has failed.*
9. Common phrases: *as a rule, in a hurry, at a loss, take a seat, have a look, make a noise, to be in a position to, once upon a time, all of a sudden, keep an eye on*.

▸ Uses of the definite article 'the'

1. When the noun has already been mentioned (second mention): *I saw a dog. **The** dog was black.*
2. When the reader/listener knows which one: *Close **the** door. **The** Principal wants you.*
3. Before things that are unique: *the sun, the moon, the earth, the sky, the equator, the universe, the world*.
4. Before superlatives: *the tallest boy, the best answer, the most beautiful flower*.
5. Before ordinals: *the first prize, the second chapter, the last bus*.
6. Before rivers, seas, oceans, gulfs, canals, mountain ranges, groups of islands, deserts: *the Ganga, the Arabian Sea, the Pacific, the Persian Gulf, the Suez Canal, the Himalayas, the Andamans, the Thar Desert*.
7. Before satellites, galaxies and star groups: *the Moon, the Milky Way, the Pole Star*. Names of individual planets take no article: *Mars, Venus, Jupiter* (but *the Earth* as a planet is also common).
8. Before historical buildings, monuments, ships, trains: *the Taj Mahal, the Red Fort, the Qutub Minar, the Titanic, the Rajdhani Express*.
9. Before countries whose names contain a common noun or are plural: *the United States, the United Kingdom, the Netherlands, the Philippines, the Republic of India, the USSR*.
10. Before the names of holy books: *the Ramayana, the Gita, the Quran, the Bible, the Guru Granth Sahib*.
11. Before names of newspapers, magazines, and well-known books: *The Hindu, The Times of India, The Reader's Digest*.
12. Before an adjective used as a noun to refer to a whole class: *the rich, the poor, the old, the blind, the brave*. (Verb is plural: *The poor need help.*)
13. Before a proper noun used as a common noun (to show a quality): *Kalidas is the Shakespeare of India.*
14. Before a singular noun representing a whole class: *The cow is a useful animal. The lion is the king of the jungle.*
15. Before musical instruments: *He plays the sitar. She plays the guitar.*
16. Before a body part after a preposition: *He caught me by the arm. She hit him on the head.*
17. Before 'same', 'only', 'very', 'following', 'next' (for definite time): *the same boy, the only chance, the very person*.
18. Before names of communities and families: *the Sharmas, the Mughals, the Marathas*.
19. With decades and centuries: *in the 1990s, in the nineteenth century*.
20. Before a comparative in the structure 'the…the': *The more, the merrier.*

▸ Omission of the article (zero article)

Where no article is used	Examples
Proper nouns (persons, cities, most countries, continents, single mountains, lakes)	Gandhi, Jaipur, India, Asia, Mount Everest, Lake Superior
Plural countable nouns and uncountable nouns used in a general sense	Dogs bark. Water is precious. Honesty is the best policy.
Names of languages, subjects, games, meals, colours	She speaks Hindi. I like Maths. They play cricket. We have lunch at one. Red suits you.
Abstract nouns used generally	Beauty fades. Time flies.
Transport after 'by'	by bus, by train, by air, by road
Institutions when used for their main purpose	go to school, in hospital (as a patient), go to bed, in prison, at college, at home, at night
Titles and relationship names used as proper names	Uncle came. Doctor Rao. Mother is cooking.
After 'what a/such a' with plurals	What lovely flowers! (not *what a lovely flowers*)

Where no article is used	Examples
Names of festivals and days/months	Diwali, Monday, March

With article (the school as a place)	Without article (the purpose of the school)
The teacher went to the school to meet the Principal.	The children go to school at 7 a.m.
His mother went to the hospital to visit him.	He is in hospital with a broken leg.
We saw a prison from the bus. The prison was huge.	The thief is in prison.

IMPORTANT

Common mistakes: *a hour, a honest boy* → **an hour, an honest boy**. *He is an university student* → **a university student**. *The Mount Everest, the Delhi, the India* → **Mount Everest, Delhi, India** (but **the Himalayas**). *I have a knowledge of the subject* → **knowledge**. *She is the M.A.* → **an M.A.** *He plays the cricket* → **cricket**. *The honesty is a virtue* → **Honesty is a virtue.**

4.3 Demonstrative Determiners

	Near	Far
Singular	this book	that book
Plural	these books	those books

- *This / these* = close to the speaker in place or time (*this week, these days*); *that / those* = farther away (*that day, those years*).
- Agree in number: *This book* (not *this books*); *those pencils*.
- 'Kind of / sort of / type of': *this kind of book*, *these kinds of books*; not *these kind of books* in careful English.

4.4 Possessive Determiners

My, our, your, his, her, its, their come before a noun. They are never used together with an article: not *the my book*. For body parts and clothes the possessive is normal: *She raised **her** hand.* A noun in the possessive case also acts as a determiner: *Ravi's bag, the teacher's desk.*

4.5 Quantifiers: Number and Quantity Words

Determiner	With countable (plural) nouns	With uncountable nouns	Remark
some	✔ some books	✔ some water	In positive sentences and in offers/requests: *Would you like some tea?*
any	✔ any books	✔ any water	In negatives and questions; in positive means 'no matter which': *Take any book.*
much	✘	✔ much time	Mostly negatives/questions: *There isn't much milk.* Positive: use 'a lot of'.
many	✔ many friends	✘	*How many?* Positive: *many* is formal; 'a lot of' is common.
a lot of / lots of	✔	✔	Positive sentences, informal.
all	✔ all the boys	✔ all the milk	*All of them; all day.*
both	✔ both hands	✘	Only two. *Both (of) the boys.*

Determiner	With countable (plural) nouns	With uncountable nouns	Remark
each	✔ (singular noun) each boy	✘	Takes singular verb: *Each student has a card.*
every	✔ (singular) every child	✘	*Every one of them is ready.* Every + 'day' (all days); 'everyday' is an adjective.
either / neither	✔ (singular)	✘	Two things: *Either road is safe. Neither answer is right.*
several	✔ several people	✘	More than two but not many.
enough	✔ enough chairs	✔ enough sugar	Before the noun; after adjectives/adverbs: *tall enough*.
more / most	✔	✔	*more books; most students*.
less / least	✘ (use fewer)	✔ less sugar	'Fewer' for countable; 'less' for uncountable: *fewer mistakes, less noise*.
another / other	✔ another book (singular); other books	✘	*another* = one more; *the other* = the remaining one.
no	✔ no problems	✔ no time	Before nouns; 'none' stands alone.

▸ Little, a little, the little

Form	Meaning	Example
little	hardly any (negative idea)	He has **little** money, so he cannot buy it.
a little	not much, but some (positive idea)	I have **a little** money; I can buy a pen.
the little	all that there is (however small)	He gave away **the little** money he had.

▸ Few, a few, the few

Form	Meaning	Example
few	hardly any (negative idea)	**Few** people came to the meeting.
a few	not many, but some (positive idea)	**A few** friends came to the party.
the few	all of them, though not many	**The few** friends he had deserted him.

> **NOTE**
> 'Little' and 'a little' go with **uncountable** nouns; 'few' and 'a few' go with **countable** nouns. 'Only a little' / 'only a few' can add a negative feel: *Only a few students passed.*

▸ Each, every, either, neither

- **Each** = one by one, for two or more: *Each of the boys got a prize.* **Every** = all, taken as a group, for three or more: *Every boy got a prize.*
- *Each / every* + singular noun + singular verb: *Each child **has** a pen.* 'Every' cannot be used without a noun; use 'every one' or 'each'.
- **Either** = one or the other of TWO; **neither** = not one nor the other of TWO. For more than two, use *any one / none*: *Any of the three; none of the three.*
- *Either of the sisters **is** coming. Neither of the boys **was** absent.*
- Either/neither need a singular verb in exams.

4.6 Numbers: Cardinal and Ordinal

Cardinal (how many)	Ordinal (which position)
one, two, three, four, five	first, second, third, fourth, fifth
eight, nine, twelve	eighth, ninth, twelfth
twenty, thirty	twentieth, thirtieth
twenty-one	twenty-first
hundred, thousand	hundredth, thousandth

- Ordinals take 'the': *the third floor, the twelfth chapter*.
- When a number is used as an adjective of measure, the noun stays singular: *a five-rupee note, a two-year-old child, a ten-minute walk* (hyphenated, singular).
- After a number, *dozen, hundred, thousand, million, score, pair* stay singular: *three hundred, two dozen*. Without a number they take 'of' and -s: *hundreds of people*.
- Years: *in 1947* (nineteen forty-seven); decades: *the 1980s*.
- *Next / last*: 'next week' (no article), 'the next day' (relative to a past time); 'last year' vs 'the last year of the century'.

IMPORTANT

Common mistakes: (1) *Many a boys* → **Many a boy**. (2) *Few water* → **little water**. (3) *I have a few knowledge* → **a little knowledge**. (4) *Each of the boys have* → **has**. (5) *Less books* → **fewer books**. (6) *Everyday I walk* → **Every day** I walk. (7) *The both boys* → **Both the boys / The two boys.** (8) *Another two books* is acceptable; *the others book* → **the other book**.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Use 'an' before a vowel SOUND, 'a' before a consonant SOUND.
- 'The' is used for things already mentioned, unique things, superlatives, rivers, seas, mountain ranges, monuments, scriptures, newspapers and classes (the poor).
- No article before proper names, games, languages, meals, plural/uncountable general nouns and 'by + transport'.
- Little/few are negative (hardly any); a little/a few are positive (some); the little/the few mean all that there is.
- Each, every, either, neither take singular verbs; use fewer with countables and less with uncountables.

CHAPTER 05 · DESCRIBING AND COMPARING · CLASSES 5–8

Adjectives and Degrees of Comparison

Adjectives add colour and detail to nouns. They also let us compare persons, places and things through three degrees: positive, comparative and superlative. Comparison is topic 8 of the Grammar syllabus and is tested through gap filling, editing and sentence transformation.

5.1 What is an Adjective?

NOTE

Grade guide: Classes 5–6: kinds of adjectives, regular comparison (-er, -est, more, most). Classes 7–8: order of adjectives, irregular comparison, than/to/the rules, transformation between degrees, double comparatives, absolute adjectives, compound adjectives.

An **adjective** is a word that describes or limits a noun or pronoun. It answers: *What kind? How many? How much? Which? Whose?* Adjectives do not change for number or gender in English: *a tall boy, tall girls*.

Kind	Examples
Quality (descriptive)	a **beautiful** garden, **kind** people, **heavy** load, **red** flower
Quantity	**some** sugar, **little** time, **whole** cake, **enough** money, **much** rain
Number: definite	**five** pens, the **third** floor
Number: indefinite	**many** birds, **few** students, **several** days, **all** boys
Distributive	**each** child, **every** day, **either** side
Demonstrative	**this** road, **those** hills
Possessive	**my** house, **their** garden
Interrogative	**Which** bag? **What** colour? **Whose** pen?
Proper adjective (from proper nouns)	**Indian** food, **Chinese** silk, **Shakespearean** drama

▸ Position of adjectives

- **Attributive**: before the noun – *a clever girl*.
- **Predicative**: after a linking verb (be, seem, look, feel, become, taste, sound) – *The girl is clever. The soup tastes good.*
- Some adjectives only work after the verb: *alive, asleep, afraid, alone, awake, ashamed, aware → The child is asleep* (not *an asleep child*). Use *sleeping child, living animal, frightened boy*.

5.2 Order of Adjectives

When two or more adjectives come before a noun, they usually follow this order: **Opinion – Size – Age – Shape – Colour – Origin – Material – Purpose – NOUN.**

Opinion	Size	Age	Shape	Colour	Origin	Material	Noun
lovely	small	old	round	brown	Kashmiri	wooden	box
delicious	big	fresh		red	Indian		apples
a beautiful	tall	young		dark	Rajasthani		girl

*She wore a **beautiful long red silk** scarf.* Number words come first: *two beautiful old houses*. Commas are used between adjectives of the same kind: *a tall, handsome man*; 'and' joins colours after a verb: *The flag is saffron, white and green.*

5.3 Compound Adjectives and Adjective Endings

- Compound adjectives are hyphenated and singular: *a ten-year-old boy, a well-known writer, a four-page letter, a first-class compartment, a part-time job*.
- Common endings: -ful (*helpful*), -less (*careless*), -ous (*famous*), -ive (*active*), -able/-ible (*readable, possible*), -al (*musical*), -ic (*historic*), -y (*rainy*), -ish (*childish*), -ent/-ant (*patient, elegant*).
- -ed vs -ing adjectives: *I am **bored** (feeling). The film is **boring** (cause). surprised/surprising, tired/tiring, interested/interesting*.

5.4 Degrees of Comparison

Degree	Use	Example
Positive	No comparison, or equality	Lata is **tall**. Raj is **as tall as** Lata.
Comparative	Compares TWO	Gita is **taller than** Lata.
Superlative	Compares MORE THAN TWO, picks the highest	Seema is **the tallest** girl in the class.

▸ Forming regular comparatives and superlatives

Word type	Comparative	Superlative	Examples
One syllable	-er	-est	tall → taller → tallest; small → smaller → smallest
One syllable ending in -e	-r	-st	fine → finer → finest; wise → wiser → wisest
Consonant + y	change y to i, add -er/-est		happy → happier → happiest; busy → busier → busiest
Short vowel + single consonant	double the consonant		big → bigger → biggest; hot → hotter → hottest; thin → thinner → thinnest
Two syllables (not ending in -y) and longer words	more …	most …	beautiful → more beautiful → most beautiful; careful, famous, difficult, intelligent
Some two-syllable words take either	-er/-est or more/most		clever → cleverer / more clever; narrow, simple, gentle, quiet

▸ Irregular comparison

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
good / well	better	best
bad / ill / evil	worse	worst
much / many	more	most
little	less	least
far	farther / further	farthest / furthest
late	later / latter	latest / last
near	nearer	nearest / next
old	older / elder	oldest / eldest
fore	former	foremost / first
in	inner	innermost / inmost
out	outer / utter	outermost / utmost

Older / oldest refer to age of persons and things. **Elder / eldest** are used only for members of a family, before a noun; they are not followed by 'than': *my elder brother, the eldest daughter*. (For comparing ages say *older than*.) **Farther** = distance; **further** = additional (*further information*). **Later/latest** = time; **latter/last** = order (the latter = the second of two).

5.5 Rules of Comparison: Than, To, The

1. **Use 'than' after a comparative**: *Delhi is bigger than Jaipur.* Never use 'than' with superlatives.
2. **Latin comparatives take 'to', not 'than'**: *senior to, junior to, superior to, inferior to, prior to, anterior to, posterior to, prefer…to. He is senior to me. This cloth is superior to that.* ('Prefer' is not an adjective: *I prefer tea to coffee*; *I prefer walking to driving*; not 'than'.)
3. **Use 'the' before a superlative**: *the best, the most useful.* Omit 'the' when the superlative is possessive or a predicate without comparison: *my best friend; He is happiest when alone.*
4. **Do not use double comparatives or double superlatives**: wrong *more better, most cleverest, more taller*. Correct: *better, cleverest, taller*.
5. **Compare like with like**: wrong *The climate of Shimla is cooler than Delhi.* Correct: *…cooler than that of Delhi.* (Compare climate with climate.)
6. **Exclude the thing compared from the group** in a comparative: *Mount Everest is higher than any other mountain in the world.* (not *than any mountain*) And include it for superlatives: *…the highest of all mountains*.
7. **Use 'as…as'** for equality, **'not so/as…as'** for inequality: *She is as tall as I. He is not so clever as his sister.*
8. **Comparative with 'the…the'**: *The more you read, the more you learn.*
9. **'Elder' is not used with 'than'**: *He is older than I (am)*, but *He is my elder brother.*
10. **Few adjectives have no degrees** (absolute): *perfect, unique, complete, universal, round, empty, dead, full, square, excellent*. Do not say *more perfect* or *very unique*.
11. **Use 'of' with superlatives** (group), **'in' with places/collective nouns**: *the tallest of the three; the tallest boy in the class.*

5.6 Transformation of Degrees

The same idea can be expressed in all three degrees. This is a frequent exam item.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
No other boy in the class is as tall as Raj.	Raj is taller than any other boy in the class.	Raj is the tallest boy in the class.
Very few cities in India are as big as Mumbai.	Mumbai is bigger than most other Indian cities.	Mumbai is one of the biggest cities in India.
Iron is not so costly as gold.	Gold is costlier than iron.	Gold is the costliest of all metals.
Few boys are as honest as Sohan.	Sohan is more honest than most other boys.	Sohan is one of the most honest boys.
Mohan is as clever as Sohan.	Mohan is not cleverer than Sohan.	—

Step 1
Identify the base adjective and the persons/things compared.

Step 2
For a superlative → comparative, use 'than any other + singular noun'.

Step 3
For a negative positive ('not so…as'), switch the positions of the two items in the comparative.

Step 4
Check 'the' (superlative), 'than' (comparative), 'as…as' (positive).

IMPORTANT

Common mistakes: (1) *This is the most unique idea* → **a unique idea**. (2) *He is more intelligent than any boy in the class* → **any other boy**. (3) *She is more taller than me* → **taller than I**. (4) *Anil is stronger than Sunil is* (fine) vs *Anil is the stronger of the two* (use 'the' with comparative when 'of the two' is present). (5) *He is junior than me* → **junior to me**. (6) *The Nile is the longest than all rivers* → **the longest of all rivers**.

IMPORTANT

Check 'adjective vs adverb' – after verbs of sense and being use adjectives: *The food smells **good**. He looks **angry**. She feels **cold**.*

NOTE

Adjectives followed by prepositions (afraid of, good at, fond of, interested in …) are listed with the other dependent prepositions in Chapter 12.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Adjectives describe nouns; use them in the order opinion–size–age–shape–colour–origin–material–noun.
- Comparative compares two (-er/more … than); superlative compares more than two (the -est/the most).
- Latin comparatives (senior, junior, superior, inferior, prefer) take 'to'.
- Never use double comparatives; say 'than any other' for a comparative of a thing within its own group.
- Compare like with like (that of / those of).

Adverbs

Adverbs add information about how, when, where, how often and how much something happens. They modify verbs, adjectives, other adverbs and sometimes whole sentences. This chapter also sorts out the confusions between adjectives and adverbs and the tricky words too, very, enough, so and such.

6.1 Kinds of Adverbs

NOTE

Grade guide: Classes 5–6: kinds of adverbs, formation with -ly. Classes 7–8: position, adverb vs adjective, too/very/enough, so/such, comparison of adverbs.

Kind	Answers	Examples
Manner	How?	slowly, carefully, well, fast, loudly, happily
Time	When?	now, today, yesterday, soon, already, lately, then
Place	Where?	here, there, everywhere, upstairs, outside, nearby
Frequency	How often?	always, never, often, sometimes, rarely, usually, twice, daily
Degree	How much?	very, quite, too, almost, rather, enough, so, fairly
Interrogative	Asks	Why? When? Where? How? How far? How often?
Relative	Joins	This is the place **where** I was born. The day **when** we met.
Affirmation / negation / reason	Yes/no/why	certainly, surely, not, never, hence, therefore

6.2 Formation of Adverbs

- Add -ly to an adjective: *quick → quickly, careful → carefully, slow → slowly*.
- Adjective ending in -y: change to -ily: *happy → happily, easy → easily, angry → angrily*.
- Ending in -le: drop e, add -y: *gentle → gently, simple → simply, humble → humbly*.
- Ending in -ic: add -ally: *tragic → tragically, basic → basically* (exception: *publicly*).
- Ending in -ue: *true → truly, due → duly*. Ending in -ll: *full → fully*.
- Same form as adjective: *fast, hard, early, late, high, low, long, deep, straight, daily, weekly, near, far, right, wrong*.
- Irregular: *good → well*.

IMPORTANT

Words that end in -ly but are ADJECTIVES: friendly, lovely, lonely, silly, ugly, lively, costly, elderly, likely, deadly. Say 'in a friendly way', not 'friendlily'.

6.3 Adverbs with Two Forms and Different Meanings

Word	Meaning of the plain form	Meaning of the -ly form
hard	with effort: *work hard*	scarcely: *hardly any*, *He can hardly walk.*
late	after the expected time: *came late*	recently: *I have not seen him lately.*
near	close by: *come near*	almost: *nearly finished*
high	at a great height: *flew high*	greatly: *highly pleased, highly paid*

Word	Meaning of the plain form	Meaning of the -ly form
free	without payment: *eat free*	without restriction: *speak freely*
deep	far down: *dig deep*	very much: *deeply hurt*
right	correct / straight: *go right*	justly: *rightly said*
wrong	incorrectly: *spelt wrong*	unjustly: *wrongly accused*
short	suddenly: *stopped short*	soon: *shortly after*
most	to the greatest degree: *the most loved*	chiefly: *mostly Indian students*

6.4 Position of Adverbs

Kind	Usual position	Example
Manner	after the verb or object	She sang **sweetly**. He solved the sum **correctly**.
Place	after the verb/object	The kids are playing **outside**.
Time	at the end (or beginning for emphasis)	I met him **yesterday**. **Yesterday** I met him.
Frequency	before the main verb, after 'be' and after the first helping verb	He **always** wakes early. She is **never** late. They have **often** visited us.
Degree	before the adjective/adverb	It is **very** hot. He ran **quite** fast.
Enough	after the adjective/adverb, before a noun	He is old **enough**. We have **enough** food.

When more than one adverb occurs at the end, the order is **manner – place – time**: *She sang beautifully (manner) in the hall (place) last night (time).* **'Only'** goes immediately before the word it limits: *I **only** saw Ravi* (I did nothing else); *I saw **only** Ravi* (nobody else). Place 'only' carefully.

6.5 Adverb or Adjective?

Adjective (describes a noun)	Adverb (describes a verb/adjective/adverb)
a quick reply	He replied **quickly**.
a hard exam	He studied **hard**.
a good player	He plays **well**.
a late train	The train came **late**.
an early flight	We left **early**.
a loud noise	Speak **loudly**.

- After **linking verbs** (be, seem, appear, look, feel, sound, taste, smell, become, grow, get, remain) use an adjective: *She looks **sad**. The milk went **sour**. He felt **weak**.*
- After **action verbs** use an adverb: *She looked **sadly** at me. He felt the cloth **carefully**.*
- 'Good' = adjective, 'well' = adverb (but 'well' is an adjective meaning healthy: *I am well.*).
- 'Hard' as adverb = with effort; 'hardly' = barely: *He works hard ≠ He hardly works.*

6.6 Too, Very, Enough, So and Such

Word	Meaning and rule	Example
very	to a high degree; neutral; no result expected	He is **very** weak but he walks.

Word	Meaning and rule	Example
too	more than needed, with a negative result; use 'too…to'	He is **too** weak **to walk**.
too much / too many	excess; 'too much' with uncountable, 'too many' with countable	too much noise; too many cooks
enough	sufficient; AFTER adjective/adverb, BEFORE noun	He is strong **enough** to lift it. We have **enough** chairs.
so	before an adjective/adverb; 'so…that' = result; 'so…as to'	He was **so** tired **that** he slept.
such	before (a/an) + (adjective) + noun; 'such…that'	It was **such** a hot day **that** we stayed in.

IMPORTANT

(1) 'Too' alone does not mean 'very': *I am too glad* is wrong; say *very glad*. (2) 'Too' also means 'also': *I'll come too.* (3) *so* + adjective (no noun) and *such* + noun: *so beautiful*; *such a beautiful girl*. (4) *so that* shows purpose: *He studied hard so that he might pass.*

▸ Transforming 'too…to', 'so…that', 'enough…to'

Form	Sentence
too…to	He is **too tired to** walk.
so…that	He is **so tired that** he cannot walk.
so tired…as to	He is so tired as not to walk (rare).
not strong enough	He is **not strong enough to** lift the box.
Opposite	The box is **so heavy that** he cannot lift it ↔ The box is **too heavy for him to** lift.

6.7 Comparison of Adverbs

Adverbs are compared like adjectives: *fast → faster → fastest; soon → sooner → soonest; hard → harder → hardest.* Adverbs in -ly take more/most: *carefully → more carefully → most carefully.* Irregular: *well → better → best; badly → worse → worst; much → more → most; little → less → least; far → farther/further → farthest/furthest. He ran faster than I. She sings the most sweetly of all.*

IMPORTANT

Common mistakes: (1) *He runs quick* → **quickly**. (2) *She sings good* → **well**. (3) *I am feeling badly* → **bad** (linking verb). (4) *He works hardly* → **hard**. (5) *very tired to walk* → **too tired to walk**. (6) *He came lately* (recently) → **late**. (7) *I have hardly no money* → **I have hardly any money** (hardly is already negative).

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Adverbs tell how, when, where, how often and how much; many end in -ly but some (fast, hard, late) do not.
- After linking verbs use adjectives; after action verbs use adverbs.
- 'Too' has a negative result (too…to); 'very' does not; 'enough' follows the adjective but precedes the noun.
- Frequency adverbs go before the main verb and after 'be'.

CHAPTER 07 · THE HEART OF THE SENTENCE · CLASSES 5–8

Verbs

The verb is the most important word in a sentence: without it there is no sentence. Verbs show action, state and being, and they change form for tense, person and number. This chapter covers kinds of verbs, auxiliaries, transitive and intransitive use, regular and irregular forms (with a table of over 140 verbs), finite and non-finite forms (phrasal verbs are in Chapter 19).

7.1 What a Verb Does

NOTE

Grade guide: Classes 5–6: action verbs, helping verbs, three forms of common verbs, transitive/intransitive. Classes 7–8: full irregular-verb table, lie/lay, rise/raise confusions, finite and non-finite verbs, stative verbs.

A **verb** says what the subject does (*run, write*), what happens to it (*is broken*), or what it is (*is, seems*). Every verb has five forms:

Form	Name	Example (write)	Used for
V1	Base form / root	write	present (I, you, we, they), infinitive, imperatives, after modals/did/do
V1 + s/es	-s form	writes	present tense with he, she, it
V2	Past simple	wrote	simple past tense
V3	Past participle	written	perfect tenses, passive voice
V1 + ing	Present participle / gerund	writing	continuous tenses, adjectives, gerunds

7.2 Main Verbs and Helping Verbs

A **main (principal) verb** carries the meaning. A **helping (auxiliary) verb** helps the main verb to form tenses, questions, negatives and the passive voice. There are two groups:

Primary auxiliaries	Modal auxiliaries
be (am, is, are, was, were, been, being), have (has, had), do (does, did)	can, could, may, might, will, would, shall, should, must, ought to, need, dare, used to

- *She **is** singing.* (helping + main) | *She **is** a singer.* (main verb)
- *I **have** finished.* (helping) | *I **have** a pen.* (main verb)
- *I **do** not know.* (helping) | *I **do** my homework.* (main)
- Modals have no -s in the third person and no -ing/-ed forms. After a modal use V1: *He can swim* (not *can swims*).

7.3 Transitive and Intransitive Verbs

Type	Meaning	Examples
Transitive	Action passes to an object (answers 'what?' or 'whom?')	She **ate** an apple. He **wrote** a letter.
Intransitive	No object; action stops with the doer	The baby **cried**. The sun **rises**. They **arrived**.

Type	Meaning	Examples
Both	Many verbs can be used either way	He **sings** (intr.). He **sings** a song (tr.)
Ditransitive	Takes two objects (indirect and direct)	She **gave** me (indirect) a pen (direct).
Linking (copular)	Joins subject and a complement; no action	She **is** a nurse. It **seems** easy. The leaf **turned** brown.

To test: ask *What?* or *Whom?* after the verb. If you get an answer, it is transitive. Only transitive verbs can be made passive.

▸ Confusing pairs

Intransitive	Transitive	Examples
lie – lay – lain (recline)	lay – laid – laid (put down)	He **lies** on the bed. She **laid** the book on the table.
rise – rose – risen	raise – raised – raised	The sun **rises**. They **raise** the flag.
sit – sat – sat	seat – seated – seated	He **sat** down. She **seated** the guests.
fall – fell – fallen	fell – felled – felled (cut down)	Leaves **fall**. They **felled** the tree.
lie (tell a falsehood) – lied – lied	—	He **lied** to me.
hang – hung – hung (things)	hang – hanged – hanged (execution)	The picture **hung** on the wall. The criminal was **hanged**.

7.4 Regular and Irregular Verbs

Regular verbs form V2 and V3 by adding -ed (or -d): *walk–walked–walked; love–loved–loved*. Spelling: consonant + y → -ied (*carry–carried*); double the final consonant of short stressed verbs (*stop–stopped, plan–planned*); just add -d to verbs ending in -e. **Irregular verbs** have other forms and must be memorised.

V1	V2	V3	V1	V2	V3
arise	arose	arisen	mistake	mistook	mistaken
awake	awoke	awoken	overcome	overcame	overcome
be	was/were	been	pay	paid	paid
bear	bore	borne	put	put	put
beat	beat	beaten	quit	quit	quit
become	became	become	read	read	read
begin	began	begun	rid	rid	rid
bend	bent	bent	ride	rode	ridden
bet	bet	bet	ring	rang	rung
bind	bound	bound	rise	rose	risen
bite	bit	bitten	run	ran	run
bleed	bled	bled	saw	sawed	sawn
blow	blew	blown	say	said	said
break	broke	broken	see	saw	seen
breed	bred	bred	seek	sought	sought

V1	V2	V3	V1	V2	V3
bring	brought	brought	sell	sold	sold
build	built	built	send	sent	sent
burn	burnt/burned	burnt/burned	set	set	set
burst	burst	burst	sew	sewed	sewn
buy	bought	bought	shake	shook	shaken
cast	cast	cast	shed	shed	shed
catch	caught	caught	shine	shone	shone
choose	chose	chosen	shoot	shot	shot
cling	clung	clung	show	showed	shown
come	came	come	shrink	shrank	shrunk
cost	cost	cost	shut	shut	shut
creep	crept	crept	sing	sang	sung
cut	cut	cut	sink	sank	sunk
deal	dealt	dealt	sit	sat	sat
dig	dug	dug	sleep	slept	slept
do	did	done	slide	slid	slid
draw	drew	drawn	smell	smelt/smelled	smelt/smelled
dream	dreamt/dreamed	dreamt/dreamed	sow	sowed	sown
drink	drank	drunk	speak	spoke	spoken
drive	drove	driven	speed	sped	sped
dwell	dwelt	dwelt	spell	spelt/spelled	spelt/spelled
eat	ate	eaten	spend	spent	spent
fall	fell	fallen	spill	spilt/spilled	spilt/spilled
feed	fed	fed	spin	spun	spun
feel	felt	felt	spit	spat	spat
fight	fought	fought	split	split	split
find	found	found	spoil	spoilt/spoiled	spoilt/spoiled
flee	fled	fled	spread	spread	spread
fling	flung	flung	spring	sprang	sprung
fly	flew	flown	stand	stood	stood
forbid	forbade	forbidden	steal	stole	stolen
forget	forgot	forgotten	stick	stuck	stuck
forgive	forgave	forgiven	sting	stung	stung
freeze	froze	frozen	stink	stank	stunk

V1	V2	V3	V1	V2	V3
get	got	got	strike	struck	struck
give	gave	given	string	strung	strung
go	went	gone	strive	strove	striven
grind	ground	ground	swear	swore	sworn
grow	grew	grown	sweep	swept	swept
hang	hung	hung	swell	swelled	swollen
have	had	had	swim	swam	swum
hear	heard	heard	swing	swung	swung
hide	hid	hidden	take	took	taken
hit	hit	hit	teach	taught	taught
hold	held	held	tear	tore	torn
hurt	hurt	hurt	tell	told	told
keep	kept	kept	think	thought	thought
kneel	knelt	knelt	throw	threw	thrown
know	knew	known	thrust	thrust	thrust
lay	laid	laid	tread	trod	trodden
lead	led	led	understand	understood	understood
lean	leant/leaned	leant/leaned	undo	undid	undone
leap	leapt/leaped	leapt/leaped	upset	upset	upset
learn	learnt/learned	learnt/learned	wake	woke	woken
leave	left	left	wear	wore	worn
lend	lent	lent	weave	wove	woven
let	let	let	weep	wept	wept
lie	lay	lain	win	won	won
light	lit	lit	wind	wound	wound
lose	lost	lost	withdraw	withdrew	withdrawn
make	made	made	wring	wrung	wrung
mean	meant	meant	write	wrote	written
meet	met	met			

IMPORTANT

Common mistakes: *He buyed / brang / teached / runned / taked* → **bought, brought, taught, ran, took**. *I have went / She has wrote / It was broke* → **have gone, has written, was broken**. *He has did it* → **has done**. V2 is used alone (no helping verb) in simple past; V3 needs 'have/has/had' or 'be'.

7.5 Finite and Non-finite Verbs

A **finite verb** has a subject and changes with tense, number and person: *She **sings**. They **sang**. I **will sing**.* A **non-finite verb** does not show tense or number and cannot be the only verb of a sentence: the infinitive (*to sing*), the gerund (*singing* as a noun) and the participle (*singing / sung* as adjectives).

Type	Example	Function
Infinitive	I want **to sing**.	noun / purpose
Gerund	**Singing** is fun.	noun
Present participle	The **singing** bird	adjective
Past participle	The **broken** glass	adjective

Non-finite verbs are covered in depth in a separate chapter.

7.6 Stative Verbs (Not Used in Continuous Tenses)

Verbs of state, thought, feeling, possession and senses are normally not used in continuous form: *know, believe, understand, remember, forget, want, like, love, hate, prefer, need, belong, own, have (possess), see, hear, smell (sense), seem, appear, contain, consist*.

Wrong	Correct
I am knowing him.	I know him.
She is having a car.	She has a car.
He is belonging to Jaipur.	He belongs to Jaipur.
I am understanding the lesson.	I understand the lesson.
They are wanting water.	They want water.

Some of these verbs have an action meaning and can be continuous: *She is having lunch* (eating), *I am thinking of a plan*, *He is seeing the doctor* (meeting).

> **NOTE**
> Verbs followed by a gerund or an infinitive are explained in Chapter 11 (Non-finites); phrasal verbs (give up, look after, put off …) have their own section in Chapter 19.

7.9 The Verb Be, Have and Do in Detail

Verb	Present	Past	V3 / -ing	Notes
be	am (I), is (he/she/it), are (you/we/they)	was (I/he/she/it), were (you/we/they)	been / being	'were' for all persons in unreal wishes: *If I were you…*
have	have / has	had	had / having	Possession; helps perfect tenses; *have to* = must
do	do / does	did	done / doing	Helps in negatives and questions; main verb 'to perform'

> **IMPORTANT**
> Do/does/did are followed by V1, never V2/V3 or -s: *She does not **like** it* (not *likes*); *Did he **come**?* (not *came*).

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Every verb has five forms: V1, V1+s, V2, V3 and V1+ing.
- Helping verbs (be, have, do and modals) help main verbs; after do/does/did and modals use V1.
- Only transitive verbs have a passive voice; learn lie/lay, rise/raise, sit/seat.
- Memorise the irregular verb table; never write 'have went' or 'has did'.
- Stative verbs (know, want, belong) are not used in continuous tenses.

CHAPTER 08 · TIME OF ACTION · CLASSES 5–8

Tenses

Tense shows the time of an action and also its stage: whether it is a habit, in progress, completed, or has been going on for a period. English has three times (present, past, future) and four aspects (indefinite, continuous, perfect, perfect continuous), making twelve tenses. Tenses form topic 2 of the Grammar syllabus and appear in editing, gap-filling, omission and transformation questions.

8.1 The Twelve Tenses at a Glance

NOTE

Grade guide: Classes 5–6: simple present, simple past, simple future, present continuous, past continuous. Classes 7–8: all twelve tenses, key words, since/for, tense in conditionals and time clauses, errors.

Aspect	Present	Past	Future
Indefinite (Simple)	I write / He writes	I wrote	I will write
Continuous (Progressive)	I am writing	I was writing	I will be writing
Perfect	I have written	I had written	I will have written
Perfect Continuous	I have been writing	I had been writing	I will have been writing

▸ Formation table

Tense	Present	Past	Future
Indefinite	V1 (V1+s/es with he, she, it); do/does + V1 in negative/question	V2; did + V1 in negative/question	will/shall + V1
Continuous	am/is/are + V1+ing	was/were + V1+ing	will/shall + be + V1+ing
Perfect	has/have + V3	had + V3	will/shall + have + V3
Perfect Continuous	has/have + been + V1+ing	had + been + V1+ing	will/shall + have + been + V1+ing

▸ Types of sentences in every tense

- **Affirmative**: *She plays tennis.*
- **Negative**: *She does not play tennis.*
- **Interrogative (Yes/No)**: *Does she play tennis?*
- **Interrogative (Wh-)**: *When does she play tennis?*
- **Negative interrogative**: *Doesn't she play tennis? / Why doesn't she play tennis?*

Contractions: *isn't, aren't, wasn't, weren't, haven't, hasn't, hadn't, won't (will not), shan't (shall not), don't, doesn't, didn't, can't, couldn't*. Third person singular: he, she, it, a singular noun (*Ravi, the dog, my mother*).

8.2 Present Tenses

▸ 1. Present Indefinite (Simple Present)

Form: V1 (V1+s/es for he/she/it). Negative: do/does not + V1. Question: Do/Does + subject + V1?

Uses: (1) habits and routines: *He gets up at five.* (2) universal truths and scientific facts: *The sun rises in the east. Water boils at 100°C.* (3) permanent situations: *My father works in a bank.* (4) timetables and schedules (future sense): *The train*

leaves at 6. (5) commentary, stage directions, headlines: *Dhoni hits a six.* (6) in time/if-clauses for the future: *If it rains, we will stay.*

Key words: always, never, usually, often, sometimes, daily, every day, generally, on Sundays, seldom, rarely.

Type	Singular subject	Plural subject
Affirmative	She walks to school.	They walk to school.
Negative	She does not walk.	They do not walk.
Question	Does she walk?	Do they walk?
Wh-question	Where does she walk?	Where do they walk?
Negative question	Doesn't she walk?	Don't they walk?

Spelling of -s / -es	Examples
Add -s	walk → walks, sing → sings
Add -es after s, x, z, ch, sh, o	pass → passes, fix → fixes, watch → watches, wash → washes, go → goes, do → does
Consonant + y → -ies	study → studies, cry → cries
Vowel + y → -ys	play → plays, say → says
Irregular	have → has, be → is

> **IMPORTANT**
> Do not add -s to the main verb when 'does' is used: *Does he **go**?* (not *goes*). *He doesn't **like** it.*

▸ 2. Present Continuous

Form: am/is/are + V1+ing. **Uses**: (1) action happening now: *The baby is sleeping.* (2) action around the present time, temporary: *I am studying for the exams these days.* (3) planned future action: *We are leaving tomorrow.* (4) annoying habit with 'always': *He is always complaining.* (5) changing situations: *Prices are rising.*

Key words: now, at present, at this moment, these days, nowadays, look!, listen!, today, currently.

Type	Example
Affirmative	I am reading.
Negative	She is not (isn't) reading.
Question	Are you reading?
Wh-question	What are you reading?
Negative question	Isn't he reading?

Spelling of V+ing: drop final -e (*make → making*), double final consonant for short stressed verbs (*run → running, sit → sitting, begin → beginning*), -ie → -ying (*lie → lying, die → dying*). Stative verbs (know, want, like, belong) are not used in continuous.

▸ 3. Present Perfect

Form: have/has + V3. **Uses**: (1) an action just completed: *I have just finished my homework.* (2) a past action whose effect is visible now: *He has broken his arm.* (3) experience up to now: *Have you ever visited Agra?* (4) actions that began in the past and continue (with stative verbs, or since/for): *We have lived here since 2015.* (5) with unfinished time periods: *I have read three books this month.*

Key words: just, already, yet, ever, never, so far, recently, lately, today/this week (unfinished), since, for.

IMPORTANT

The present perfect cannot be used with a definite past time: wrong *I have seen him yesterday.* → **I saw him yesterday.** Also wrong: *When have you come?* → **When did you come?** Use the simple past with: yesterday, last week, ago, in 2010, when.

Word	Meaning and use	Example
just	a moment ago	She has just left.
already	earlier than expected (affirmative)	I have already eaten.
yet	until now (negative/question)	Have you finished yet? Not yet.
ever / never	at any time / at no time up to now	Have you ever flown? I have never flown.
so far	up to now	So far we have won two matches.

▸ 4. Present Perfect Continuous

Form: have/has + been + V1+ing. **Uses**: an action that began in the past and is still continuing, or has just stopped with visible result: *She has been studying since morning. It has been raining for two hours. Your eyes are red; have you been crying?*

Key words: since, for, all day, how long, lately, recently.

Word	Use	Examples
since	a point of time (starting point)	since 2010, since Monday, since morning, since he left, since I was a child
for	a period of time (duration)	for two hours, for ten years, for a long time, for ages

IMPORTANT

Wrong: *I am living here since 2010.* → **I have been living / have lived here since 2010.** Never use the present continuous or simple present with 'since/for' for an action continuing up to now.

8.3 Past Tenses

▸ 5. Past Indefinite (Simple Past)

Form: V2; negative: did not + V1; question: Did + subject + V1? **Uses**: (1) completed actions at a definite time in the past: *I visited Udaipur last year.* (2) past habits: *He walked to school every day.* (3) a series of past actions in a story: *She opened the door, entered, and sat down.* (4) states in the past: *He was ill.*

Key words: yesterday, last night/week/year, ago, in 2005, then, once, one day, when (a past event).

IMPORTANT

After 'did / did not' use V1, never V2: *Did you **go**?* (not *went*); *I did not **see** him.* The past of 'be' is was (I/he/she/it) and were (you/we/they): *Was she there? They weren't happy.*

▸ 6. Past Continuous

Form: was/were + V1+ing. **Uses**: (1) action in progress at a stated moment in the past: *At 8 p.m. last night I was watching TV.* (2) a long action interrupted by a short one: *I was crossing the road when a car stopped.* (3) two simultaneous past actions: *While she was cooking, he was laying the table.* (4) setting the scene in a story: *The wind was blowing and the rain was falling.*

Key words: while, when, as, at that time, those days, all day yesterday.

▸ 7. Past Perfect

Form: had + V3. **Uses**: the earlier of two past actions (the 'past of the past'): *The patient had died before the doctor came. When I reached the station, the train had left.* Also in reported speech and in 3rd conditional.

Key words: before, after, by the time, when, as soon as, already, just, till, until.

Earlier past (Past Perfect)	Later past (Simple Past)
had finished	before she came
had left	when I reached
had already eaten	by the time we arrived

> **NOTE**
> With 'after', either tense may be used: *After he had eaten, he left = After he ate, he left*. With 'before': *Before he left, he had locked the door.* The action that happened first takes the past perfect when the sequence is not obvious.

▸ 8. Past Perfect Continuous

Form: had + been + V1+ing. **Use**: an action that had been going on for some time before another past action or time: *She had been reading for two hours when I reached her house. He was tired because he had been working all day.*

Key words: since, for, how long, all day, before.

8.4 Future Tenses

▸ 9. Future Indefinite (Simple Future)

Form: will/shall + V1. **Rule**: in strict grammar 'shall' goes with I/we, 'will' with you/he/she/it/they; to express **determination, promise, threat, command** the order reverses: *You shall have the prize* (promise); *I will not forgive him* (determination); *He shall pay for this* (threat). Today 'will' is used with all persons in ordinary statements. Negative: will not (won't) + V1. Question: Will/Shall + subject + V1?

Uses: (1) simple prediction or fact about the future: *It will rain tomorrow.* (2) decision made at the moment of speaking: *I'll take this one.* (3) promises, offers, requests: *I will help you. Will you open the door?* (4) with 'think/hope/expect/probably'.

Key words: tomorrow, next week/year, soon, tonight, in a few days, by and by, one day.

▸ 10. Future Continuous

Form: will/shall + be + V1+ing. **Uses**: an action in progress at a stated time in the future: *At this time tomorrow, she will be writing her exam.* Also polite enquiry: *Will you be using the car tonight?*

▸ 11. Future Perfect

Form: will/shall + have + V3. **Use**: an action that will be completed before a certain time in the future: *I will have finished the project by Saturday.* **Key words**: by, by the time, before, by then, by next month.

▸ 12. Future Perfect Continuous

Form: will/shall + have + been + V1+ing. **Use**: duration of an action up to a point in the future: *By next June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.* **Key words**: for, since, by next year, when….

8.5 Ways to Express Future Time

Way	Use	Example
will/shall + V1	prediction, decision, promise	I will go to Agra tomorrow.
Present simple	timetable / schedule	What time does the match begin? The train leaves at 5.
Present continuous	fixed arrangement	The Prime Minister is leaving for America next week.
be going to + V1	intention or sure prediction from evidence	I am going to take a bath. Look at the clouds; it is going to rain.
be about to + V1	immediate future	The train is about to arrive.

Way	Use	Example
be to + V1	official plan, command	The President is to address the nation.

8.6 Tense Contrast and Common Confusions

Pair	Difference	Example
Simple past vs Present perfect	Definite finished time vs connection with now	I lost my pen yesterday. / I have lost my pen (I cannot find it now).
Present perfect vs Present perfect continuous	Result/completion vs duration/activity	I have painted the room (it's done). / I have been painting the room (all day).
Past continuous vs Simple past	Action in progress vs completed action	I was reading when he came. / I read the book last week.
Past perfect vs Simple past	Earlier action vs later action	The show had begun when we reached.
Present simple vs Present continuous	Habit/fact vs now	She sings well. / She is singing now.

IMPORTANT

Common errors: (1) *He is working here since 2012* → **has been working**. (2) *I have seen the film yesterday* → **saw**. (3) *If it will rain, we will stay* → **If it rains**. (4) *She told that she is ill* (past report) → **that she was ill**. (5) *He didn't went* → **didn't go**. (6) *The train has left before I reached* → **had left**. (7) *I am knowing him* → **I know him**. (8) *When did you come? I have come yesterday.* → **I came yesterday.**

8.7 How to Identify and Change the Tense (Method)

Step 1 — Read the whole passage
Decide the general time (present, past, future). A narration of events is usually past; facts and habits are present.

Step 2 — Find the signal words
yesterday, ago, last → past; since, for, just, already → perfect; now, these days → continuous; tomorrow, next → future.

Step 3 — Pick the aspect
Habit → indefinite; in progress → continuous; completed with link to now/another time → perfect; duration → perfect continuous.

Step 4 — Check the helping verb
do/does/did + V1; am/is/are/was/were + V-ing; has/have/had + V3; will/shall + V1.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Twelve tenses = 3 times (present, past, future) × 4 aspects (indefinite, continuous, perfect, perfect continuous).
- Use do/does/did + V1 in negatives and questions of the simple tenses; never add -s or -ed after them.
- Present perfect links past with now and never takes a definite past time (yesterday, ago).
- Since = point of time; for = period; both use perfect continuous / perfect.
- Past perfect shows the earlier of two past actions; in time and if-clauses use the present for the future.

CHAPTER 09 · CONCORD · CLASSES 5–8

Subject-Verb Agreement

A verb must agree with its subject in number (singular or plural) and person. This is called concord. Most errors in editing exercises arise from wrongly identifying the real subject, which may be hidden behind a phrase, a collective noun, or a joining word like 'or' or 'along with'. This chapter lists every rule you need.

9.1 The Basic Rule

NOTE

Grade guide: Classes 5–6: basic rule, is/are, has/have, don't/doesn't, there is/are, each/every. Classes 7–8: all rules 3–17 including nouns plural in form, either/or, as well as, titles, quantity, relative clauses and 'one of'.

A **singular subject** takes a **singular verb**; a **plural subject** takes a **plural verb**. In the present simple the singular verb ends in -s/-es (*he runs*); the plural does not (*they run*). For 'be': I **am**, he/she/it **is**, you/we/they **are**; past: I/he/she/it **was**, you/we/they **were**. For 'have': he/she/it **has**, others **have**; 'do/does'.

Singular	Plural
The boy plays football.	The boys **play** football.
She has a pen.	They **have** pens.
The dog was barking.	The dogs **were** barking.
He doesn't know.	They **don't** know.

9.2 Rules of Agreement

▸ Rule 1 — Find the real subject (ignore the words between)

A phrase between the subject and verb does not change the number. *The **box** of apples **is** heavy. The **quality** of these mangoes **is** poor. The **students** in the hall **are** waiting.*

▸ Rule 2 — Two subjects joined by 'and' take a plural verb

*Ram and Shyam **are** friends. Reading and writing **are** skills.*

Exceptions — a singular verb when 'and' joins two names for **one person/thing** or a **single idea**: *The poet and philosopher **was** honoured.* (one person) *Bread and butter **is** my breakfast. Slow and steady **wins** the race. Rice and curry **is** a favourite dish.* With **each/every/no** before both nouns: *Every boy and girl **has** a book. No man and no woman **was** present.*

▸ Rule 3 — Subjects joined by 'as well as', 'along with', 'together with', 'with', 'in addition to', 'besides', 'no less than', 'rather than'

The verb agrees with the **first** subject: *The teacher, along with the students, **is** going. Rita, as well as her sisters, **was** present. The boys, together with their coach, **have** gone.*

▸ Rule 4 — 'Or', 'nor', 'either…or', 'neither…nor'

The verb agrees with the **nearer** subject: *Either the teacher or the students **are** wrong. Neither the students nor the teacher **is** present. Neither he nor I **am** guilty.* If possible place the plural subject nearer to the verb.

▸ Rule 5 — Each, every, either, neither, one, anyone, someone, everybody, nobody

Always singular: *Each of the girls **has** a doll. Every student **was** present. Either of the two **is** correct. Neither of them **knows**. Everyone **is** here. Nobody **was** hurt. One of my friends **lives** in Pune.* After 'each' the noun is plural but the verb is singular: *Each of the boys* (plural boys) *has*.

▸ Rule 6 — Collective nouns

If the group is considered as a **unit**, use a singular verb: *The team **is** winning. The committee **has** decided. The jury **is** united.* If members are thought of as **individuals**, use a plural verb: *The jury **were** divided in their opinions. The family **are** having their meals.* (Indian exam books prefer singular unless clearly individual.)

▸ Rule 7 — Nouns plural in form but singular in meaning

News, mathematics, physics, economics, politics, ethics, measles, mumps, billiards, athletics, innings, gallows, Wales, the United States, the Philippines (as a country) take a **singular** verb: *The news **is** true. Mathematics **is** my favourite subject. Measles **is** a disease.*

▸ Rule 8 — Nouns always plural

Scissors, trousers, jeans, spectacles, pants, clothes, pliers, tongs, shorts, binoculars, goods, belongings, thanks, riches, savings, earnings, cattle, police, people take a **plural** verb: *My trousers **are** torn. The police **have** arrived. Cattle **are** grazing.* But *a pair of trousers **is*** on the bed (the pair is singular).

▸ Rule 9 — 'A number of' and 'the number of'

*A number of students **are** absent* (= many; plural). *The number of students **is** small* (= the total; singular). Similarly: *a variety of* (plural), *the variety of* (singular); *a majority of* (plural), *the majority of the class* (usually plural).

▸ Rule 10 — 'One of', 'each of', 'none of'

*One of the boys **is** absent* (verb agrees with 'one'). *Each of the books **is** new. None of the boys **is/are** guilty* (singular is formal, plural is also accepted when it means 'not any'). *None of the milk **was** spilt* (uncountable, singular).

▸ Rule 11 — Relative pronouns who, which, that

The verb agrees with the **antecedent**: *He is one of the boys who **are** punctual.* (who → boys: plural). *He is the only one of the boys who **is** punctual.* (who → one). *I, who **am** your friend, will help you.* (who → I, so 'am').

▸ Rule 12 — Amounts, distance, weight, time, money considered as a whole

They take a **singular verb**: *Ten kilometres **is** a long distance. Fifty rupees **is** not enough. Two years **is** a short time. Five kilos **is** too heavy.* But when the individual units are meant: *Ten rupee notes **were** counted.*

▸ Rule 13 — Fractions and 'of' phrases

The verb agrees with the noun after 'of': *Half of the cake **is** left. Half of the cakes **are** left. Two-thirds of the land **is** barren. 30% of students **have** passed. A lot of money **is** wasted. A lot of people **are** waiting.* Same for *all of, some of, most of, the rest of, plenty of, a lot of, lots of*.

▸ Rule 14 — 'There is / There are' and 'Here is / Here are'

The verb agrees with the noun that follows: *There **is** a book on the table. There **are** three books. Here **comes** the bus. There **was** a boy and a girl* (first noun; in careful writing, 'there were').

▸ Rule 15 — Titles, names of books, newspapers, organisations

Take a singular verb: *'Gulliver's Travels' **is** an interesting book. The Times of India **is** a newspaper. The Arabian Nights **is** a classic. The United Nations **was** founded in 1945. Tom and Jerry **is** a cartoon.*

▸ Rule 16 — The pronoun 'you'

Always takes a plural verb: *You **are** my friend. You **were** right.* Even for one person.

▸ Rule 17 — Words like 'pair', 'dozen', 'series', 'means', 'species', 'headquarters'

*A pair of shoes **is** missing. The means of transport **is** poor (a means = singular). This species **is** rare. The headquarters **is** in Delhi. A series of events **has** occurred. Two dozen eggs **are** needed.*

9.3 Quick Reference Tables

Subject	Verb	Example
each, every, either, neither, one, anyone, everybody	singular	Everybody is happy.

Subject	Verb	Example
news, mathematics, physics, economics, measles	singular	Physics is interesting.
scissors, trousers, police, cattle, people	plural	The police are here.
A and B (two things/persons)	plural	Ram and Mohan are twins.
A or B / neither A nor B	agree with nearer	Neither Ram nor his friends are going.
A as well as B / A along with B	agree with A	Ram as well as his friends is going.
a number of	plural	A number of boys are absent.
the number of	singular	The number of boys is large.
a lot of / some / all + uncountable	singular	All the water is dirty.
a lot of / some / all + plural	plural	All the books are old.
measurement, money, time as a whole	singular	Ten miles is far.

IMPORTANT

Common mistakes: (1) *The price of vegetables have gone up* → **has**. (2) *Each of the students have a book* → **has**. (3) *The news were shocking* → **was**. (4) *Neither of the answers are correct* → **is**. (5) *My brother, along with his friends, are coming* → **is**. (6) *Mathematics are difficult* → **is**. (7) *There is two chairs* → **are**. (8) *A number of reasons is given* → **are**. (9) *The scissors is blunt* → **are**. (10) *One of my friends are ill* → **is**.

★ **KEY TAKEAWAYS**

- The verb must agree with the real subject, not the nearest noun in a phrase.
- Each, every, either, neither, everyone, nobody, and nouns like news and mathematics take a singular verb.
- With or/nor use the nearer subject; with as well as/along with/with use the first subject.
- 'A number of' is plural; 'the number of' is singular.
- In 'one of those who…', the verb is plural; in 'the only one who…', it is singular.

CHAPTER 10 · VERBS

Modals: Can, May, Must, Should and Their Friends

Modals are small helping verbs that add a 'mood' to the main verb: ability, permission, possibility, duty, advice, request, promise or habit. They never change their form, they are followed by the base form of the verb, and a single wrong modal can change the whole meaning of a sentence.

10.1 What Is a Modal?

DEFINITION

A **modal auxiliary verb** (modal) is a helping verb that shows ability, permission, possibility, necessity, advice, request or a similar idea about the action of the main verb.

The modals are: **can, could, may, might, will, would, shall, should, must, ought to**. Also used as modals (semi-modals) are **need, dare, used to** and **have to**.

▸ Five rules that never change

1. A modal is followed by the **base form** (V1) of the verb, without *to* (except *ought to*, *used to*, *have to*): *She can sing.* (not *can sings*, not *can to sing*).
2. A modal has **no -s/-es** in the third person: *He must go.* (not *musts*).
3. A modal has **no -ing or -ed form** and no infinitive: we cannot say *to can*. We use *to be able to* instead.
4. Questions are made by **placing the modal before the subject**, and negatives by adding *not* after it: *Can you swim? You cannot (can't) swim.* We do not use do/does/did with modals.
5. Two modals cannot be used together: *He will can come* is wrong; write *He will be able to come.*

IMPORTANT

Structure: **Subject + modal + base verb (V1) + rest**. Example: *Students should respect their teachers.*

Modal	Negative short form	Main ideas it expresses
can	cannot / can't	ability, informal permission, possibility
could	couldn't	past ability, polite request, weak possibility
may	may not	formal permission, possibility, wish
might	might not / mightn't	slight possibility, past of *may* in reported speech
will	won't	future, promise, willingness, request
would	wouldn't	polite request, past habit, conditional
shall	shan't	future with I/we, offer, suggestion, command/promise
should	shouldn't	advice, duty, expectation
ought to	oughtn't to	moral duty, strong advice
must	mustn't	necessity, strong obligation, prohibition, logical certainty
need	needn't	no necessity (negative/question use)
dare	daren't	courage to do something
used to	didn't use to	past habits and past states

10.2 Can and Could

▸ Uses of can

- **Ability (present):** *Ria can solve difficult sums.*
- **Informal permission:** *You can go out and play now.*
- **Possibility / capability:** *The road can get very slippery in the rains.*
- **Request (informal):** *Can you lend me your pen?*

▸ Uses of could

- **Past ability:** *When I was five, I could ride a tricycle.*
- **Polite request:** *Could you please open the window?* (more polite than *can*)
- **Weak possibility:** *It could rain by evening.*
- **Suggestion:** *You could ask your teacher for help.*

> **NOTE**
> For **one particular occasion in the past** use *was/were able to* (or *managed to*), not *could*: *The firemen were able to rescue all the children.* Use *could* for general ability: *She could swim well even as a child.*

▸ To be able to

Can has no future or perfect forms, so we borrow **be able to**: *I will be able to join you tomorrow. He has been able to read since the age of four.*

10.3 May and Might

- **Formal permission:** *May I come in, sir?* (asking) / *You may leave now.* (giving)
- **Possibility (about 50 per cent):** *It may rain tomorrow.*
- **Slighter possibility:** *She might be at home, but I am not sure.*
- **Wish or blessing (formal):** *May you live long! May God bless you!*
- **Purpose in a clause:** *He works hard so that he may succeed.*

Modal	Present idea	Example
may	fairly possible	He may win the race.
might	just possible / doubtful	He might win, but the other boys are faster.

> **IMPORTANT**
> **Can vs may for permission.** *Can I go?* is acceptable in speech, but *May I go?* is the correct, polite form in school and formal writing. Teachers expect *May I…?*

10.4 Will, Would and Shall

▸ Simple future

Traditional rule: **shall** with *I/we*, **will** with *you/he/she/it/they*. In modern use *will* is also common with *I/we*, but board papers still test the traditional rule, so learn it.

Person	Simple future (plain statement)	Command / promise / determination / threat
I, we	I **shall** go to Delhi tomorrow.	I **will** not give up. (determination)
you	You **will** pass the test.	You **shall** have a prize. (promise)
he, she, it, they	He **will** come soon.	He **shall** be punished. (threat/command)

REMEMBER

To show **determination, promise or threat**, the rule is reversed: *will* for I/we and *shall* for you/he/she/they. Example: *I will win this match* (determination); *You shall not pass* (command).

▸ Other uses

- **Shall I / Shall we** for offers and suggestions: *Shall I carry your bag? Shall we begin?*
- **Will you / Would you** for requests: *Will you please close the door? Would you mind waiting?*
- **Willingness:** *I will help you.*
- **Habit in the past with would:** *Every summer we would visit our grandparents.*
- **Polite wish with would:** *I would like a glass of water.*
- **Would in reported speech** as the past of *will*: *He said he would come.*

10.5 Should and Ought to

- **Advice:** *You should drink more water.*
- **Duty / moral obligation:** *We ought to help the poor. Children should obey their parents.*
- **Expectation:** *The train should arrive at 6 p.m.*
- **Negative advice:** *You shouldn't waste food. You ought not to tell lies.*

NOTE

Ought to is followed by *to + V1*, and its negative is **ought not to** (rare: *oughtn't to*). *Should* is followed by V1 only.

10.6 Must and Have to

- **Necessity from the speaker's own feeling:** *I must finish this project today.*
- **Strong obligation or rule:** *Students must wear uniform.*
- **Prohibition (mustn't):** *You mustn't cross the road at a red light.*
- **Logical certainty:** *He is not answering; he must be asleep.*

	must	have to / has to / had to
Source of duty	Speaker's feeling or a strong rule	External rule or circumstance
Example	I must call my mother.	I have to wear glasses to read.
Past	No past form: use *had to*	He had to stay back.
Future	No future form: use *will have to*	We will have to leave early.
Negative meaning	*mustn't* = it is forbidden	*don't have to* = it is not necessary

IMPORTANT

mustn't ≠ don't have to. *You mustn't smoke here* = it is forbidden. *You don't have to come on Sunday* = you may come, but it is not needed.

10.7 Need and Dare

- As a **modal** (in questions and negatives, with no -s): *You needn't worry. Need I go? He daren't speak to the principal.*
- As an **ordinary verb** (with do/does, and *to*): *I need to buy a notebook. He does not need to come. Do they dare to climb that rock?*
- **Needn't** means 'it is not necessary': *You needn't bring lunch; it will be provided.*
- **Dare** shows courage: *How dare you speak like that? I dare say* = I think it probable.

10.8 Used to

Used to + V1 shows a **past habit** or a **past state that no longer exists**: *We used to play cricket every evening. There used to be a pond here.* The negative and question are made with *did*: *Did you use to…? I didn't use to…*

Structure	Meaning	Example
used to + V1	past habit (now stopped)	She used to walk to school.
be used to + V-ing/noun	be accustomed to	She is used to walking long distances.
get used to + V-ing	become accustomed	I am getting used to the cold.

> **NOTE**
> In *be used to* and *get used to*, the word **to is a preposition**, so it is followed by a noun or an -ing form, never V1.

10.9 Modals in the Past

To talk about the past, a modal is followed by **have + V3** (past participle). This is a favourite Class 8 topic.

Pattern	Meaning	Example
could have + V3	was able to, but did not	I could have won, but I fell.
should have + V3	right thing not done (regret/criticism)	You should have told me earlier.
shouldn't have + V3	wrong thing was done	He shouldn't have shouted.
might / may have + V3	possible past event	She may have missed the bus.
must have + V3	logical certainty about the past	It must have rained last night; the road is wet.
needn't have + V3	did something that was not necessary	You needn't have brought a gift.
would have + V3	result in an unreal past (3rd conditional)	If I had known, I would have come.

10.10 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct	Reason
He can sings well.	He can sing well.	Base form after a modal
She musts go.	She must go.	No -s with modals
You should to rest.	You should rest.	No *to* after should
Do you can swim?	Can you swim?	No do/does with modals
I will can do it.	I will be able to do it.	Two modals cannot be used together
He didn't could come.	He couldn't come.	Modal already shows tense
You mustn't come tomorrow; it is a holiday. (meaning not necessary)	You don't have to come tomorrow.	mustn't = forbidden
I am used to wake up early.	I am used to waking up early.	to is a preposition here
You ought to went.	You ought to go.	V1 after ought to
I will go to Jaipur tomorrow. (plain future)	I shall go to Jaipur tomorrow.	Plain future: shall with I/we (traditional rule)

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- A modal is followed by V1, has no -s, no -ing/-ed, and forms questions by inversion (never with do/does).
- Can = ability/informal permission; could = past ability/polite request; may = formal permission/possibility; might = slight possibility.
- Shall with I/we and will with others for plain future; reverse them for determination, promise, threat.
- Should/ought to = advice and duty; must = strong obligation or certainty; have to = external duty; mustn't = forbidden; needn't = not necessary.
- Used to + V1 = past habit; be/get used to + V-ing = accustomed.
- Past modals: modal + have + V3 (should have, could have, must have).

CHAPTER 11 · VERBS

Non-finites: Infinitive, Gerund and Participle

A finite verb changes with the subject, person and tense (He tries, they tried). A non-finite verb does not. It is a verb form that works as a noun, adjective or adverb: to try, trying, tried. These forms are the building blocks of many sentences and a regular exam topic.

11.1 Finite and Non-finite Verbs

DEFINITION

A **finite verb** is limited by number, person and tense. A **non-finite verb** is **not** limited by these; it has no subject of its own. The three non-finites are the **infinitive**, the **gerund** and the **participle**.

Finite (changes)	Non-finite (same form)
He always tries to find an easy way.	He always tries **to find** an easy way.
They always try to find an easy way.	They always try **to find** an easy way.
He always tried to find an easy way.	He always tried **to find** an easy way.

In all three sentences *to find* stays the same, while *tries / try / tried* changes. So *to find* is non-finite and *tries/try/tried* are finite.

Non-finite	Form	Works as	Example
Infinitive	to + V1 (or V1 alone)	noun / adverb (purpose) / adjective	To err is human. I came to learn.
Gerund	V-ing	noun	Swimming is a good exercise.
Present participle	V-ing	adjective (active, ongoing)	a **calculating** machine, a **running** horse
Past participle	V3	adjective (passive, completed)	a **crashed** aircraft, a **broken** window

11.2 The Infinitive

▸ Two kinds

- **Full (to-) infinitive:** *to + base verb*. *I want to read.*
- **Bare infinitive:** base verb **without to**. *I can read.*

▸ Uses of the to-infinitive

- **Subject:** *To teach is to learn twice.*
- **Object of a verb:** *She wants to become a doctor.*
- **Purpose (adverbial):** *I went to the post office to post a letter.* (answers 'why?'; can also be *in order to / so as to*)
- **After adjectives:** *The water is safe to drink. He is eager to win.*
- **After nouns:** *I have a lot of work to do.*
- **After question words:** *I do not know what to say.*

▸ Bare infinitive (without to) is used after

- **Modals:** *can, could, may, might, will, would, shall, should, must — You must go.*
- **Verbs of perception** (see, hear, watch, feel, notice) with an object: *I saw him cross the road.*
- **let, make, help (help may take either):** *Let me go. The teacher made us sit. She helped me (to) finish.*
- **had better, would rather, rather than, why not:** *You had better leave. I would rather stay.*

- **do/does/did:** *She does not like tea.*

> **IMPORTANT**
> In the **passive**, the *to* comes back: *He made me **laugh**. → I was made **to laugh**. We saw him enter. → He was seen **to enter**.*

11.3 The Gerund

> **DEFINITION**
> A **gerund** is the **-ing form of a verb that does the work of a noun.** Because it is a noun, it can be a subject, an object or the object of a preposition.

- **Subject:** *Swimming is a good exercise. Reading improves vocabulary.*
- **Object of a verb:** *She enjoys singing.*
- **Object of a preposition:** *He is fond of drawing. She left without saying goodbye.*
- **Complement:** *My hobby is collecting stamps.*
- **After a possessive:** *I did not like his shouting.* (his = possessive before gerund)

▸ Verbs and expressions followed by a gerund

Group	Examples
Verbs followed only by -ing	enjoy, avoid, finish, mind, practise, suggest, deny, admit, delay, postpone, risk, consider, imagine, keep, resist, miss
Verb + preposition + -ing	insist on, look forward to, depend on, think of, succeed in, apologise for, object to, be afraid of, be fond of, be tired of
Fixed phrases	can't help, it is no use, it is worth, there is no point in, be busy, feel like, cannot stand, be used to

11.4 The Participle

> **DEFINITION**
> A **participle** is a verb form that **does the work of an adjective**. It describes a noun or pronoun.

▸ Present participle (V1 + ing)

- Shows an **action going on** or the active quality: *a barking dog; a smiling baby; the rising sun*.
- Starts a participle phrase: ***Walking** along the road, I met an old friend.*

▸ Past participle (V3)

- Shows a **finished or passive** sense: *a locked door; a fallen leaf; a tired man*.
- Starts a phrase: ***Written** in simple language, the book was popular.*

▸ Perfect participle (having + V3)

Shows that one action was **completed before another**: ***Having finished** his homework, Aman went to play.* (= After he had finished…)

11.5 Gerund or Participle? Telling Them Apart

	Gerund	Present participle
Function	Noun	Adjective (or part of a continuous tense)
Test	Can be replaced by *it/this/something*	Describes a noun
Example	Swimming is fun. → It is fun.	I saw a swimming duck. (duck swims)

	Gerund	Present participle
Compound	a **swimming** pool = a pool for swimming (purpose)	a **swimming** girl = a girl who is swimming

11.6 Infinitive or Gerund After a Verb?

Verb	Followed by to-infinitive	Followed by gerund
want, hope, wish, decide, plan, promise, refuse, learn, manage, agree, offer, afford, expect, tend	*I want to go.*	—
enjoy, avoid, finish, mind, suggest, deny, practise, give up, keep	—	*I enjoy going.*
like, love, hate, prefer, begin, start, continue	*I like to swim* (a particular occasion)	*I like swimming* (in general); both are usually acceptable

▸ Verbs that change meaning

Verb	+ to-infinitive	+ gerund
remember	Remember **to lock** the door. (do not forget to)	I remember **locking** it. (recall the past act)
forget	I forgot **to post** the letter. (did not do it)	I shall never forget **meeting** her. (recall)
stop	He stopped **to drink** water. (stopped in order to)	He stopped **drinking** water. (quit the act)
try	Try **to reach** early. (make an effort)	Try **adding** salt. (experiment)
regret	I regret **to inform** you… (sorry to say)	I regret **saying** that. (feel sorry about the past)

11.7 ‘To’ as a Preposition or as an Infinitive Marker

Sometimes *to* is not part of an infinitive but a **preposition**, and then a **gerund (V-ing)** follows. Check by asking whether you can put a noun after *to*.

Preposition *to* + noun/-ing	Infinitive *to* + V1
I look forward to meeting you. (→ to the meeting)	I want **to meet** you.
He is used to getting up early.	He used **to get** up early.
She objects to wearing a uniform.	She decided **to wear** it.
We are committed to winning.	We hope **to win**.

11.9 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct	Rule
He enjoys to play.	He enjoys playing.	*enjoy* takes a gerund
I want going out.	I want to go out.	*want* takes to-infinitive
She can to dance.	She can dance.	bare infinitive after modal
I am looking forward to meet you.	…to meeting you.	*to* is a preposition
He is good in sing.	He is good at singing.	preposition + gerund
I saw him to go.	I saw him go.	bare infinitive after perception verbs

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Non-finites (infinitive, gerund, participle) are not limited by person, number or tense.
- Infinitive = to + V1 (noun/adverb of purpose); bare infinitive after modals, let, make, perception verbs.
- Gerund = V-ing as a noun; it follows prepositions and verbs such as enjoy, avoid, finish, mind.
- Participle = adjective: present (V-ing, active), past (V3, passive), perfect (having + V3).
- ‘to’ before an -ing form (look forward to, used to, object to) is a preposition.
- Remember/forget/stop/try/regret change meaning with infinitive vs gerund; passive brings back ‘to’ after make/see.

CHAPTER 12 · WORDS

Prepositions: Linking Words that Show Relationship

A preposition is a small word with a big job: it tells us where, when, how or by whom. Most mistakes happen because a wrong preposition has been learnt or because English chooses a preposition by custom, not logic. This chapter gives you both the rules and a long list of fixed combinations.

12.1 What Is a Preposition?

DEFINITION

A **preposition** is a word placed before a noun, pronoun or gerund (its **object**) to show its relation to some other word in the sentence.

*The book is **on** the table. She came **after** lunch. He is afraid **of** dogs.* A preposition is followed by a noun, a pronoun in the **objective case** (*me, him, her, us, them*), or a gerund (V-ing): *between you and **me**; interested in **reading***.

IMPORTANT

Never use a verb after a preposition in its base form. *She is good at **drawing** (not draw).*

▸ Kinds of prepositions

Kind	Meaning	Examples
Simple	one word	in, on, at, by, for, with, of, to, from, up, down
Compound	preposition + another word	about, across, along, among, around, before, behind, beside, between, beyond, inside, outside, within, without, underneath
Phrase prepositions	group of words acting as one	because of, in front of, in spite of, on behalf of, according to, instead of, owing to, in place of, by means of, with regard to
Participle prepositions	-ing forms that act as prepositions	during, regarding, concerning, considering, following, including, barring

12.2 Prepositions of Place and Position

Preposition	Use	Example
in	inside a space, city, country	in the room, in Jaipur, in India, in a box, in the sky
on	on a surface; touching	on the table, on the wall, on the floor, on the bus, on the second floor
at	a point or specific place	at the bus stop, at the gate, at school, at the door, at home, at 10 Main Road
under / below / beneath	lower than	under the chair; below the bridge; the sun sank below the horizon
over / above	higher than (over may touch or cover)	a fan above the bed; a lamp over the table; he put a shawl over his shoulders
between / among	two / more than two	between you and me; among the trees
beside / next to / by	at the side of	She sits beside me. The house stands by the river.
in front of / behind	front / back	The car is in front of the gate.
near / opposite	close to / facing	near the temple; the bank is opposite the school

Preposition	Use	Example
inside / outside	within / not within	inside the house; outside the gate

In, on or at (place)

- **at** = a point: *at the station, at the corner, at the cinema*.
- **on** = a surface or a line: *on the wall, on the road, on the border, on the river bank*.
- **in** = an enclosed area: *in a town, in the garden, in a car, in a village*.
- Say **in** a car/taxi, but **on** a bus/train/plane/bicycle/horse. We **arrive at** a small place (the station, school) and **arrive in** a city or country.

12.3 Prepositions of Time

Preposition	Used with	Example
at	clock time, festivals, night, noon, midnight	at 5 o'clock, at noon, at night, at Diwali, at dawn
on	days and dates	on Monday, on 15 August, on my birthday, on New Year's Day, on Sunday morning
in	months, years, seasons, centuries, parts of the day	in June, in 2025, in summer, in the 21st century, in the morning/afternoon/evening
since	point of time (start)	since 2020, since Monday, since morning
for	period of time (length)	for two years, for an hour, for a long time
from … to / till	start and end	from 9 a.m. to 3 p.m.; open till 8 p.m.
by	not later than	Submit the form by Friday.
until / till	up to that time	Wait until I return.
before / after	earlier / later	before breakfast; after school
during	within a period	during the holidays; during the match
within	inside a time limit	within a week; within an hour
ago	back from now	two years ago

IMPORTANT

Since = point of time (since 2019); **for** = period of time (for six years). Both are used with the present perfect: *He has lived here since 2019 / for six years.*

IMPORTANT

By vs until. *By* means 'at or before' a time (action completed by then). *Until* means 'continuing up to' that time. *Finish by 5. Work until 5.*

No preposition is used before **last, next, this, every, each, one, some, any, all** with time words: *He came **last** Monday. I will meet you **next** week. We go **every** summer.*

12.4 Prepositions of Direction and Movement

Preposition	Meaning	Example
to	towards a destination	She went to school. Give it to me.
into	from outside to inside	He jumped into the pool.

Preposition	Meaning	Example
onto	to a surface	The cat jumped onto the wall.
from	starting point	I came from Kota.
towards	in the direction of	He walked towards the gate.
through	from one side to the other inside something	The train passed through a tunnel.
across	from one side to the other on the surface	She swam across the river.
along	in a line beside	We strolled along the beach.
up / down	higher / lower	up the hill; down the stairs
over	from one side to the other, above	The horse jumped over the fence.
round / around	circular	The Earth moves round the Sun.
past	beyond	He walked past the shop.

> **NOTE**
> **Into** shows movement; **in** shows position. *He is **in** the room* (position). *He came **into** the room* (movement). Also: **at** is for a point, **to** is for destination: *We reached **at** the station* is wrong; write *reached the station*.

12.5 Prepositions of Agent, Instrument and Manner

Preposition	Use	Example
by	doer in the passive	The poem was written by Tagore.
by	means of transport or communication	by bus, by train, by post, by email
with	instrument or company	He cut the apple with a knife. She came with her mother.
with / without	manner, possession	a girl with long hair; a house without a garden
of	belonging, material, part	the cover of the book; a cup of tea; a member of the club
for	purpose, beneficiary	a gift for you; a bat for cricket
about / on	subject of a talk or book	a book about birds; a lecture on pollution
like / as	likeness / role	She sings like a nightingale. He works as a pilot.

12.6 Commonly Confused Prepositions

Pair	Difference	Example
between / among	between = two (or clear individuals); among = three or more as a group	Divide the sweets **between** the two girls; **among** the children.
beside / besides	beside = next to; besides = in addition to	She sat **beside** me. **Besides** English, he knows French.
in / into	position / movement	in the room / into the room
on / upon / onto	surface / formal / movement to a surface	on the table; the cat jumped onto the table
to / till	destination / up to a time	to school; till evening
since / for	point / period	since 9 / for 3 hours

Pair	Difference	Example
by / with	doer or means / instrument	written by him / written with a pen
at / in (time)	clock moment / long period	at six / in summer
above / over	higher than / covering or crossing	birds above the trees; a bridge over the river
till / by	continuing up to / before	stay till 6 / come by 6
about / around	approximately / surrounding	about 20 students; around the house
during / while	during + noun; while + clause	during the interval; while we were waiting

12.7 Dependent Prepositions (Fixed Combinations)

Many words are always followed by a particular preposition. Learn them in groups. This is the most scoring part of the chapter.

▸ Adjective + preposition

Preposition	Words that take it
of	afraid of, fond of, proud of, jealous of, capable of, full of, tired of, aware of, certain of, guilty of
at	good at, bad at, clever at, quick at, expert at, skilled at, surprised at, angry at (a thing), shocked at, laugh at
in	interested in, rich in, weak in, deficient in, confident in, successful in, engaged in, absorbed in, lacking in, experienced in
with	angry with (a person), pleased with, satisfied with, bored with, busy with, familiar with, popular with, crowded with, content with, happy with
to	kind to, rude to, polite to, cruel to, loyal to, grateful to, similar to, equal to, harmful to, useful to
for	famous for, responsible for, sorry for, ready for, eager for, fit for, suitable for, late for, hungry for, thankful for
from	different from, free from, absent from, safe from, far from, distinct from, exempt from, divorced from, protected from
about	anxious about, careful about, certain about, worried about, serious about, glad about, enthusiastic about, curious about
on	keen on, dependent on, intent on, based on, focused on, hard on, bent on

▸ Verb + preposition

Verb	Preposition and example
agree	agree **with** a person; agree **to** a plan; agree **on** a point
apologise	apologise **to** someone **for** a mistake
argue	argue **with** a friend **about** a topic
arrive	arrive **at** a station; arrive **in** a city
ask	ask **for** help; ask **about** a matter
blame	blame him **for** the loss; the loss is blamed **on** him
borrow	borrow **from** a friend
care	care **for** (like); care **about** (be concerned)
complain	complain **to** the teacher **about** the noise

Verb	Preposition and example
congratulate	congratulate her **on** her success
depend	depend **on** your effort
die	die **of** a disease; die **from** an accident
divide	divide **into** parts; divide **between/among**
explain	explain **to** someone
fight	fight **with/against** an enemy; fight **for** a cause
hope	hope **for** the best
insist	insist **on** payment
laugh	laugh **at** someone (mock); laugh **with** (share joy)
listen	listen **to** music
prevent	prevent him **from** going
pray	pray **to** God **for** peace
prefer	prefer tea **to** coffee
protect	protect **from/against** danger
search	search **for** a lost key
smile	smile **at** a person
spend	spend money **on** books
suffer	suffer **from** fever
wait	wait **for** a bus
warn	warn him **of/against** danger
wonder	wonder **at** the sight

▸ Noun + preposition

Noun	Preposition
a cause / reason	cause **of** the fire; reason **for** the delay
demand, need	demand **for**, need **for/of**
answer / reply	answer **to** a question; reply **to** a letter
love, hatred, respect	love **for** nature, respect **for** elders
interest	interest **in** music
effect, influence	effect **on** health; influence **over/on**
key, solution	key **to** the lock; solution **to** the problem
difficulty	difficulty **in** reading
admission, entrance	admission **to** a school
attack, invitation	attack **on** the camp; invitation **to** a party
ability, talent	ability **in/for** drawing

Noun	Preposition
increase / decrease	increase **in** prices

IMPORTANT

Prepositions with participles. *Be pleased with, be surprised at, be interested in, be satisfied with, be known for / as / to, be tired of / from, be annoyed with/at, be covered with, be married to.* Examples: *The hill is covered **with** snow. Kota is known **for** coaching. He is known **to** the police.*

12.8 Preposition at the End and Other Fine Points

- A preposition can come at the end in **questions and relative clauses**: *Who are you talking to? That is the girl I spoke to.* Formally: *To whom are you talking?*
- After a preposition use the **objective case**: *between you and me* (never *between you and I*).
- Do not use a **preposition with** words that already carry the idea: *discuss the matter* (not *discuss about*), *enter the room* (not *enter into the room*), *reach Delhi* (not *reach to*), *attack the fort* (not *attack on the fort*), *marry her* (not *marry with her*), *order him* (not *order to him*).
- Some prepositions disappear in expressions of time: *this morning, last night, next week, every day*.
- Omit *to* before *home*: *He went home.* but *He went to his home town.*

12.9 Class-wise Guide

Class	Learn
5–6	in/on/at (place and time), into/onto, under/over/above/below, between/among, simple dependent prepositions (afraid of, good at, listen to, wait for).
7	since/for, by/until, beside/besides, during/within, adjective + preposition list, verb + preposition list, phrase prepositions.
8	All dependent prepositions, noun + preposition, easily confused pairs, prepositions in editing/gap-filling passages, ‘omit unnecessary prepositions’.

12.10 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct
He is good in Maths.	He is good at Maths.
She is fond for music.	She is fond of music.
I am waiting you.	I am waiting for you.
He is married with a doctor.	He is married to a doctor.
We discussed about the plan.	We discussed the plan.
He lives from 2010 in Jaipur.	He has lived in Jaipur since 2010.
I have been ill since three days.	I have been ill for three days.
She sat besides me.	She sat beside me.
He is senior than me.	He is senior to me.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- A preposition is followed by a noun, an objective pronoun or a gerund — never a bare verb.
- At = point, on = surface, in = enclosed space; at = clock time, on = day/date, in = month/year/season.
- Since = point of time; for = period; by = not later than; until = continuing up to.
- Between = two; among = more than two; beside = next to; besides = in addition to; into/onto show movement.
- Learn dependent prepositions in groups (good at, fond of, interested in, kind to, famous for, different from).
- Do not add prepositions after discuss, reach, enter, marry, attack; prefer X to Y; senior/junior to.

CHAPTER 13 · SENTENCES

Conjunctions and Connectors

Conjunctions join words, phrases and clauses; connectors (linkers) go a step further and carry the logic of a whole passage: contrast, cause, result, sequence. Good connectors are the difference between a list of short sentences and a well-written paragraph.

13.1 What Is a Conjunction?

DEFINITION

A **conjunction** is a word that **joins** words, phrases or clauses. *Ram **and** Shyam are friends. I was tired **but** I finished the work.*

Kind	What it does	Examples
Coordinating	joins things of equal rank (words, phrases, main clauses)	and, but, or, nor, for, so, yet
Subordinating	joins a dependent clause to a main clause	because, although, if, unless, when, while, since, as, that, till, until, before, after, whether, so that, as soon as
Correlative	work in pairs	both … and, either … or, neither … nor, not only … but also, whether … or, no sooner … than, hardly … when, so … that, such … that

13.2 Coordinating Conjunctions (FANBOYS)

Conjunction	Meaning	Example
for	reason	He went to bed early, for he was tired.
and	addition	She sang and danced.
nor	negative addition	He neither smiled nor spoke.
but	contrast	I called him, but he did not answer.
or	choice / otherwise	Hurry up, or you will be late.
yet	contrast (surprising)	It was raining, yet she went out.
so	result	It was late, so we left.

IMPORTANT

Put a **comma before** a coordinating conjunction that joins two full clauses: *I wanted to go, but it rained.* No comma when it joins two words: *tea and coffee*.

13.3 Subordinating Conjunctions by Meaning

Idea	Conjunctions	Example
Time	when, while, as, before, after, since, till, until, as soon as, once, whenever	Wait until I come back. As soon as the bell rang, we left.
Reason	because, since, as, for	I stayed at home because I was ill.
Purpose	so that, in order that, lest	He studies hard so that he may pass. Walk carefully lest you fall.

Idea	Conjunctions	Example
Result	so … that, such … that	He was so tired that he fell asleep. It was such a good film that I saw it twice.
Condition	if, unless, provided (that), as long as, in case, on condition that	Unless you work hard, you will fail.
Contrast / concession	although, though, even though, whereas, while, even if	Although it was cold, he swam. She is tall, whereas her sister is short.
Comparison	than, as … as, as if, as though	He runs faster than I do. She talks as if she knew everything.
Place	where, wherever	Sit where you like.
Noun clause	that, whether, if	I know that he is honest. I wonder whether he will come.

IMPORTANT

Lest has a negative sense, so no *not* follows: *Run fast **lest** you **should miss** the train.* (not *lest you should not miss*)

▸ Because, since, as, for

- **because** gives the most direct reason and answers 'why?': *I am late because the bus broke down.*
- **since / as** put the reason first, usually already known: *Since you are here, let us begin.*
- **for** is formal and cannot start a sentence: *He wept, for his friend was dead.*

▸ Although, though, even though, in spite of, despite

Pattern	Example
although / though / even though + clause	Although he was ill, he came to school.
in spite of / despite + noun or -ing	In spite of his illness, he came. Despite being ill, he came.
in spite of the fact that + clause	In spite of the fact that he was ill, he came.

IMPORTANT

Never use 'although' together with 'but' or 'yet' in the same sentence. Wrong: *Although he was tired, but he worked.* Right: *Although he was tired, he worked.* or *He was tired, but he worked.* Likewise: not *Because… so*; not *Though… yet* (in strict usage).

13.4 Correlative Conjunctions

Pair	Rule	Example
both … and	joins two equal items; plural verb	Both Anil and Sunil are present.
either … or	choice; verb agrees with nearer subject	Either he or I am wrong.
neither … nor	negative choice; verb agrees with nearer subject; no extra *not*	Neither the teacher nor the students were absent.
not only … but also	keep the same grammatical form after each part	She is not only clever but also hard-working.
whether … or	doubt between two	I do not know whether he will come or stay.

REMEMBER

Parallel structure. The words after each part of a pair must match. Wrong: *He is both a poet and writes novels.* Right: *He is both a poet and a novelist.* Wrong: *He neither came nor did he call.* Right: *He neither came nor called.*

13.5 Connectors (Linkers) for Paragraph Writing

Connectors join **sentences and paragraphs**, not only clauses. Choose them for the **relationship** you want to show.

Function	Connectors
Addition	and, also, too, besides, moreover, furthermore, in addition, as well as, what is more, not only … but also
Contrast	but, yet, however, nevertheless, on the other hand, still, in contrast, whereas, while, although
Cause / reason	because, since, as, for, due to, owing to, because of, on account of, thanks to
Result	so, therefore, thus, hence, consequently, as a result, accordingly, that is why
Condition	if, unless, provided that, otherwise, in case, as long as
Sequence / time	first, firstly, next, then, after that, meanwhile, finally, at last, in the end, afterwards, subsequently, at the same time, eventually
Example	for example, for instance, such as, namely, like
Emphasis	indeed, in fact, certainly, above all, especially, particularly, undoubtedly
Summing up	in short, to sum up, in conclusion, in brief, all in all, to conclude
Purpose	so that, in order to, so as to, to, for the purpose of
Alternative	or, either … or, otherwise, alternatively, instead

▸ Punctuation of sentence connectors (Class 7–8)

Words such as *however, therefore, moreover, nevertheless, consequently, thus, hence* are **adverbs used as connectors**. Three correct ways:

- Separate sentences: *It was raining.* ***However****, we went out.*
- With a semicolon: *It was raining;* ***however****, we went out.*
- In the middle: *We,* ***however****, went out.* (commas on both sides)

IMPORTANT

Do **not** join two sentences with only a comma before *however*: *It was raining, however we went out* is a comma splice. Use a full stop or a semicolon.

13.6 Beginners' Guide: and / but / or / because / so (Class 5–6)

Use	Joins	Example
and	similar ideas	I like apples and I like bananas.
but	opposite ideas	I like tea but I do not like coffee.
or	choices	Do you want milk or juice?
because	reason (answers 'why?')	I was happy because it was my birthday.
so	result	It was cold, so I wore a sweater.
when / while	time	I was reading when the phone rang.

13.7 Joining Sentences

Step 1 — Find the relationship
Ask: is it addition, contrast, reason, result, time or condition?

Step 2 — Choose the connector
Pick a suitable coordinating or subordinating conjunction from the tables.

Step 3 — Remove repetition
Drop the repeated subject or noun if it is the same; use a pronoun.

Step 4 — Punctuate
Add a comma before *but/so/yet/or* joining clauses, and after an opening clause that begins with *although/if/when*.

13.8 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct
Although it rained, but we played.	Although it rained, we played.
Because he was ill, so he stayed home.	Because he was ill, he stayed home.
Unless you do not study, you will fail.	Unless you study, you will fail.
He neither came nor he called.	He neither came nor called.
Both he as well as I went.	Both he and I went.
I will go if it will not rain.	I will go if it does not rain.
Hardly he had come when it rained.	Hardly had he come when it rained.
Run fast lest you should not be late.	Run fast lest you should be late.
It was raining, however we went.	It was raining; however, we went.
He is as tall than me.	He is as tall as I (am).

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Coordinating (FANBOYS) join equals; subordinating join a dependent clause to a main clause; correlatives work in pairs.
- Match the connector to the idea: contrast (but, however), reason (because, since), result (so, therefore), condition (if, unless).
- Never double up: although…but, because…so, unless…not.
- In spite of/despite take noun or -ing; although/though take a clause.
- After however/therefore/moreover use a full stop or semicolon before, a comma after.
- Keep correlatives parallel: either…or, neither…nor, not only…but also.

CHAPTER 14 · SENTENCES

Relatives: Who, Whom, Whose, Which, That, Where

Relatives (relative pronouns and adverbs) join two sentences into one and give extra information about a person, thing, place or time. They are the heart of 'joining sentences' and 'editing' questions.

14.1 What Are Relatives?

DEFINITION

A **relative pronoun** joins a clause to a noun or pronoun and also **stands for** that noun. The noun it refers to is called the **antecedent**. A **relative adverb** (where, when, why) joins a clause and also acts as an adverb.

*The girl **who** won the prize is my cousin.* Here *who* refers to *girl* (antecedent) and begins the relative clause *who won the prize*.

Relative	Used for	Example
who	persons (subject)	The man who called is my uncle.
whom	persons (object)	The man whom you met is my uncle.
whose	possession (persons, sometimes things)	The boy whose bag was lost cried.
which	things and animals	The book which I bought is interesting.
that	persons, things, animals (defining clauses only)	The pen that I lost was new.
what	= the thing that (no antecedent)	I know what you mean.
where	place	This is the house where I was born.
when	time	I remember the day when we met.
why	reason	Tell me the reason why you are late.

14.2 Who, Whom and Whose

- **who** is the **subject** of the relative clause: *The teacher **who** taught us is kind.* (who = the teacher; 'who taught us')
- **whom** is the **object**: *The teacher **whom** we respect is kind.* (we respect whom?) In everyday speech *who* replaces *whom*, but in exams and formal English use **whom**, especially after a preposition: *the person **to whom** I wrote*.
- **whose** shows ownership: *I have a friend **whose** father is a pilot.*

NOTE

Easy test: if you can replace the pronoun with **he/she/they**, use *who*; if with **him/her/them**, use *whom*.

14.3 Which and That

- **which** is used for things and animals: *The dog which barked was caged.* It can also refer to a whole clause: *He failed, which surprised everyone.*
- **that** can replace *who/whom/which* in **defining** clauses: *The man that called… The book that I bought…*
- **That is preferred** after: all, everything, nothing, something, anything, little, much, none, the only, the same, the first, the last, superlatives: *This is the best film that I have seen. All that glitters is not gold. It is the only book that he owns.*
- **That cannot be used** in non-defining clauses or after a preposition: not *the house in that I live* but *the house **in which** I live*.

14.4 Where, When and Why

Adverb	Replaces	Example
where	in/at/to which (place)	This is the town where I grew up. (= in which)
when	in/on which (time)	That was the year when India won. (= in which)
why	for which (reason)	I do not know the reason why he left. (= for which)

14.5 Defining and Non-defining Relative Clauses

	Defining (restrictive)	Non-defining (non-restrictive)
Job	Tells **which** one we mean; necessary	Gives **extra** information; not necessary
Commas	None	Commas before and after
Pronouns	who, whom, whose, which, that	who, whom, whose, which (never **that**)
Can the pronoun be dropped?	Yes, when it is the object	No
Example	The boy who sits next to me is my friend.	Rohan, who sits next to me, is my friend.

IMPORTANT

Use **commas** if the noun is already clear: names, 'my mother', 'the Taj Mahal'. *The Taj Mahal, which is in Agra, is a wonder.* (no *that*)

14.6 Omission of the Relative Pronoun

In a **defining** clause, if the relative pronoun is the **object**, it may be dropped: *The film (that) we saw was good. The girl (whom) I met is a doctor.* It cannot be dropped when it is the subject: *The girl who sings is my sister.* Never drop it in non-defining clauses.

14.7 Preposition + Relative

Informal (preposition at the end)	Formal (preposition before)
The man I spoke to is the principal.	The man to whom I spoke is the principal.
The pen he writes with is gold.	The pen with which he writes is gold.
The house we live in is old.	The house in which we live is old.

IMPORTANT

After a preposition use **whom** (persons) and **which** (things). Not *that*, not *who*.

14.8 What and That Compared

What = 'that which / the thing that' and has **no antecedent**: *I did not understand what he said.* **That** needs an antecedent: *I did not understand the words that he said.* Do not use *what* after a noun: not *the book what I read* but *the book that I read*.

14.9 Joining Sentences with Relatives

Step 1 — Find the common noun

Spot the person or thing that appears in both sentences.

Step 2 — Choose the relative

Person (who/whom/whose); thing (which/that); place (where); time (when); possession (whose).

Step 3 — Join and remove repetition
Put the second sentence in place of the repeated noun and delete that noun.

Step 4 — Punctuate
Use commas for extra information (non-defining).

14.10 Relative Pronoun and Verb Agreement

The verb in the relative clause agrees with the **antecedent**: *She is one of the girls **who are** in the choir.* (plural: 'girls'). *He is the only one of the boys **who is** absent.* (singular)

14.11 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct
The boy which won is my friend.	The boy who won is my friend.
This is the man who I saw.	This is the man whom I saw. (formal)
The book what I read was good.	The book that I read was good.
Delhi, that is our capital, is big.	Delhi, which is our capital, is big.
He is the man to that I gave it.	He is the man to whom I gave it.
She has a dog who barks.	She has a dog which/that barks.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Who (person, subject), whom (person, object), whose (possession), which (things/animals), that (defining), where/when/why (place/time/reason).
- Defining clauses have no commas and can use that; non-defining clauses take commas and never use that.
- After a preposition use whom/which — not who/that.
- The relative pronoun can be omitted when it is the object in a defining clause.
- What = the thing that; it has no antecedent.
- The verb in the relative clause agrees with the antecedent.

CHAPTER 15 · VERBS

Conditionals: If Sentences and Their Cousins

A conditional sentence has two parts: the if-clause (the condition) and the main clause (the result). The tense you use in each part tells the listener how real or how imaginary the situation is. Master the four types and the special words (unless, wish, as if) and this topic becomes easy marks.

15.1 The Structure

DEFINITION

A **conditional sentence** states that one thing happens (or would happen) **if** another thing happens. *If it rains, the match will be cancelled.*

- **If-clause** (subordinate): states the condition.
- **Main clause**: states the result.
- Either clause may come first. A **comma** is used when the if-clause is first: *If you study, you will pass.* No comma: *You will pass if you study.*

15.2 The Four Types at a Glance

Type	Meaning	If-clause	Main clause	Example
Zero	always true, facts	simple present	simple present	If you heat ice, it melts.
First (real/probable)	possible in the future	simple present	will/shall/can/may + V1	If it rains, we will stay home.
Second (unreal/improbable)	imaginary present or unlikely future	simple past	would/could/might + V1	If I were a bird, I would fly.
Third (impossible)	imaginary past; cannot be changed	past perfect (had + V3)	would/could/might + have + V3	If I had studied, I would have passed.

15.3 Zero Conditional

Used for **scientific facts, general truths and habits**. *If* here can be replaced by *when*.

- *If you mix red and blue, you get purple.*
- *Water boils if you heat it to 100 °C.*
- *If I eat peanuts, I sneeze.*

15.4 First Conditional

Used for **real possibilities** in the present or future. Pattern: **If + simple present, … will + V1.**

- *If you work hard, you will succeed.*
- *If he comes, I shall tell him.*
- *If it is sunny tomorrow, we can go for a picnic.* (can, may, must, should are also possible in the main clause)
- An imperative can be used: *If you see Raj, give him this book.*

IMPORTANT

Never use *will* in the if-clause for the first conditional. Wrong: *If it will rain, I will stay.* Right: *If it rains, I will stay.* (The exception is *will* meaning willingness: *If you will help me, I shall be grateful.*)

15.5 Second Conditional

Used for **imaginary or unlikely** situations. Pattern: **If + simple past, … would/could/might + V1.**

- *If I had wings, I would fly to the moon.*
- *If I won a lottery, I would build a school.*
- *If I were you, I would apologise.*

> **IMPORTANT**
> Use **were** for all persons in the if-clause of a second conditional (especially in formal English): *If he were here… If I were the principal…* 'Was' is common in speech but 'were' is the exam answer.

First (possible)	Second (unlikely/imaginary)
If I win the race, I will celebrate.	If I won the race, I would celebrate. (I probably will not)
If it rains, we will stay in.	If it rained, we would stay in. (rain is unlikely)

15.6 Third Conditional

Used for **past situations that did not happen** — regret, criticism, relief. Pattern: **If + past perfect, … would/could/might + have + V3.**

- *If she had left earlier, she would have caught the train.* (She did not leave early; she missed it.)
- *If you had listened, you would not have made this mistake.*
- *I could have won if I had practised more.*

15.7 Mixed Conditionals (Class 8)

Pattern	Meaning	Example
If + past perfect, … would + V1	past condition, present result	If I had studied medicine, I would be a doctor now.
If + simple past, … would have + V3	present state, past result	If he were more careful, he would not have broken the vase.

15.8 Unless, Provided that, As long as, In case, Otherwise

Word	Meaning	Example
unless	= if not. Used with a **positive** verb.	Unless you hurry, you will be late. (= If you do not hurry…)
provided / providing that	only if	You may go provided that you return by six.
as long as	on condition that	As long as you try, you will improve.
in case	as a precaution	Take an umbrella in case it rains.
otherwise / or	if not (separate sentence)	Hurry, otherwise you will miss the bus.

> **IMPORTANT**
> **Unless** already means *if … not*. Do not add another negative: wrong *Unless you do not work, you will fail*; right *Unless you work, you will fail.*

▸ Changing if … not into unless

If you do not study, you will fail. → Unless you study, you will fail. | If he does not come, I shall go. → Unless he comes, I shall go.

15.9 Wish, If Only, As if and Would Rather

Structure	Meaning	Example
wish + simple past	regret about the present	I wish I knew the answer. (I do not)
wish + past perfect	regret about the past	I wish I had taken the exam seriously.
wish + would	annoyance, request for change	I wish he would stop shouting.
wish + were (all persons)	unreal present	I wish I were taller.
if only	stronger wish	If only I had more time!
as if / as though + past	unreal comparison	He talks as if he were the owner.
would rather + V1	preference	I would rather walk than ride.
it is (high) time + past	the right moment has already come	It is time we left.

REMEMBER

After *wish / if only / as if* the verb 'steps back' one tense: present → past, past → past perfect. That signals that the situation is **unreal**.

NOTE

In formal writing *if* can be dropped by inverting *had / were / should*: *Had I known, I would have come.* (Part 2 deals with this in detail.)

15.11 Converting Sentences

- Condition into **simple sentence**: *If you work hard, you will pass. → By working hard, you will pass.*
- Into **compound**: *If you work hard, you will pass. → Work hard and you will pass. / Work hard, or you will fail.*
- Into **complex with unless**: *Unless you work hard, you will not pass.*
- From **fact to conditional**: *He did not hurry, so he missed the bus. → If he had hurried, he would not have missed the bus.*
- Real to unreal: *As I am poor, I cannot buy it. → If I were not poor, I could buy it.*

15.13 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct
If it will rain, I will stay.	If it rains, I will stay.
If I would have time, I would help.	If I had time, I would help.
If he had come, I will have met him.	If he had come, I would have met him.
If I was you, I would go.	If I were you, I would go.
Unless you don't study, you will fail.	Unless you study, you will fail.
I wish I have a car.	I wish I had a car.
He talks as if he knows everything. (unreal)	He talks as if he knew everything.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Zero: if + present, present (facts). First: if + present, will + V1 (real). Second: if + past, would + V1 (unreal). Third: if + past perfect, would have + V3 (impossible past).
- Do not use will/would in the if-clause (except willingness).
- Use ‘were’ for all persons in second-conditional and wish sentences.
- Unless = if not; no second negative.
- Wish/if only/as if push the verb one tense back to show unreality.
- Formal inversions: Had I known, Were I you, Should you need.

CHAPTER 16 · VERBS

Active and Passive Voice

Voice tells us whether the subject does the action (active) or receives it (passive). The passive is used when the work done matters more than the doer, or when the doer is unknown. Learn the tense table, the four-step method and the special cases, and every transformation question becomes mechanical.

16.1 What Is Voice?

DEFINITION

Voice is the form of a verb that shows whether the subject is the **doer** (active voice) or the **receiver** (passive voice) of the action.

Active	Passive
Rohan wrote a letter.	A letter was written by Rohan.
The teacher praises the students.	The students are praised by the teacher.
They are building a bridge.	A bridge is being built (by them).

Use the passive when (1) the doer is not known or not important (*My bike was stolen*), (2) the doer is obvious (*The thief was arrested*), (3) the action is more important (*Sugar is made from cane*), or (4) in notices, news and scientific writing (*Visitors are requested not to touch the exhibits*).

16.2 Before You Begin: Object and Pronoun Cases

Only a sentence with an **object** (transitive verb) can be changed into the passive. Find the object by asking *what/whom?* after the verb.

Subjective	Possessive	Objective
I	my	me
We	our	us
You	your	you
He	his	him
She	her	her
It	its	it
They	their	them

▸ Direct and indirect objects

I teach you English. — *What* do I teach? English = **direct object**. *Whom* do I teach? You = **indirect object**.

16.3 The Method

Step 1 — Object becomes subject
Take the object of the active sentence and make it the subject (change it to the subjective case: *me* → *I*, *them* → *they*).

Step 2 — Change the verb
Use the correct form of **be** for the tense, followed by the **past participle (V3)** of the main verb.

Step 3 — Subject becomes agent
Put the old subject after the verb with **by**, changing it to the objective case (*I* → *me*, *he* → *him*).

Step 4 — Check agreement
The new verb must agree with the new subject in number and person.

I write a letter. → **A letter** (object→subject) **is written** (is + V3) **by me** (subject→object).

16.4 Passive Voice Tense Table

Tense	Present	Past	Future
Simple (Indefinite)	is / am / are + V3	was / were + V3	will be / shall be + V3
Continuous	is / am / are + being + V3	was / were + being + V3	— (not used)
Perfect	has / have + been + V3	had + been + V3	will have / shall have + been + V3
Perfect Continuous	— (rarely used)	— (rarely used)	— (rarely used)
Modals	modal + be + V3	modal + have + been + V3	can be, may be, must be, should be + V3

▸ Examples in every tense

Tense	Active	Passive
Simple present	She writes a poem.	A poem is written by her.
Present continuous	She is writing a poem.	A poem is being written by her.
Present perfect	She has written a poem.	A poem has been written by her.
Simple past	She wrote a poem.	A poem was written by her.
Past continuous	She was writing a poem.	A poem was being written by her.
Past perfect	She had written a poem.	A poem had been written by her.
Simple future	She will write a poem.	A poem will be written by her.
Future perfect	She will have written a poem.	A poem will have been written by her.
Modal (can)	She can write a poem.	A poem can be written by her.
Modal (should)	You should obey rules.	Rules should be obeyed.
Perfect continuous	She has been writing a poem.	(Passive is not normally used; *a poem has been being written* sounds awkward, so rephrase.)

16.5 Special Cases

▸ Sentences with two objects

Either object can become the subject. The **indirect object** version is more common: *She gave me a book.* → *I was given a book (by her).* or *A book was given to me (by her).*

▸ Questions

Type	Active	Passive
Yes/No	Did he break the glass?	Was the glass broken by him?
Yes/No	Does she like music?	Is music liked by her?
Wh- (object)	Who wrote this poem?	By whom was this poem written?
Wh- (object)	What do you want?	What is wanted by you?

Type	Active	Passive
Wh-	Why did they punish him?	Why was he punished (by them)?

▸ Imperative sentences

- Command: *Close the door. → Let the door be closed. / You are ordered to close the door.*
- Request: *Please help me. → You are requested to help me.*
- Negative: *Do not touch the wires. → Let the wires not be touched. / The wires must not be touched.*
- Advice: *Work hard. → You are advised to work hard.*

▸ Verbs that take two forms of passive

Verbs of making/seeing take **to** in the passive: *They made him run. → He was made to run.* | *We saw him go. → He was seen to go.* | *They let him go. → He was allowed to go.*

▸ Intransitive verbs

Verbs with no object (*sleep, go, arrive, rise, fall, laugh*) have **no passive**. *The sun rises* cannot be passivised.

▸ Agent omitted

The agent (*by* + *doer*) is dropped when it is unknown, obvious or unimportant: *The window was broken.* Retain it when it is important: *Hamlet was written by Shakespeare.* Also drop vague agents such as *by people, by someone, by them, by us, by one*.

▸ Verbs with phrasal prepositions

Keep the preposition in the passive: *They laughed at him. → He was laughed at.* | *The doctor looked after the patient. → The patient was looked after by the doctor.*

16.6 Passive Voice in Real Writing

- **Notices:** *Silence is to be maintained. Smoking is prohibited.*
- **Procedures (process descriptions):** *First, the vegetables are washed. Then they are cut into small pieces and boiled for ten minutes.*
- **News reports:** *Two persons were injured in the accident.*

> **REMEMBER**
> **Procedure rule:** when instructions in the imperative are rewritten as a process, use the **passive** in the same tense the passage begins with (present: *is/are + V3*; past: *was/were + V3*). Instruction: *Boil water. Add tea. → Water is boiled. Tea is added.*

16.7 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct
The letter written by me.	The letter was written by me.
The work is did by him.	The work is done by him.
A book is being wrote.	A book is being written.
The match has been win.	The match has been won.
He was seen go.	He was seen to go.
Was the thief caught by they?	Was the thief caught by them?
The door is opened by I.	The door is opened by me.
The glass was broke.	The glass was broken.

Wrong	Correct
Roses are grow in the garden.	Roses are grown in the garden.
The moon is risen by the earth.	Intransitive verbs have no passive.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Only transitive verbs (with an object) have a passive.
- Object → subject; verb → be + V3 in the same tense; subject → by + object.
- Passive continuous = is/am/are/was/were + being + V3; passive perfect = has/have/had + been + V3; modals: modal + be + V3.
- Pronoun case changes: I/me, he/him, they/them, etc.
- Questions: ‘Who…?’ becomes ‘By whom…?’; commands become ‘Let…be + V3’ or ‘You are requested/ordered/advised to…’.
- Drop the agent when it is unknown, obvious or unimportant; procedures and notices use the passive.

CHAPTER 17 · VERBS

Reported Speech (Direct and Indirect)

When we repeat what someone said, we can quote the exact words (direct speech) or report their meaning in our own words (indirect or reported speech). The change involves the reporting verb, the connecting word, the tense, the pronouns and the time and place words. Learn each step once and apply it to every sentence type.

17.1 Direct and Indirect Speech

DEFINITION

Direct speech gives the speaker's exact words inside inverted commas. **Indirect (reported) speech** reports the meaning without quoting.

Part	Example
Direct speech	He said to me, "How are you?"
Reporting verb	said to (asked)
Reported speech (the quoted part)	How are you?
Indirect speech	He asked me how I was.

17.2 Five Steps for Changing Direct into Indirect

Step 1 — Change the reporting verb
Choose a verb that suits the type of sentence (said/told, asked, ordered/requested/advised, exclaimed).

Step 2 — Remove the commas and quotation marks; add a conjunction
that (statement), if/whether (yes-no question), the same wh-word (wh-question), to / not to (command).

Step 3 — Change the tense of the reported verb
Only if the reporting verb is in the past tense (see the tense table).

Step 4 — Change the pronouns
First person → matches the speaker; second person → matches the listener; third person → no change.

Step 5 — Change time and place words, then end with a full stop
now → then, today → that day, here → there …

17.3 Change of Reporting Verb

Direct (reporting verb)	Type of sentence	Indirect (reporting verb)
said to	statement (declarative)	told
said	statement	said
said to	question	asked
said to	command / request / advice	ordered / commanded / requested / advised / told
said to / cried	exclamation	exclaimed (with joy, sorrow, surprise)
said to	wish / prayer	wished / prayed
said to	suggestion	suggested / proposed

17.4 Conjunctions Used

Type of sentence	Conjunction
Statement	that
Yes/No question (begins with is, are, do, can, have…)	if / whether
Wh- question (what, where, why, when, who, how)	the same wh-word (no conjunction)
Command / request (affirmative)	to
Negative command (Do not…)	not to
Exclamation	that (with exclaimed with joy / sorrow)

17.5 Tense Changes (Reporting Verb in the Past)

Direct speech	Indirect speech
Simple present (am/is/are, V1)	Simple past (was/were, V2)
Present continuous (is/am/are + ing)	Past continuous (was/were + ing)
Present perfect (has/have + V3)	Past perfect (had + V3)
Present perfect continuous	Past perfect continuous (had been + ing)
Simple past (V2)	Past perfect (had + V3)
Past continuous	Past perfect continuous (had been + ing)
Past perfect	No change (past perfect)
will / shall	would / should
can	could
may	might
must	had to (obligation) / must (deduction, unchanged)
would, could, might, should, ought to	No change
Universal truth / habit / scientific fact	No change

IMPORTANT

No tense change if (a) the reporting verb is in the **present or future** (*He says, "I am ill." → He says that he is ill.*), or (b) the quoted sentence is a **universal truth** (*The teacher said, "The Earth moves round the Sun." → The teacher said that the Earth moves round the Sun.*), or (c) the speaker is **still saying** what is true.

17.6 Changes in Pronouns

Person	Rule	Example
First person (I, we, my, our)	matches the **subject of the reporting verb**	Ram said, "I am happy." → Ram said that **he** was happy.
Second person (you, your)	matches the **object of the reporting verb** (the listener)	He said to me, "You are late." → He told me that **I** was late.
Third person (he, she, they, it)	**no change**	Mohan said, "She is clever." → Mohan said that she was clever.

17.7 Time and Place Words

Direct	Indirect
now	then
today	that day
tonight	that night
tomorrow	the next day / the following day
yesterday	the previous day / the day before
last night	the previous night
next week	the following week
ago	before
this	that
these	those
here	there
come	go
thus / so	in that way

17.8 Statements (Assertive Sentences)

Direct	Indirect
She said, “I am reading a novel.”	She said that she was reading a novel.
He said to me, “I will help you.”	He told me that he would help me.
The teacher said, “The sun rises in the east.”	The teacher said that the sun rises in the east.
Seema said to Reema, “I have finished my homework.”	Seema told Reema that she had finished her homework.

17.9 Questions

▸ Yes/No questions (if, whether)

*He said to me, “Do you like tea?” → He asked me **if** I liked tea.* Use *whether* if there is a choice (*or*). **Question order is dropped; the reported question becomes a statement, and the question mark is removed.**

▸ Wh- questions (same question word)

*She said to him, “Where are you going?” → She asked him **where** he was going. | The teacher said, “Who broke the window?” → The teacher asked who had broken the window.*

17.10 Commands, Requests, Advice

Direct	Indirect
He said to me, “Go away.”	He ordered me to go away.
She said to him, “Please help me.”	She requested him to help her.
The doctor said to me, “Take rest.”	The doctor advised me to take rest.
The teacher said to the boy, “Do not make a noise.”	The teacher told the boy not to make a noise.

Direct	Indirect
The officer said, “Stand up.”	The officer commanded them to stand up.
Mother said, “Let us go for a walk.”	Mother suggested that they should go for a walk.

Choose the reporting verb from the tone: **order/command** (strong), **request** (with *please, kindly*), **advise** (suggestion for benefit), **warn** (danger), **forbid** (prohibition), **beg/implore** (with *please, I beg you*).

17.11 Exclamations and Wishes

Direct	Indirect
He said, “Hurrah! We have won!”	He exclaimed with joy that they had won.
He said, “What a beautiful garden!”	He exclaimed that it was a very beautiful garden. / He exclaimed with wonder that the garden was very beautiful.
The old man said, “May you live long!”	The old man prayed that I might live long.

17.12 Mixed and Dialogue Reports (Class 8)

When a sentence has two parts of different types, change each according to its own type and join them with *and*, *but* or *that*. Dialogues between two speakers are reported by alternating the reporting verbs (*asked, replied, said, suggested, exclaimed, agreed*), with *that* or the question word, and past-tense verbs.

Dialogue	Report
Rama: I am going to the jungle. Sita: Why?	Rama told Sita that he was going to the jungle. She asked him why he was going.
Anita: What do you want to do this morning? Prakash: I feel like taking a walk.	Anita asked Prakash what he wanted to do that morning. Prakash replied that he felt like taking a walk.

▸ Greetings, thanks, wishes

- *He said, “Good morning, sir.” → He wished the teacher good morning.*
- *She said, “Thank you.” → She thanked him.*
- *“Congratulations!” → He congratulated her.*
- *“Happy birthday!” → They wished him a happy birthday.*

17.13 Useful Reporting Verbs

Purpose	Verbs
Statement	said, told, stated, declared, announced, replied, answered, added, admitted, explained, complained, remarked, confessed, promised, informed
Question	asked, enquired, wondered, demanded, questioned
Order / request	ordered, commanded, requested, begged, urged, advised, warned, forbade, instructed, suggested, invited
Emotion	exclaimed, cried, shouted, groaned, sighed

17.14 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct
He said me that he was ill.	He told me that he was ill.
She asked that where I lived.	She asked where I lived.
He asked where was I going.	He asked where I was going.
She told that she would come.	She said that she would come.
He asked me did I know him.	He asked me if I knew him.
The teacher said that the earth moved round the sun.	...that the earth moves round the sun. (universal truth)
He ordered me do it.	He ordered me to do it.
She asked what is your name.	She asked what my name was.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Five steps: reporting verb → conjunction → tense → pronouns → time/place, then a full stop.
- said to → told (statement) / asked (question) / ordered, requested, advised (command).
- that (statements), if/whether (yes-no), same wh-word (wh-questions), to / not to (commands).
- Tenses go one step back only when the reporting verb is past; universal truths do not change.
- Pronouns: First with Subject, Second with Object, Third No change.
- Questions in indirect speech take statement order, no do/did, no question mark.

CHAPTER 18 · SENTENCES

Sentences, Phrases, Clauses and Punctuation

A sentence is the basic unit of writing. This chapter shows how sentences are classified by function and by structure, how phrases and clauses build them, how one kind of sentence can be rewritten as another without changing meaning, and how capital letters and punctuation make the writing clear.

18.1 What Is a Sentence?

DEFINITION

A **sentence** is a group of words that makes complete sense. It has a **subject** (about whom/what) and a **predicate** (what is said), and begins with a capital letter and ends with a full stop, question mark or exclamation mark.

The bus left. (subject: *The bus*; predicate: *left*). *Left the.* is not a sentence. A sentence must have a finite verb.

18.2 Kinds of Sentences by Function

Kind	Job	Ends with	Example
Assertive (declarative)	makes a statement	full stop	The sun rises in the east.
Interrogative	asks a question	question mark	Where do you live?
Imperative	gives a command, request, advice	full stop (or !)	Please sit down.
Exclamatory	expresses strong feeling	exclamation mark	What a beautiful rose it is!
Optative	expresses a wish or prayer	full stop / !	May you live long!

REMEMBER

Assertive sentences can be **affirmative** (*He plays.*) or **negative** (*He does not play.*). Interrogatives can be **yes/no** (*Is he here?*) or **wh-** (*Why is he here?*).

18.3 Subject, Predicate, Object, Complement

Part	Meaning	Example (underlined idea)
Subject	who or what does the action	**The tall boy** is running.
Predicate	what is said about the subject	The tall boy **is running**.
Object	receives the action (what/whom?)	She ate **an apple**.
Complement	completes the meaning of the verb	He became **a doctor**. She looks **happy**.
Adverbial	tells how/when/where/why	He came **late**. She works **in the garden**.

Basic patterns: **S V** (Birds fly.) | **S V O** (She reads books.) | **S V C** (He is tall.) | **S V IO DO** (He gave me a pen.) | **S V O A** (He put the book on the table.)

18.4 Phrases and Clauses

	Phrase	Clause
Definition	group of words **without** a finite verb and a subject-predicate pair	group of words **with** a subject and a finite verb

	Phrase	Clause
Sense	not complete	may be complete (main) or incomplete (subordinate)
Example	in the garden; to win the race; having finished his work	when the bell rang; because he was ill

▸ Kinds of phrases

Phrase	Works as	Example
Noun phrase	noun	The old man with a stick is my grandfather.
Adjective phrase	adjective	A boy of great courage won.
Adverb phrase	adverb	He ran with great speed.
Prepositional phrase	adjective/adverb	The book on the table is mine.
Verb phrase	verb	She has been waiting.
Infinitive/participle phrase	noun/adjective/adverb	To win the match was his aim. Walking quickly, he reached school.

▸ Kinds of clauses

- **Principal (main) clause** can stand alone: *I know that he is honest.* (I know)
- **Subordinate (dependent) clause** cannot stand alone: *that he is honest*.

Subordinate clause	Works as	Starts with	Example
Noun clause	noun (subject/object)	that, what, whether, if, who, why, how	I know **that he is honest**. **What he said** is true.
Adjective clause	adjective	who, whom, whose, which, that	The boy **who is sitting there** is my brother.
Adverb clause	adverb (time, place, reason, purpose, result, condition, concession, comparison)	when, where, because, so that, if, although, than	He left **because he was ill**.

18.5 Kinds of Sentences by Structure

Kind	Structure	Example
Simple	one main clause, one finite verb (may have phrases)	The ill boy stayed at home.
Compound	two or more **main clauses** joined by and, but, or, so, yet	He was ill, so he stayed at home.
Complex	one **main clause + one or more subordinate clauses**	He stayed at home because he was ill.
Compound-complex (Class 8)	two main clauses + at least one subordinate	He was ill, so he stayed at home although he wanted to go.

18.6 Sentence Transformation: Simple ⇄ Compound ⇄ Complex

Pattern	Simple	Compound	Complex
Reason	Being ill, he stayed at home.	He was ill, so he stayed at home.	As he was ill, he stayed at home.
Contrast	In spite of his illness, he came.	He was ill but he came.	Although he was ill, he came.

Pattern	Simple	Compound	Complex
Condition	In case of rain, we shall stay in.	Take an umbrella or you will get wet.	If it rains, we shall stay in.
Time	On reaching school, he rang the bell.	He reached school and rang the bell.	When he reached school, he rang the bell.
Purpose	He works hard to pass.	He works hard; he wants to pass.	He works hard so that he may pass.
Result	He is too weak to walk.	He is weak and cannot walk.	He is so weak that he cannot walk.
Relative	The injured man was taken to hospital.	The man was injured and was taken to hospital.	The man who was injured was taken to hospital.

Simple → compound: replace the phrase by a clause and join with *and/but/so/or*. **Simple → complex:** replace the phrase by a subordinate clause. **Compound → complex:** turn one main clause into a subordinate clause with a suitable conjunction.

18.7 Other Transformations

- **too … to ⇄ so … that:** *He is too tired to walk. → He is so tired that he cannot walk.*
- **as soon as ⇄ no sooner … than:** *As soon as he arrived, it rained. → No sooner had he arrived than it rained.*
- **enough to ⇄ so … that:** *She is clever enough to solve it. → She is so clever that she can solve it.*
- **both … and ⇄ not only … but also:** *Both he and I went. → Not only he but also I went.*

18.8 Word Order and Sentence Building

The normal English order is **Subject – Verb – Object – Place – Time**: *The children played cricket in the park yesterday.* Adverbs of frequency come before the main verb but after *be*: *He always arrives early. He is always early.*

Rule	Example
Subject comes before verb	Rita sings. (not Sings Rita.)
Adjective before noun	a red rose (not a rose red)
Order of adjectives: opinion – size – age – shape – colour – origin – material – noun	a lovely small old round brown Indian wooden box
Question: auxiliary before subject	Where do you live? What is he doing?
Indirect question: statement order	I wonder where she lives.
Place before time	She went to the market in the morning.
Manner – place – time	He spoke clearly in the hall yesterday.

▸ Rearranging jumbled words

Step 1
Find the **subject** (noun/pronoun).

Step 2
Find the **helping verb** and then the **main verb**.

Step 3
Look for the **object** (direct then indirect) and any **wh-word**.

Step 4
Attach **phrases of place and time** at the end.

Step 5
Read the sentence aloud to check that it is meaningful.

18.9 Capital Letters

- First word of a sentence and of a quotation: *He said, “Come here.”*
- The pronoun **I**; names of people, places, days, months, festivals, languages, nationalities (*Jaipur, Monday, Diwali, Hindi*).
- Titles and the main words of book titles: *The Jungle Book*; titles of respect: *Dr Rao, Mr Singh*.
- Words that begin a line of poetry; names of God; abbreviations such as *UNESCO, NASA*.
- Not for seasons or directions: *summer, north* (unless part of a name: *North Pole*).

18.10 Punctuation Marks

Mark	Use	Example
Full stop (.)	ends a statement; abbreviations	I like tea. Mr. Rao (or Mr Rao)
Question mark (?)	ends a direct question	Are you coming?
Exclamation mark (!)	strong feeling, interjection	Wow! What a view!
Comma (,)	lists, after introductory words/clauses, round extra information, before direct speech	I bought apples, oranges and grapes. When he came, we left. Mr Rao, our teacher, is kind.
Semicolon (;)	joins two related main clauses	It was late; we went home.
Colon (:)	introduces a list, quotation or explanation	You need three things: a pen, a pencil and an eraser.
Apostrophe (’)	possession and contraction	Rita’s book; don’t; it’s (= it is); its (possessive)
Inverted commas (“ ”)	exact words of a speaker, titles	She said, “I am hungry.”
Hyphen (-)	joins words	well-known, twenty-one, mother-in-law
Dash (—)	sudden break or extra remark	He came — late as usual.
Brackets ( )	extra information	Delhi (the capital) is large.

IMPORTANT

Apostrophe rules. Singular: *the boy’s bag*. Plural ending in s: *the boys’ bags*. Irregular plural: *children’s, women’s*. **its** (belonging to it) has no apostrophe; **it’s** = it is. Plurals never take an apostrophe: *three dogs*, not *three dog’s*.

▸ Punctuation of direct speech

Meera said, “I am ready.” | *“I am ready,” said Meera.* | *“Are you ready?” asked Rani.* Start a new paragraph each time the speaker changes.

18.11 Class-wise Guide

Class	Learn
5–6	four kinds of sentences, subject/predicate, simple word order, capital letters, full stop, comma, question mark, apostrophe.
7	phrases and clauses, simple/compound/complex, affirmative–negative, assertive–interrogative–exclamatory, semicolon, colon, direct speech punctuation.
8	noun/adjective/adverb clauses, all transformations, degrees of comparison, too…to/so…that, sentence reordering, compound-complex.

18.12 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct
Running along the road, a dog bit me.	While I was running along the road, a dog bit me.
He said “I am ill.”	He said, “I am ill.”
It was late, we went home. (comma splice)	It was late, so we went home. / It was late; we went home.
The dogs bone is lost.	The dog’s bone is lost.
Its a nice day.	It’s a nice day.
She is tall she is slim.	She is tall and slim.
Where you are going?	Where are you going?
i live in jaipur.	I live in Jaipur.
Because he was ill.	He stayed at home because he was ill. (A fragment is not a sentence.)

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Sentences by function: assertive, interrogative, imperative, exclamatory, optative.
- A clause has a subject and a finite verb; a phrase does not. Subordinate clauses are noun, adjective or adverb clauses.
- Structure: simple (1 clause), compound (main + main), complex (main + subordinate).
- Transform sentences by changing connectors without changing meaning.
- Word order: S–V–O–manner–place–time; indirect questions take statement order.
- Capital letters and punctuation (. , ? ! ; : ’ “ ”) make meaning clear; avoid comma splices.

CHAPTER 19 · WORDS

Vocabulary and Word Usage

Grammar tells you how to build a sentence; vocabulary gives you the bricks. This chapter covers the word skills tested from Class 5 to Class 8: synonyms and antonyms, one-word substitutes, idioms, homophones and confusing words, prefixes and suffixes, phrasal verbs, collocations and commonly used foreign words.

19.1 Synonyms (Words with Similar Meanings)

DEFINITION

Synonyms are words that have the same or nearly the same meaning. Choose the one that fits the context, because no two words are exactly alike.

Word	Synonyms	Word	Synonyms
abandon	desert, leave, forsake	huge	enormous, giant, vast, immense
ancient	old, antique, primitive	honest	truthful, sincere, upright
begin	start, commence, initiate	idle	lazy, inactive, slothful
brave	courageous, bold, fearless	joy	delight, happiness, pleasure
calm	quiet, peaceful, serene	kind	generous, gentle, considerate
clever	smart, intelligent, bright	locate	find, discover, trace
complete	finish, conclude, accomplish	mistake	error, blunder, fault
danger	risk, peril, hazard	quick	fast, rapid, swift, speedy
difficult	hard, tough, tricky, demanding	reply	answer, respond, retort
end	finish, conclusion, close	rich	wealthy, affluent, prosperous
enemy	foe, opponent, rival	silent	quiet, still, noiseless
famous	well-known, renowned, celebrated	strange	odd, peculiar, unusual
fear	dread, terror, fright	tired	weary, exhausted, fatigued
help	assist, aid, support	unhappy	sad, miserable, sorrowful
hurry	rush, hasten, dash	wise	sensible, prudent, learned

19.2 Antonyms (Words with Opposite Meanings)

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
accept	reject, refuse	love	hate
ancient	modern	major	minor
brave	cowardly	never	always
create	destroy	optimist	pessimist
defeat	victory	permanent	temporary
diligent	lazy	polite	rude

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
expand	contract	pure	impure
generous	selfish, mean	rapid	slow
genuine	fake	success	failure
guilty	innocent	sweet	bitter
include	exclude	tight	loose
increase	decrease	victory	defeat
knowledge	ignorance	visible	invisible
lend	borrow	wise	foolish

▸ Making antonyms with prefixes

Prefix	Examples
un-	happy → unhappy, kind → unkind, able → unable, fair → unfair
dis-	agree → disagree, appear → disappear, honest → dishonest
in-/im-/il-/ir-	complete → incomplete, possible → impossible, legal → illegal, regular → irregular
mis-	understand → misunderstand, lead → mislead
non-	sense → nonsense, stop → non-stop
anti- / counter-	social → antisocial, clockwise → anticlockwise

19.3 One-word Substitutes

Phrase	One word
a person who loves his country	patriot
one who knows everything	omniscient
something that cannot be seen	invisible
one who writes poems	poet
a place where books are kept	library
a person who is new to a job	novice / beginner
one who does not believe in God	atheist
a doctor who treats eyes	oculist / ophthalmologist
a person who treats teeth	dentist
a story of a person's life written by himself	autobiography
a person who walks on foot	pedestrian
that which cannot be read	illegible
that which cannot be heard	inaudible
that which cannot be avoided	inevitable
that which cannot be believed	incredible

Phrase	One word
that which cannot be done	impossible / impracticable
an experienced old soldier or worker	veteran
a speech delivered without preparation	extempore
fear of closed spaces	claustrophobia
a person who eats only vegetables	vegetarian
place where fish are kept	aquarium
a person who looks on the bright side	optimist
a person who looks on the dark side	pessimist
a government by the people	democracy

19.4 Idioms and Phrases

DEFINITION

An **idiom** is a fixed group of words whose meaning cannot be guessed from its separate words. Use idioms as wholes; do not change their words.

Idiom	Meaning	Example
a piece of cake	very easy	The exam was a piece of cake.
once in a blue moon	very rarely	He visits us once in a blue moon.
break the ice	start a conversation in an awkward situation	She told a joke to break the ice.
burn the midnight oil	study/work late at night	He burnt the midnight oil before exams.
cry over spilt milk	regret what cannot be changed	It is no use crying over spilt milk.
hit the nail on the head	say exactly the right thing	You hit the nail on the head.
let the cat out of the bag	reveal a secret	He let the cat out of the bag.
a blessing in disguise	a good thing that seemed bad at first	Losing that job was a blessing in disguise.
under the weather	slightly ill	I am feeling under the weather.
call it a day	stop working	Let us call it a day.
the last straw	the final small thing that makes a situation unbearable	His rudeness was the last straw.
to beat about the bush	avoid coming to the point	Don’t beat about the bush.
at the eleventh hour	at the last moment	He arrived at the eleventh hour.
bolt from the blue	an unexpected shock	The news came as a bolt from the blue.
tooth and nail	with all effort	They fought tooth and nail.
turn over a new leaf	begin a better life	He turned over a new leaf.
rain cats and dogs	rain heavily	It rained cats and dogs.
apple of one’s eye	a loved person	She is the apple of her father’s eye.

Idiom	Meaning	Example
on cloud nine	extremely happy	She was on cloud nine.
add fuel to the fire	make a bad situation worse	His comment added fuel to the fire.

19.5 Proverbs (Class 7–8)

- *A stitch in time saves nine* — do a job promptly to avoid more work.
- *All that glitters is not gold* — appearances can deceive.
- *Look before you leap* — think before acting.
- *Honesty is the best policy.*
- *A rolling stone gathers no moss* — someone who keeps moving does not settle or gain.
- *Where there is a will there is a way.*
- *Too many cooks spoil the broth.*
- *Slow and steady wins the race.*
- *Actions speak louder than words.*
- *Birds of a feather flock together.*

19.6 Homophones, Homonyms and Confusing Words

DEFINITION

Homophones sound alike but differ in spelling and meaning (*pair/pear*). **Homonyms** are spelt and pronounced alike but have different meanings (*bank*: river bank / money bank).

Homophones	Meaning
bare / bear	uncovered / an animal; to carry
buy / by / bye	to purchase / near, by means of / goodbye
cereal / serial	grain food / a series
check / cheque	to examine / a bank paper
dear / deer	loved / animal
flour / flower	wheat powder / bloom
hear / here	listen / in this place
knew / new	past of know / not old
made / maid	created / a servant
meat / meet	flesh / to come together
peace / piece	calm / a part
plane / plain	aircraft / simple, flat land
principal / principle	head of school, main / rule
right / write	correct / to put in words
sail / sale	to travel by boat / selling at a low price
sea / see	ocean / to look
steal / steel	to rob / metal
tail / tale	animal's tail / story

Homophones	Meaning
their / there / they're	belonging to them / in that place / they are
threw / through	past of throw / from one end to another
to / too / two	toward / also, excess / number 2
weak / week	not strong / seven days
wear / where	to put on / at which place
whole / hole	complete / an opening
wood / would	from trees / modal verb

▸ Words often confused

Pair	Difference
accept / except	accept = receive; except = apart from
advice / advise	advice (noun); advise (verb)
affect / effect	affect (verb, influence); effect (noun, result)
alone / lonely	alone = by oneself; lonely = sad because alone
beside / besides	next to / in addition
borrow / lend	take from / give to
bring / take	towards the speaker / away from the speaker
farther / further	distance / additional
lay / lie	to place (lay, laid, laid) / to recline (lie, lay, lain)
lose / loose	to misplace / not tight
many / much	countable / uncountable
quiet / quite / quit	silent / completely / to stop
raise / rise	to lift something / to go up by itself
stationary / stationery	not moving / writing material
than / then	comparison / at that time
weather / whether	climate / if

19.7 Prefixes and Suffixes

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
un-, in-, im-, dis-, non-	not	unlucky, invisible, impolite, disloyal, nonsense
re-	again	rewrite, rebuild, return
pre-	before	prehistoric, preview, predict
post-	after	postpone, post-war
mis-	wrongly	misread, misbehave
sub-	under	submarine, subway

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
inter-	between	international, interval
super-	above	superman, supermarket
over-, under-	too much / too little	overeat, underpay
co-	together	co-operate, co-worker
semi-	half	semicircle
trans-	across	transport, translate

Suffix	Forms	Examples
-er, -or, -ist, -ian	person who	teacher, actor, artist, musician
-ness, -ment, -tion, -ity, -ship	noun (state/action)	kindness, movement, education, honesty, friendship
-ful, -less	with / without	careful, careless, helpful, helpless
-able, -ible	can be done	readable, visible
-ous, -al, -ic, -ive, -y	adjective	famous, natural, heroic, active, rainy
-ly	adverb	quickly, happily
-ize, -ify, -en	verb	modernize, simplify, widen
-hood, -dom	state	childhood, freedom

19.8 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
to succeed	success	successful	successfully
to decide	decision	decisive	decisively
to create	creation / creativity	creative	creatively
to differ	difference	different	differently
to behave	behaviour	well-behaved	—
to compete	competition / competitor	competitive	competitively
to help	help	helpful / helpless	helpfully
to employ	employment / employer	employed	—
to explain	explanation	explanatory	—
to anger	anger	angry	angrily
to admire	admiration	admirable	admirably

19.9 Phrasal Verbs

DEFINITION

A **phrasal verb** is a verb + a particle (adverb or preposition) with a **special meaning**.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
break down	stop working	The car broke down.
bring up	raise (a child)	She brought up three children.
call off	cancel	The match was called off.
carry on	continue	Carry on with your work.
come across	meet/find by chance	I came across an old friend.
fill in	complete a form	Fill in the form.
get along (with)	have good relations	She gets along with everyone.
give up	stop trying	Never give up.
look after	take care of	Look after your sister.
look for	search	I am looking for my keys.
look up	search in a book	Look up the word in a dictionary.
pick up	lift; learn	He picked up Spanish quickly.
put off	postpone	Don’t put off your work.
put on	wear	Put on your cap.
run out of	have none left	We ran out of sugar.
set off	begin a journey	We set off at dawn.
take off	remove; (plane) leave the ground	Take off your shoes. The plane took off.
turn down	refuse	She turned down the offer.

19.10 Collocations (Words that Go Together)

Pattern	Correct collocations
make	make a mistake, make progress, make a decision, make friends, make noise, make an effort
do	do homework, do your best, do harm, do a favour, do business
take	take a bath, take a break, take a photograph, take care, take part, take place
have	have a meal, have fun, have a look, have a good time
pay	pay attention, pay a visit, pay a fine
keep	keep a promise, keep a secret, keep quiet, keep calm
heavy / strong / deep	heavy rain, strong tea, deep sleep, fast food, high tide

19.11 Commonly Used Foreign Words and Phrases

Phrase	Language	Meaning
ad hoc	Latin	for this purpose only
alma mater	Latin	one’s school or college
bona fide	Latin	genuine
et cetera (etc.)	Latin	and so on

Phrase	Language	Meaning
per annum	Latin	every year
vice versa	Latin	the other way round
status quo	Latin	existing state of affairs
bon voyage	French	have a good journey
déjà vu	French	feeling that something has happened before
cul-de-sac	French	dead-end street
rendezvous	French	a meeting place/appointment
fiasco	Italian	complete failure
kindergarten	German	children's school
pyjamas, shampoo, jungle, bungalow, cot	Hindi/Urdu origin	words English borrowed from India

19.12 Spelling Tips

- **i before e except after c**: *believe, receive, ceiling.* (Exceptions: weird, seize, neighbour)
- **Drop the silent e** before a vowel suffix: *make → making; hope → hoping.* Keep it before a consonant suffix: *hope → hopeful.*
- **Double the final consonant** in a short word with one vowel before it: *run → running; stop → stopped; sit → sitting.*
- **Change y to i** after a consonant: *happy → happiness; carry → carried; study → studies.*
- **Plurals:** add -es to s, x, z, ch, sh: *boxes, watches.* Words ending in consonant + y: *-ies* (*babies*). Some irregular: *child → children, man → men, mouse → mice, tooth → teeth, leaf → leaves, knife → knives.*
- **Commonly misspelt:** *separate, definitely, necessary, occasion, beginning, tomorrow, library, February, receive, government, environment, independent, Wednesday, restaurant.*

19.13 Class-wise Guide

Class	Focus
5–6	simple synonyms/antonyms, prefixes un-/dis-, plurals, homophones (to/too/two, their/there), simple one-word substitutes, basic phrasal verbs.
7	more synonym–antonym pairs, 30+ idioms, one-word substitutes, suffixes, confusing words, collocations.
8	idioms and proverbs, word formation (noun–adjective–adverb), phrasal verbs, foreign words, advanced spelling rules.

19.14 Common Mistakes

Wrong	Correct
He gave me an advise.	He gave me advice.
Please borrow me your pen.	Please lend me your pen.
There going to the park.	They're going to the park.
Its my book; I lost it's cover.	It's my book; I lost its cover.
I don't know weather it will rain.	I don't know whether it will rain.
He is a honest man.	He is an honest man.
I have many works to do.	I have much work to do.

Wrong	Correct
Everyone came accept Ravi.	Everyone came except Ravi.
He is more taller.	He is taller.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Learn synonyms and antonyms in pairs and in context; prefixes (un-, dis-, im-) make many antonyms.
- One-word substitutes replace long phrases (patriot, biography, inevitable).
- Idioms are fixed phrases; use them whole and know their meaning in a sentence.
- Homophones sound alike (their/there/they’re); confusing words differ in meaning (accept/except, affect/effect).
- Prefixes and suffixes build new words: noun, adjective, adverb forms follow patterns (success, successful, successfully).
- Phrasal verbs and collocations must be learnt as units; follow the spelling rules for plural and suffix changes.

CHAPTER 20 · EXERCISE BANK · PART A

Topic-wise Practice (Classes 5–8)

One pair of exercise sets for every grammar topic in this workbook: Set I is for Classes 5–6 and Set II for Classes 7–8; attempt them after the matching chapter. Every item has one correct answer; the complete key is in Chapter 23.

Topic 1: Parts of Speech

▸ A1-I Parts of Speech (Classes 5–6)

Name the part of speech of the word in CAPITAL LETTERS (noun, pronoun, adjective, verb, adverb, preposition, conjunction, interjection).

1. The TORTOISE won the race.
2. SHE sings very well.
3. We saw a BEAUTIFUL rainbow.
4. The children ran QUICKLY to the gate.
5. The cat is sleeping UNDER the table.
6. I like tea AND coffee.
7. HURRAY! We have won the match.
8. Meena PLAYS the guitar every evening.

▸ A1-II Parts of Speech (Classes 7–8)

Name the part of speech of the word in CAPITAL LETTERS. The same word may be used as different parts of speech.

1. Please CLOSE the window.
2. The shop is CLOSE to my house.
3. She ran FAST to catch the bus.
4. The train arrived AFTER the bell rang.
5. We reached the hall AFTER the show.
6. The WATCH on his wrist is new.
7. Alas! The bird has flown away.
8. This is the book THAT I bought yesterday.

Topic 2: Nouns

▸ A2-I Nouns (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank as directed.

1. Plural of 'box' is _____.
2. Plural of 'leaf' is _____.
3. Feminine of 'prince' is _____.
4. Masculine of 'cow' is _____.
5. A group of sheep is called a _____. (flock/herd)
6. 'Honesty' is a _____ noun. (proper/abstract)
7. Plural of 'child' is _____.
8. 'Furniture' is a _____ noun. (countable/uncountable)

▸ A2-II Nouns (Classes 7–8)

Answer as directed.

1. Plural of 'mouse' (animal) is _____.

2. Plural of 'knife' is _____.
3. Plural of 'sister-in-law' is _____.
4. Plural of 'deer' is _____.
5. The noun in 'The team has won the trophy' that names a group is a _____ noun.
6. Write the possessive form: the toys of the children.
7. Form the abstract noun from 'brave'.
8. Form the abstract noun from 'wise'.

Topic 3: Pronouns

▸ A3-I Pronouns (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with the correct pronoun.

1. Ravi is my friend. _____ lives near my house. (He/Him)
2. Give _____ the book. (I/me)
3. The girls finished _____ homework. (their/them)
4. This pen is not yours; it is _____. (my/mine)
5. Anil and I are friends. _____ play together. (We/Us)
6. The dog wagged _____ tail. (its/it's)
7. Rita hurt _____ in the game. (herself/her)
8. _____ is knocking at the door? (Who/Whom)

▸ A3-II Pronouns (Classes 7–8)

Choose the correct pronoun to fill the blank.

1. Between you and _____, the plan is risky. (I/me)
2. He is taller than _____. (I/me)
3. To _____ did you give the keys? (who/whom)
4. Each of the boys has done _____ work. (his/their)
5. I myself saw the accident. 'myself' here is a _____ pronoun. (reflexive/emphatic)
6. Neither of the answers is right; _____ is complete. (none/neither)
7. _____ of the three boys won the race? (Who/Which)
8. The bag _____ was lost has been found. (who/that)

Topic 4: Determiners

▸ A4-I Determiners (Articles, Demonstratives, Quantifiers) (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with a, an, the or X (if no article is needed).

1. She is _____ honest girl.
2. I saw _____ elephant at the zoo. _____ elephant was huge.
3. _____ sun rises in the east.
4. My father is _____ engineer.
5. We had _____ lunch at one o'clock.
6. He is _____ European.
7. Mount Everest is _____ highest peak in the world.
8. _____ Ganga is a holy river.

▸ A4-II Determiners (Articles, Demonstratives, Quantifiers) (Classes 7–8)

Choose the correct word to fill the blank.

1. I have _____ money left. (few/little)

2. There are _____ books on the shelf. (a few/a little)
3. _____ of the students were absent. (Much/Many)
4. _____ boy in the class has a book. (Each/All)
5. I have two brothers. _____ of them is married. (Either/Any)
6. _____ books on that shelf are mine. (This/Those)
7. He has _____ patience; he gets angry quickly. (little/a little)
8. Kalidas is _____ Shakespeare of India. (a/the)

Topic 5: Adjectives and Comparison

▸ A5-I Adjectives and Degrees of Comparison (Classes 5–6)

Write the correct form of the adjective in brackets.

1. Mount Everest is the _____ peak in the world. (high)
2. Rani is _____ than Sita. (tall)
3. This is the _____ story I have read. (good)
4. A cheetah is _____ than a horse. (fast)
5. She is the _____ girl in the class. (beautiful)
6. Today is the _____ day of the year. (hot)
7. This road is _____ than that one. (narrow)
8. Gold is _____ than silver. (costly)

▸ A5-II Adjectives and Degrees of Comparison (Classes 7–8)

Rewrite as directed.

1. He is the tallest boy in the class. (Change to comparative using 'taller')
2. Gold is more precious than iron. (Change to positive degree)
3. Iron is one of the most useful metals. (Change to comparative)
4. Fill 'to' or 'than': She is senior _____ me.
5. Write the comparative of 'little' (amount).
6. Write the superlative of 'far' (distance).
7. Choose: This is the (more good / best / most good) book.
8. Choose: Of the two brothers, Ravi is the (elder / eldest).

Topic 6: Adverbs

▸ A6-I Adverbs (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with the correct adverb from the brackets.

1. She sings _____. (sweet/sweetly)
2. He ran _____ to catch the bus. (quick/quickly)
3. The baby is sleeping _____. (soundly/sound)
4. I have _____ seen such a big fish. (never/ever)
5. The train will come _____. (soon/sooner than)
6. He works _____. (hard/hardly)
7. She _____ goes to bed before ten. (always/ever)
8. The water is _____ hot to drink. (too/to)

▸ A6-II Adverbs (Classes 7–8)

Choose the correct adverb and name its kind (manner, time, place, frequency, degree).

1. He is _____ tired to walk. (very/too)

2. I have _____ finished my work. (just/yet)
3. She _____ visits her grandparents. (seldom/seldomly)
4. The students listened _____. (attentive/attentively)
5. He could _____ speak because of fear. (hard/hardly)
6. Look _____! A snake is there. (up/high)
7. The film was _____ boring. (extremely/extreme)
8. He arrived _____ for the meeting. (late/lately)

Topic 7: Verbs: Kinds and Forms

▸ A7-I Verbs: Kinds and Forms (Classes 5–6)

Write the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1. The sun _____ in the east. (rise)
2. She _____ a letter yesterday. (write)
3. They have _____ their lunch. (eat)
4. He is _____ a song. (sing)
5. I _____ to school every day. (go)
6. The boys _____ football last Sunday. (play)
7. The glass has _____. (break)
8. My mother _____ tea every morning. (make)

▸ A7-II Verbs: Kinds and Forms (Classes 7–8)

Fill in the table-style forms. Write the V2 (past) and V3 (past participle) of each verb as 'V2 / V3'.

1. bring
2. begin
3. lie (to rest)
4. lay (to put down)
5. drive
6. swim
7. Name the transitive verb: 'Rohan kicked the ball.'
8. Is 'arrived' transitive or intransitive in 'The guests arrived'?

Topic 8: Tenses

▸ A8-I Tenses (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1. She _____ (go) to school every day.
2. Look! The baby _____ (smile).
3. We _____ (visit) Agra last summer.
4. I _____ (finish) my homework just now.
5. He _____ (not like) bitter gourd.
6. _____ you _____ (see) the new film yesterday?
7. My sister _____ (watch) TV when I reached home.
8. I _____ (go) to Jaipur tomorrow.

▸ A8-II Tenses (Classes 7–8)

Fill in the blank with the correct tense form of the verb in brackets.

1. By the time we reached, the film _____ (start).

2. She _____ (live) in Kota since 2019.
3. When I called him, he _____ (have) lunch.
4. The patient _____ (die) before the doctor arrived.
5. This time tomorrow, we _____ (fly) to Delhi.
6. By next June, he _____ (complete) his course.
7. She _____ (read) for two hours when the light went off.
8. The train _____ (leave) at 6 p.m. tomorrow, so be ready.

Topic 9: Subject–Verb Agreement

▸ A9-I Subject–Verb Agreement (Classes 5–6)

Choose the correct verb.

1. The boys _____ playing in the park. (is/are)
2. The news _____ true. (is/are)
3. Each of the girls _____ a prize. (get/gets)
4. Rice and curry _____ my favourite. (is/are)
5. Mathematics _____ my favourite subject. (is/are)
6. The scissors _____ on the table. (is/are)
7. Neither Raju nor Sonu _____ come. (has/have)
8. There _____ five apples in the basket. (is/are)

▸ A9-II Subject–Verb Agreement (Classes 7–8)

Choose the correct verb and give a reason where asked.

1. One of my friends _____ coming today. (is/are)
2. Either the teacher or the students _____ to blame. (is/are)
3. The committee _____ its report. (has submitted/have submitted)
4. The number of students _____ increasing. (is/are)
5. A number of students _____ absent today. (was/were)
6. Ten kilometres _____ a long distance. (is/are)
7. The poor _____ in need of help. (is/are)
8. Not only the boys but also the girl _____ late. (was/were)

Topic 10: Modals

▸ A10-I Modals (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with can, could, may, must, should, will or shall.

1. _____ I come in, sir? (formal permission)
2. A fish _____ swim. (ability)
3. You _____ obey your parents. (duty)
4. It is raining. You _____ take an umbrella. (advice)
5. He _____ run fast when he was young. (past ability)
6. _____ you please open the window? (very polite request)
7. I _____ not lift this box; it is too heavy. (inability)
8. The train _____ arrive at noon tomorrow. (future)

▸ A10-II Modals (Classes 7–8)

Fill in the blank with the correct modal or modal-like expression (could, might, ought to, used to, have to, need not, had better, would).

1. She _____ be at home; her car is outside. (strong certainty) (must/can)

2. He _____ live in Ajmer, but now he lives in Jaipur. (past habit)
3. You _____ to respect your elders. (moral obligation)
4. Students _____ wear uniform on weekdays. (rule)
5. You _____ come tomorrow; it is a holiday. (no necessity)
6. He _____ have missed the bus; that is why he is late. (weak guess) (might/need)
7. When I was a child, I _____ play in the rain. (past habit) (would/will)
8. You _____ see a doctor at once. (strong advice)

Topic 11: Non-finites

▸ A11-I Non-finites: Infinitives, Gerunds, Participles (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1. I want _____ a doctor. (be)
2. She enjoys _____ stories. (read)
3. _____ is good for health. (Walk)
4. He went to the market _____ vegetables. (buy)
5. The _____ boy cried loudly. (hurt)
6. The _____ baby smiled at me. (sleep)
7. My hobby is _____ stamps. (collect)
8. It is time _____ to bed. (go)

▸ A11-II Non-finites: Infinitives, Gerunds, Participles (Classes 7–8)

Identify the underlined verb form (write infinitive, gerund, present participle or past participle).

1. SWIMMING is a good exercise.
2. The SHINING stars were beautiful.
3. I have a lot of work TO DO.
4. He is fond of PLAYING chess.
5. She decided TO LEAVE early.
6. SEEING the lion, the deer ran away.
7. Fill in: He avoided _____ the truth. (tell)
8. Fill in: She promised _____ on time. (come)

Topic 12: Prepositions

▸ A12-I Prepositions (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with a suitable preposition (in, on, at, by, with, for, from, to, of, into, under, between).

1. The book is _____ the table.
2. She was born _____ 2012.
3. We have school _____ 8 o'clock.
4. He cut the apple _____ a knife.
5. The cat jumped _____ the box.
6. I have been waiting _____ two hours.
7. He has lived here _____ 2020.
8. This letter is _____ my uncle.

▸ A12-II Prepositions (Classes 7–8)

Fill in the blank with the correct preposition.

1. He is good _____ mathematics.

2. She is afraid _____ spiders.
3. He was angry _____ me.
4. The match was cancelled _____ rain.
5. We divided the sweets _____ the three children.
6. Sit _____ Ravi and Mohan.
7. She is married _____ a doctor.
8. He was accused _____ theft.

Topic 13: Conjunctions and Connectors

▸ A13-I Conjunctions and Connectors (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with a suitable conjunction (for example: and, but, or, because, although, if, when, so, unless).

1. I was tired _____ I went to bed early.
2. She was late _____ the bus broke down.
3. Do you want tea _____ coffee?
4. He is poor _____ honest.
5. _____ it rains, we shall stay at home.
6. He is not only clever _____ also hardworking.
7. Wait here _____ I come back.
8. _____ she was ill, she came to school.

▸ A13-II Conjunctions and Connectors (Classes 7–8)

Join the sentences using the connector given in brackets.

1. He is rich. He is not happy. (although)
2. Work hard. You will not pass. (unless)
3. She was tired. She kept working. (yet)
4. He did not study. He failed. (therefore)
5. Choose: He wants to win, _____ he practises daily. (so/but)
6. Choose: _____ the roads were blocked, we could not reach. (Because/But)
7. Choose: Not only the teacher _____ also the students were tired. (and/but)
8. Choose: _____ he is clever, he does not work. (Though/Therefore)

Topic 14: Relatives

▸ A14-I Relatives (who, whom, whose, which, that, where) (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with who, whom, whose, which or where.

1. The girl _____ won the prize is my cousin.
2. This is the house _____ I was born.
3. The dog _____ barked all night belongs to Ravi.
4. Do you know the boy _____ bag was stolen?
5. The man _____ I met yesterday is a doctor.
6. This is the book _____ I like most.
7. That is the school _____ my father studied.
8. The tree _____ flowers are red is a gulmohar.

▸ A14-II Relatives (who, whom, whose, which, that, where) (Classes 7–8)

Join the sentences using a relative pronoun/adverb.

1. I met a man. He was a pilot.

2. This is the pen. I lost it yesterday.
3. That is the boy. His kite is red.
4. The lady is my aunt. You saw her.
5. Choose: Everything _____ glitters is not gold. (that/which)
6. Choose: This is the best film _____ I have seen. (that/who)
7. Choose: The river, _____ flows through our city, is polluted. (that/which)
8. Choose: I cannot find _____ I kept my keys. (where/which)

Topic 15: Conditionals

▸ A15-I Conditionals (Classes 5–6)

Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1. If it rains, we _____ at home. (stay)
2. If you heat ice, it _____. (melt)
3. If I were a bird, I _____ fly. (can/could)
4. If you study hard, you _____ pass. (will/would)
5. If I had wings, I _____ fly to you. (will/would)
6. If she _____ here, she would help. (be)
7. Unless you hurry, you _____ the bus. (miss)
8. If it _____ tomorrow, we will not go. (rain)

▸ A15-II Conditionals (Classes 7–8)

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verb.

1. If I _____ (know) his number, I would call him.
2. If she had worked hard, she _____ (pass).
3. If you _____ (see) him, tell him to call me.
4. If I _____ (be) you, I would apologise.
5. Water _____ (freeze) if the temperature falls below 0°C.
6. Rewrite with 'unless': If you do not work, you will fail.
7. Rewrite with 'if': Unless he apologises, I will not forgive him.
8. Choose: If I (had / have) money, I would buy a car.

Topic 16: Active and Passive Voice

▸ A16-I Active and Passive Voice (Classes 5–6)

Change into the passive voice.

1. Ravi writes a letter.
2. The cat drank the milk.
3. Children love ice cream.
4. She sings a song.
5. Mother cooked the food.
6. They are playing cricket.
7. I shall finish the work.
8. The teacher has praised Anu.

▸ A16-II Active and Passive Voice (Classes 7–8)

Change into the active voice.

1. The ball was thrown by Sachin.

2. The letter has been posted by Rani.
3. A cake is being baked by my aunt.
4. The thief was caught by the police.
5. English is spoken all over the world.
6. Change to passive: Who wrote this poem?
7. Change to passive: Open the door.
8. Change to passive: Do not tell lies.

Topic 17: Reported Speech

▸ A17-I Reported (Indirect) Speech (Classes 5–6)

Change into reported speech.

1. He said, "I am happy."
2. She said, "I like mangoes."
3. Ravi said to me, "I will help you."
4. The teacher said, "The earth moves round the sun."
5. Mother said to me, "Where are you going?"
6. He said to her, "Do you know me?"
7. The teacher said to us, "Be quiet."
8. Sita said, "I can swim."

▸ A17-II Reported (Indirect) Speech (Classes 7–8)

Change into reported speech (note the change of pronouns, tenses and words showing time/place).

1. He said to me, "I met your brother yesterday."
2. She said, "I will go there tomorrow."
3. The boy said, "I am writing a letter now."
4. Mother said to him, "Don't go out in the sun."
5. The officer said to the boy, "What is your name?"
6. Rita said, "Hurrah! We have won."
7. He said, "Alas! I am ruined."
8. Change to direct: She told him that she had seen the film.

Topic 18: Sentences, Clauses and Transformation

▸ A18-I Sentences, Clauses and Transformation (Classes 5–6)

Say whether the sentence is declarative, interrogative, imperative or exclamatory.

1. Close the door.
2. What a lovely day it is!
3. Do you like apples?
4. The sun rises in the east.
5. Please give me a glass of water.
6. Where do you live?
7. She plays the piano well.
8. Will you help me?

▸ A18-II Sentences, Clauses and Transformation (Classes 7–8)

Transform as directed (meaning must not change).

1. He is too weak to walk. (Use 'so ... that')

2. As soon as he came, I left. (Use 'no sooner')
3. Only a fool would say so. (Rewrite using 'none but')
4. Change to a simple sentence: He worked hard because he wanted to succeed.
5. Change to a complex sentence: He is rich but unhappy.
6. Change to an exclamatory sentence: It is a very sweet fruit.
7. Change to interrogative: She does not know him.
8. Identify the clause: 'I know that he is honest.' (noun/adjective/adverb clause)

Topic 19: Vocabulary and Word Usage

▸ A19-I Vocabulary and Word Usage (Classes 5–6)

Write a synonym or antonym as directed.

1. Synonym of 'big'
2. Antonym of 'hot'
3. Antonym of 'early'
4. Antonym of 'strong'
5. Synonym of 'begin'
6. Choose the correct word: The (sun / son) is shining.
7. Choose the correct word: I can (here / hear) the bell.
8. Choose the correct word: We (ate / eight) mangoes.

▸ A19-II Vocabulary and Word Usage (Classes 7–8)

Answer as directed.

1. One word for 'a person who writes books'.
2. One word for 'a person who cannot see'.
3. One word for 'a place where books are kept'.
4. Add a prefix to make an antonym: 'happy'.
5. Add a suffix to form a noun: 'kind' + ____.
6. Idiom: 'to break the ice' means _____. (to start a friendly talk / to freeze water)
7. Idiom: 'a piece of cake' means _____. (something very easy / a slice of sweet)
8. Choose: Please (accept / except) this gift.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Read the instruction of each set before starting; the bracketed hints tell you the form wanted.
- Do Set I first, then Set II; if Set II feels hard, revise the chapter.
- Check answers only after finishing a set, then re-do every wrong item.
- Aim for at least 7 out of 8 in each set before moving on.

CHAPTER 21 · EXERCISE BANK · PART B

Exam-pattern Question Types (Classes 5–8)

These sets follow the question types used in school grammar papers: gap filling, editing, omission, sentence reordering, dialogue completion, reported speech, headlines, procedure reporting, transformation and more. Read the tip before each type and write answers in full.

How to Attack Each Question Type

Type	Tip
Gap filling	Read the whole passage first; find the tense; check subject–verb agreement; then pick.
Editing	Check every line for tense, agreement, article, preposition, number and the form of the word; the error is a single word.
Omission	Read each line aloud in your head; the missing word is usually a preposition, article, auxiliary or conjunction.
Reordering	Find the subject, then the verb, then the object; Wh-words and auxiliaries start questions.
Dialogue completion	Match the tense and the question type of the previous line.
Reported speech	Change reporting verb, conjunction, pronouns, tense and time words; end with a full stop.
Headlines	Decide whether the event is past, present perfect or future from the headline form.
Procedure	Use the passive; the hint in the first sentence tells the tense.

B1 Gap Filling (Cloze with Options)

▸ B1.1 Gap Filling — A Day at the Zoo (Classes 5–6)

Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option.

Last Sunday, our class (a) _____ a trip to the city zoo. We (b) _____ there by bus. The zoo is (c) _____ than I had imagined. First we saw the elephants, (d) _____ were drinking water from a pond. Then we watched monkeys (e) _____ from tree to tree. Our teacher told us not to feed the animals (f) _____ they may fall ill. We returned home in the evening, tired (g) _____ happy. It was (h) _____ best day of the term.

No.	Options
(a)	(1) go (2) went (3) goes (4) gone
(b)	(1) reach (2) reached (3) had reach (4) reaching
(c)	(1) big (2) biggest (3) bigger (4) more big
(d)	(1) who (2) which (3) whom (4) whose
(e)	(1) jump (2) jumped (3) jumping (4) to jumping
(f)	(1) because (2) although (3) unless (4) but
(g)	(1) or (2) nor (3) but (4) if
(h)	(1) a (2) an (3) the (4) X (no article)

▸ B1.2 Gap Filling — Marie Curie (Class 8)

Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option.

Marie Curie (a) _____ born in Warsaw in 1867. She (b) _____ physics and chemistry in Paris. Marie and her husband Pierre (c) _____ two new elements, polonium and radium. In 1903 she (d) _____ the Nobel Prize in Physics, and she (e) _____ the prize in Chemistry in 1911. By the time she died in 1934, she (f) _____ the world's attention for her science. Her research (g) _____ the foundation of modern cancer treatment. She remains an inspiration (h) _____ girls everywhere.

No.	Options
(a)	(1) is (2) was (3) were (4) has been
(b)	(1) study (2) studied (3) has studied (4) had studying
(c)	(1) discover (2) discovered (3) discovering (4) discovers
(d)	(1) won (2) win (3) has won (4) wins
(e)	(1) received (2) receives (3) is receiving (4) has received
(f)	(1) attracts (2) has attracted (3) had attracted (4) would attract
(g)	(1) laid (2) lay (3) lain (4) laying
(h)	(1) in (2) at (3) to (4) by

▸ B1.3 Gap Filling — Mobile Phones (Class 7)

Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option.

Mobile phones have made life easier, but they (a) _____ be used carefully. Students (b) _____ not use them in class. Many children are addicted (c) _____ games. Doctors say that too much screen time (d) _____ the eyes. A child who sleeps late (e) _____ tired in the morning. Parents (f) _____ set limits on usage. If we (g) _____ the phone wisely, it will be a good servant. (h) _____ we use it carelessly, it becomes a bad master.

No.	Options
(a)	(1) should (2) ought (3) would to (4) can to
(b)	(1) must (2) would (3) are (4) does
(c)	(1) on (2) to (3) at (4) for
(d)	(1) damage (2) damages (3) damaged (4) damaging
(e)	(1) feel (2) feels (3) felt (4) feeling
(f)	(1) ought to (2) could to (3) ought (4) should to
(g)	(1) use (2) uses (3) will use (4) used
(h)	(1) Because (2) If (3) Unless (4) But

▸ B1.4 Gap Filling — Climate Change (Class 8)

Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option.

Climate change is one of (a) _____ biggest challenges of our time. Burning fossil fuels (b) _____ harmful gases into the air. (c) _____ the rising temperature, glaciers are melting fast. Scientists warn that sea levels (d) _____ rise further if nothing is done. Planting trees, saving electricity and (e) _____ public transport can help. Everyone (f) _____ do their bit. The world (g) _____ already lost many forests (h) _____ cannot be replaced quickly.

No.	Options
(a)	(1) a (2) an (3) the (4) X (no article)

No.	Options
(b)	(1) release (2) releases (3) releasing (4) released
(c)	(1) Due to (2) Because (3) Although (4) Despite
(d)	(1) would (2) will (3) shall (4) are
(e)	(1) use (2) used (3) using (4) to use
(f)	(1) should (2) are (3) does (4) doing
(g)	(1) have (2) has (3) had (4) is
(h)	(1) which (2) who (3) whom (4) whose

B2 Editing

▸ B2.1 Editing — My Grandfather (Classes 5–6)

Each line of the passage has ONE error. Write the incorrect word and its correction.

No.	Line of passage
(a)	My grandfather live in a small village.
(b)	He walks to the river and have a bath.
(c)	Then he feed the cows and buffaloes.
(d)	After that he read the newspaper.
(e)	His wife makes breakfast for him with loving.
(f)	Both of them is very kind to everyone.
(g)	I enjoy visit them during the summer holidays.
(h)	It is the happier time of my year.

▸ B2.2 Editing — Plastic Pollution (Classes 7–8)

Each line of the passage has ONE error. Write the incorrect word and its correction.

No.	Line of passage
(a)	Plastic is one of the most harmful material today.
(b)	It take hundreds of years to decay.
(c)	Many animals dies after eating plastic bags.
(d)	Rivers is choked with waste.
(e)	We should use cloth bags instead of plastic one.
(f)	Shopkeepers must stopped giving free bags.
(g)	Recycling help us save energy.
(h)	If everyone try, our cities will become cleaner.

▸ B2.3 Editing — Annual Day (Class 8)

Each line of the passage has ONE error. Write the incorrect word and its correction.

No.	Line of passage
(a)	The school annual day was celebrate last Friday.
(b)	The chief guest arrived at ten sharp and was welcomed from the principal.
(c)	The students performed a play who was written by their teacher.
(d)	The audience clapped loud at the end.
(e)	Prizes were give to the winners.
(f)	Neither the principal or the teachers left early.
(g)	He said that the programme is the best he had seen.
(h)	The next day, everybody were talking about the event.

▸ B2.4 Editing — Simple Sentences (Class 5)

Each line of the passage has ONE error. Write the incorrect word and its correction.

No.	Line of passage
(a)	There is three mangoes on the table.
(b)	She have a red umbrella.
(c)	We goes to the park every Sunday.
(d)	The sun are hot in May.
(e)	My brother and me play cricket.
(f)	Birds can flies high in the sky.
(g)	He is tallest than his sister.
(h)	They did not went to school.

B3 Omission

▸ B3.1 Omission — Ramu's Story (Classes 5–6)

In each line below ONE word has been omitted. Write the missing word. (Mark the place with a slash / in your copy.)

No.	Line of passage
(a)	Ramu was a poor boy who lived a small hut.
(b)	He very little money to buy books.
(c)	But he was determined study hard.
(d)	His teacher gave him books and he read them night.
(e)	Soon he became the best student the class.
(f)	People praised him his hard work.
(g)	Years later he a famous doctor.
(h)	He never forgot those helped him.

▸ B3.2 Omission — A New Hospital (Class 8)

In each line below ONE word has been omitted. Write the missing word. (Mark the place with a slash / in your copy.)

No.	Line of passage
(a)	The Mayor inaugurated a new hospital the city yesterday.
(b)	It been built at a cost of ten crore rupees.
(c)	The hospital will provide free treatment poor patients.
(d)	More than hundred doctors will work there.
(e)	Many people gathered watch the ceremony.
(f)	The Mayor said that health the right of every citizen.
(g)	He also promised that more such centres would opened soon.
(h)	Residents thanked him the gift.

▸ B3.3 Omission — Anu's Parrot (Class 5)

In each line below ONE word has been omitted. Write the missing word. (Mark the place with a slash / in your copy.)

No.	Line of passage
(a)	Anu has a pet. It a parrot.
(b)	The parrot green in colour.
(c)	It is fond chillies.
(d)	Anu gives it water twice day.
(e)	Sometimes the parrot sits her shoulder.
(f)	Her friends come see it.
(g)	They all play with it in garden.
(h)	Anu takes good care it.

▸ B3.4 Omission — Cricket (Class 7)

In each line below ONE word has been omitted. Write the missing word. (Mark the place with a slash / in your copy.)

No.	Line of passage
(a)	Cricket is the most popular game India.
(b)	Children play it streets, parks and fields.
(c)	Sachin Tendulkar is called the 'God of Cricket' millions of fans.
(d)	He scored hundred centuries in international cricket.
(e)	Cricket teaches us teamwork discipline.
(f)	It is the team's victory, not the victory one player.
(g)	Players practise regularly improve fast.
(h)	Cricket a game of patience, skill and luck.

B4 Sentence Reordering

▸ B4.1 Sentence Reordering — Set 1 (Classes 5–6)

Rearrange the words/phrases to form a meaningful sentence.

No.	Words and phrases
(a)	to school / every day / walks / Meena
(b)	is / my favourite / mathematics / subject
(c)	in the sky / are flying / the birds / high
(d)	were playing / when it started / the children / to rain

▸ B4.2 Sentence Reordering — Honey Bees (Class 7)

Rearrange the words/phrases to form a meaningful sentence.

No.	Words and phrases
(a)	live / in colonies / honey bees / thousands of
(b)	collects / nectar / from flowers / every worker bee
(c)	is stored / in the hive / the nectar / as honey
(d)	lays / all the eggs / the queen / in the colony

▸ B4.3 Sentence Reordering — Food Waste (Class 8)

Rearrange the words/phrases to form a meaningful sentence.

No.	Words and phrases
(a)	large amounts of food / every year / are wasted
(b)	this food / could feed / millions of hungry people
(c)	should not / we / take more food / than we can eat
(d)	the leftovers / can be given / to the needy / at the end of the party

▸ B4.4 Sentence Reordering — Questions (Classes 6–8)

Rearrange the words/phrases to form a meaningful sentence.

No.	Words and phrases
(a)	you / do / what / want to be
(b)	have / you / finished / your homework / yet
(c)	was / the film / how
(d)	is / where / the nearest / post office

B5 Dialogue Completion

▸ B5.1 Dialogue Completion — At a Shop (Classes 6–8)

Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option.

Customer: Good morning. (a) _____
Shopkeeper: Yes, madam. We have all sizes.
Customer: (b) _____
Shopkeeper: It costs five hundred rupees.
Customer: That is too costly. (c) _____
Shopkeeper: I can give you a ten per cent discount.
Customer: (d) _____, I will take it.

No.	Options
(a)	(1) Do you have school bags? (2) You have school bags? (3) Are you having school bag? (4) Have you school bag be?
(b)	(1) How much it costs? (2) How much does it cost? (3) How it costs much? (4) What much it costs?
(c)	(1) Can you reduce the price a little? (2) Can you reducing the price? (3) Could you reduced price? (4) You reduce the price?
(d)	(1) In that case (2) In that cases (3) On that case (4) At that case

▸ B5.2 Dialogue Completion — At the Doctor's (Classes 7–8)

Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option.

Doctor: What is the problem?
Patient: (a) _____ since morning.
Doctor: (b) _____ any medicine?
Patient: No, I haven't.
Doctor: You (c) _____ more water and rest well.
Patient: (d) _____ come again, doctor?
Doctor: Yes, come after three days.

No.	Options
(a)	(1) I am having a headache (2) I have had a headache (3) I had a headache (4) I will have a headache
(b)	(1) Do you take (2) Have you taken (3) Are you taken (4) Did you took
(c)	(1) should drink (2) should drinks (3) should drank (4) should to drink
(d)	(1) Shall I (2) Do I shall (3) Am I shall (4) Will I shall

▸ B5.3 Dialogue Completion — A Phone Call (Class 8)

Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option.

Ravi: Hello! May I speak to Mr Sharma?
Voice: (a) _____
Ravi: This is Ravi from Mastermind Classes. (b) _____
Voice: Mr Sharma (c) _____ at the moment. Can I take a message?
Ravi: (d) _____ Please tell him that the test has been postponed.

No.	Options
(a)	(1) Who is speaking, please? (2) Who are you speaking? (3) Whom are you? (4) Who you are speaking?
(b)	(1) I am calling to inform about the test. (2) I am calling to inform you about the test. (3) I call for inform you about test. (4) I called to inform you the test about.
(c)	(1) is not available (2) not available (3) does not available (4) has not available
(d)	(1) Yes, please. (2) Yes, I please. (3) Yes, pleased. (4) Please, yes I.

B6 Reported Speech: Dialogue to Paragraph

▸ B6.1 Reported Speech Paragraph — Going to the Market (Classes 5–6)

Read the conversation. Then complete the report by filling in each blank.

Rama: I am going to the market.
Sita: Why are you going there?
Rama: I need to buy vegetables.
Sita: Can I come with you?

Report: Rama told Sita (a) _____. She asked him (b) _____. He replied that (c) _____. Sita asked (d) _____.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)

▸ B6.2 Reported Speech Paragraph — After Dinner (Class 7)

Read the conversation. Then complete the report by filling in each blank.

Mother: Have you finished your homework?
Son: Not yet. I'll finish it after dinner.
Mother: Don't watch TV until you finish.
Son: I won't, Mother.

Report: Mother asked her son (a) _____. He answered that he had not finished it yet and that (b) _____. Mother told him (c) _____ until he finished. The son replied that (d) _____.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)

▸ B6.3 Reported Speech Paragraph — The Shirt (Class 8)

Read the conversation. Then complete the report by filling in each blank.

Customer: How much does this shirt cost?
Shopkeeper: It costs four hundred rupees.
Customer: That is too expensive. Will you give a discount?
Shopkeeper: I can give you ten per cent off.

Report: The customer asked the shopkeeper (a) _____. The shopkeeper replied that (b) _____. The customer said that (c) _____ and asked (d) _____. The shopkeeper said that he could give ten per cent off.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)

▸ B6.4 Reported Speech Paragraph — The Coach (Class 8)

Read the conversation. Then complete the report by filling in each blank.

Coach: Run faster.
Player: I am very tired, sir.
Coach: Don't give up. You are almost there.

Report: The coach (a) _____. The player said that (b) _____. The coach (c) _____ and said that (d) _____.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)

B7 Newspaper Headlines

▸ B7.1 Newspaper Headlines — Set 1 (Classes 6–7)

Use the information in the headline to complete the news item with the correct form of the verb.

No.	Headline and news item
(a)	**PM TO INAUGURATE NEW AIRPORT TOMORROW** — The Prime Minister _____ a new airport tomorrow.
(b)	**FLOODS DESTROY CROPS IN BIHAR** — Heavy floods _____ crops over thousands of acres, officials said on Monday.
(c)	**THREE ARRESTED FOR THEFT** — Three men _____ for stealing mobile phones from a shop.
(d)	**SCHOOLS TO REMAIN CLOSED TILL MONDAY** — All schools in the city _____ closed till Monday due to heavy rain.

▸ B7.2 Newspaper Headlines — Set 3 (Class 8)

Use the information in the headline to complete the news item with the correct form of the verb.

No.	Headline and news item
(a)	**FIRE DESTROYS GODOWN** — A fire _____ a godown in the old market last night.
(b)	**TRAFFIC HIT BY RAIN** — Traffic _____ badly by heavy rain on Tuesday.
(c)	**GOVT TO PROVIDE FREE BOOKS** — The government _____ free books to all students next year.
(d)	**FARMERS DEMAND HIGHER PRICES** — Farmers _____ higher prices for their crops.

▸ B7.3 Newspaper Headlines — Set 4 (Classes 5–6)

Use the information in the headline to complete the news item with the correct form of the verb.

No.	Headline and news item
(a)	**BOY SAVES DOG FROM WELL** — A brave boy _____ a dog from a well.
(b)	**SCHOOL ANNUAL DAY ON 5 MARCH** — The school's annual day _____ on 5 March.
(c)	**CHILDREN PLANT 100 TREES** — Children of Class 6 _____ 100 trees on Sunday.
(d)	**CAT RESCUED FROM TREE** — A cat _____ from a tall tree by firemen.

B8 Procedure Reporting (Passive)

▸ B8.1 Procedure — Making Tea (Classes 5–6)

Read the instructions and complete the passage using the passive voice.

Instructions:
1. Boil water in a pan.
2. Add tea leaves.

3. Add milk and sugar.
4. Strain and serve hot.

Report: First, water (a) _____ in a pan. Then tea leaves (b) _____. Milk and sugar (c) _____ next. Finally, the tea (d) _____ and served hot.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)

▸ B8.2 Procedure — An Experiment (Class 7; past tense)

Read the instructions and complete the passage using the passive voice.

Instructions:
1. Rohan took a glass of water.
2. He added salt.
3. He stirred the water.
4. He noted the change.

Report: A glass of water (a) _____ by Rohan. Salt (b) _____ to it. The water (c) _____. The change (d) _____.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)

▸ B8.3 Procedure — Making Lemonade (Class 8)

Read the instructions and complete the passage using the passive voice.

Instructions:
1. Squeeze a lemon into a glass.
2. Add sugar.
3. Pour cold water.
4. Stir well.
5. Serve with ice.

Report: The lemon juice (a) _____ into a glass. Sugar (b) _____. Cold water (c) _____. The drink (d) _____ well and (e) _____ with ice.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)
(e)	Blank (e)

B9 Sentence Transformation

▸ B9.1 Sentence Transformation — Kinds of Sentences (Classes 5–6)

Rewrite as directed.

1. She is a good singer. (Make interrogative)
2. They play cricket on Sundays. (Make interrogative)
3. He did his work. (Make negative)
4. She has seen the Taj Mahal. (Make interrogative)
5. It is a very hot day. (Make exclamatory)
6. The soup is very tasty. (Make exclamatory with 'How')
7. You must open the box. (Make negative)
8. Open the window. (Make negative imperative)

▸ B9.2 Sentence Transformation — Degrees of Comparison (Classes 6–7)

Change the degree of comparison without changing the meaning.

1. Mount Everest is the highest peak. (Comparative)
2. No other student is as clever as Anita. (Superlative)
3. Few cities are as clean as Indore. (Superlative)
4. Gold is more costly than silver. (Positive)
5. Iron is the most useful of all metals. (Comparative)
6. This question is easier than that one. (Positive)
7. My bag is heavier than yours. (Positive)
8. Neha is the best singer in the school. (Comparative)

▸ B9.3 Sentence Transformation — too … to / so … that (Class 7)

Rewrite as directed.

1. He is too tired to walk. (Use 'so … that')
2. The tea was too hot to drink. (Use 'so … that')
3. She is so weak that she cannot lift the bag. (Use 'too … to')
4. The boy is intelligent enough to solve this. (Use 'so … that')
5. She spoke so softly that nobody could hear. (Use 'too … to')
6. The news is too good to be true. (Use 'so … that')
7. The bag is not light enough for the child to carry. (Use 'too … to')
8. He ran so fast that no one could catch him. (Use 'too … to')

▸ B9.4 Sentence Transformation — Simple, Compound, Complex (Class 8)

Rewrite as directed.

1. He is poor but honest. (Change to a complex sentence using 'although')
2. Because he was ill, he stayed at home. (Change to a compound sentence using 'so')
3. On seeing the lion, the children ran away. (Change to a complex sentence)
4. Work hard, or you will fail. (Change to a complex sentence using 'if')
5. He worked hard to pass the exam. (Change to a complex sentence using 'so that')
6. I know his address. (Change to a complex sentence using 'where')
7. Having finished his work, he went home. (Change to a compound sentence)
8. She is clever and she is hardworking. (Change to a simple sentence using 'both … and')

B10 Sentence Completion

▸ B10.1 Sentence Completion — Choose the Best Ending (Classes 6–8)

Complete each sentence by choosing the correct option for the numbered blank in the order given.

1. If I had a million rupees, _____
2. She was late because _____
3. Although he was tired, _____
4. Unless you work hard, _____
5. No sooner had the teacher entered than _____
6. The boy who _____ is my cousin.

No.	Options
1	(1) I would build a school. (2) I will build a school. (3) I built a school. (4) I have built a school.
2	(1) the bus had broken down. (2) the bus breaking down. (3) the bus will break down. (4) of the bus down.
3	(1) he finished the work. (2) so he finished the work. (3) because he finished the work. (4) and but he finished.
4	(1) you will fail. (2) you won't fail. (3) you would not fail. (4) you not fail.
5	(1) the students stood up. (2) did the students stand up. (3) the students standing up. (4) stood the students.
6	(1) won the race (2) winning the race (3) win the race (4) has win the race

▸ B10.2 Sentence Completion — Complete Meaningfully (Classes 7–8)

Complete each sentence in your own words. (Any grammatically correct and meaningful completion earns credit; a sample answer is given.)

1. If it rains tomorrow, _____
2. She was so happy that _____
3. I will wait here until _____
4. The boy who sits next to me _____
5. He is too young to _____
6. Hardly had we left home when _____

▸ B10.3 Sentence Completion — Choose the Best Ending (Classes 5–6)

Complete each sentence by choosing the correct option for the numbered blank in the order given.

1. I like mangoes, but _____
2. We went to the park and _____
3. She asked me _____
4. The tiger is a _____ animal.
5. He sat down because _____
6. I have a friend whose _____

No.	Options
1	(1) my sister does not like them. (2) my sister doesn't likes them. (3) my sister not like them. (4) my sisters didn't likes them.
2	(1) played football. (2) playing football. (3) play football yesterday. (4) plays football.
3	(1) where I was going. (2) where was I going. (3) where am I going. (4) where I am go.
4	(1) danger (2) dangerous (3) dangerously (4) dangering
5	(1) he was tired. (2) he is tire. (3) tiring. (4) tired of.
6	(1) father is a pilot. (2) father are a pilot. (3) a father pilot. (4) pilot father is.

B11 Verb Forms in a Passage

▸ B11.1 Verb Forms in a Passage — The Picnic (Classes 5–6)

Fill in each blank with the correct form of the verb given in brackets.

Last Sunday, my family (a) _____ (go) for a picnic. My father (b) _____ (drive) the car, and my mother (c) _____ (sit) beside him. We (d) _____ (reach) the river at ten. The children (e) _____ (play) in the sand when it suddenly (f) _____ (begin) to rain. We (g) _____ (run) to the car. By the time we (h) _____ (reach) the car, our clothes (i) _____ (become) wet. It (j) _____ (be) a fun day all the same.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)
(e)	Blank (e)
(f)	Blank (f)
(g)	Blank (g)
(h)	Blank (h)
(i)	Blank (i)
(j)	Blank (j)

▸ B11.2 Verb Forms in a Passage — The Earthquake (Class 8)

Fill in each blank with the correct tense (and voice, where the verb needs it) of the verb in brackets.

When the earthquake (a) _____ (strike), most people (b) _____ (sleep). Many houses (c) _____ (collapse) within seconds. Rescue teams (d) _____ (reach) the area at noon and (e) _____ (begin) work immediately. By evening they (f) _____ (rescue) over two hundred people. Relief camps (g) _____ (set up) and food (h) _____ (distribute). The government says that it (i) _____ (rebuild) the damaged houses next year. Scientists warn that earthquakes (j) _____ (be) unpredictable.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)
(e)	Blank (e)
(f)	Blank (f)
(g)	Blank (g)
(h)	Blank (h)
(i)	Blank (i)
(j)	Blank (j)

B12 Cloze: Prepositions and Determiners

▸ B12.1 Cloze — Determiners (Class 7)

Fill in each blank with a suitable determiner (article, quantifier or other).

In the zoo, I saw (a) _____ elephant. (b) _____ elephant is the largest land animal. It has (c) _____ long trunk. (d) _____ trunk is used for drinking, eating and lifting. An elephant eats (e) _____ lot of food every day. There are very (f) _____ elephants left in some forests. (g) _____ the villagers say that elephants never forget. (h) _____ elephant in this park is looked after by the forest department.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)
(e)	Blank (e)
(f)	Blank (f)
(g)	Blank (g)
(h)	Blank (h)

▸ B12.2 Cloze — Prepositions and Connectors (Class 8)

Fill in each blank with one suitable word.

He was angry (a) _____ me (b) _____ I had lost his pen. (c) _____ I apologised, he did not speak (d) _____ me. I decided to buy another pen (e) _____ him, but the shop was closed (f) _____ Sunday. I therefore waited (g) _____ Monday morning. He thanked me (h) _____ my kindness.

No.	Blank
(a)	Blank (a)
(b)	Blank (b)
(c)	Blank (c)
(d)	Blank (d)
(e)	Blank (e)
(f)	Blank (f)
(g)	Blank (g)
(h)	Blank (h)

B13 Spot the Error

▸ B13.1 Spot the Error — Set 1 (Classes 5–6)

Each sentence has ONE error. Identify the error and write the correct form.

No.	Sentence
(a)	She don't like apples.
(b)	There is many birds on the tree.

No.	Sentence
(c)	I has a new bicycle.
(d)	He go to school by bus.
(e)	My mother cooked a delicious foods.
(f)	Ramesh is more taller than Suresh.
(g)	She sings very good.
(h)	Both the boys is absent.
(i)	We are going at the market.
(j)	I am agree with you.

▸ B13.2 Spot the Error — Set 3 (Class 8)

Each sentence has ONE error. Identify the error and write the correct form.

No.	Sentence
(a)	The news are shocking.
(b)	He insisted to go there.
(c)	I look forward to meet you.
(d)	Unless you do not work hard, you will fail.
(e)	She is one of the best teacher in the school.
(f)	The man whom I thought was honest cheated me.
(g)	My brother is elder than me.
(h)	He as well as his sons are guilty.
(i)	It is high time we start.
(j)	He asked me what was my name.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Always read the whole passage before filling any blank.
- Underline the key (tense, subject) before choosing the answer.
- In editing, correct only the word asked; do not rewrite the line.
- Check the final sentence for a full stop and capital letters.

Mixed Practice Tests

Two full-length mixed tests that combine tenses, agreement, editing and transformation, as in a school paper.

Instructions

Each test carries 20 marks (1 mark for each item). Time allowed: 40 minutes. Test 1 is meant for Classes 5–6 and Test 2 for Classes 7–8.

Test 1 (Classes 5–6) — 20 Marks

▸ C1-A Test 1, Section A — Fill in the blanks (5 marks)

Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1. My sister _____ (play) the piano every evening.
2. The children _____ (watch) a film now.
3. We _____ (visit) Jaipur last year.
4. She has _____ (write) a long letter.
5. It _____ (rain) when we left home.

▸ C1-B Test 1, Section B — Choose the correct option (5 marks)

Choose the correct option.

1. The book is _____ the table.
2. She is _____ honest girl.
3. The boys _____ playing in the park.
4. Give _____ the pen.
5. Ravi is _____ than Mohan.

No.	Options
1	(1) on (2) in (3) at (4) by
2	(1) an (2) a (3) the (4) X
3	(1) is (2) are (3) were (4) be
4	(1) him (2) he (3) his (4) himself
5	(1) taller (2) tallest (3) more tall (4) tall

▸ C1-C Test 1, Section C — Spot the error (5 marks)

Each sentence has one error. Write the correct form of the wrong word.

1. He don't like tea.
2. There is five pens on the desk.
3. She sings very sweet.
4. My mother cook food daily.
5. They did not went home.

▸ C1-D Test 1, Section D — Rewrite as directed (5 marks)

Rewrite as directed.

1. Ravi writes a letter. (Passive)
2. He said, "I am tired." (Reported speech)

3. She is a good singer. (Make interrogative)
4. Gold is costlier than silver. (Positive)
5. Join using 'who': I know a girl. She plays chess.

Test 2 (Classes 7–8) — 20 Marks

▸ C2-A Test 2, Section A — Tenses (5 marks)

Fill in the blank with the correct tense form of the verb in brackets.

1. By the time we arrived, the match _____ (begin).
2. She _____ (live) in Kota since 2015.
3. This time tomorrow, I _____ (travel) to Delhi.
4. If he _____ (work) hard, he will succeed.
5. He _____ (not/see) the film yet.

▸ C2-B Test 2, Section B — Choose the correct option (5 marks)

Choose the correct option for the numbered blank.

1. Neither of the boys _____ present.
2. The girl _____ bag was lost cried.
3. I look forward to _____ you.
4. My grandfather _____ walk every morning (past habit).
5. He has been ill _____ Monday.

No.	Options
1	(1) is (2) are (3) were (4) have
2	(1) whom (2) who (3) whose (4) which
3	(1) to meet (2) meeting (3) meet (4) met
4	(1) have to (2) used to (3) ought (4) need
5	(1) for (2) since (3) from (4) by

▸ C2-C Test 2, Section C — Editing (5 marks)

Each line has one error. Write the incorrect word and the correction.

1. The news are very surprising.
2. He is more taller than his brother.
3. She suggested me to rest.
4. Unless you do not hurry, you will be late.
5. He asked me where was the station.

▸ C2-D Test 2, Section D — Transformation (5 marks)

Rewrite as directed.

1. The thief was caught by the police. (Active)
2. She said, "I will help you." (Reported speech)
3. He is too weak to walk. (so … that)
4. Because it rained, we stayed in. (Compound, using 'so')
5. The man is my uncle. You met him. (Join with a relative pronoun)

Marking Scheme

Marks	Remark
18–20	Excellent
15–17	Very good
12–14	Good — revise weak topics
Below 12	Revise chapters and re-attempt Part A

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Attempt under timed conditions without notes.
- Compare with the key in Chapter 23 and note your weak topics.

CHAPTER 23 · ANSWER KEY

Complete Answer Key

Complete answers for every set in Chapters 20–22.

How to Use This Key

Answers are numbered to match the exercise sets. Where several answers are acceptable, they are shown separated by a slash or marked 'also'. Italic text gives a short reason for the trickier items.

Part A — Topic-wise Practice

▸ Topic 1: Parts of Speech

▸ A1-I Parts of Speech (Classes 5–6)

1. noun
2. pronoun
3. adjective
4. adverb
5. preposition
6. conjunction
7. interjection
8. verb

▸ A1-II Parts of Speech (Classes 7–8)

1. verb
2. adjective
3. adverb
4. conjunction — *it joins two clauses*
5. preposition — *it has a noun object*
6. noun
7. interjection
8. pronoun — *relative pronoun, it stands for 'book'*

▸ Topic 2: Nouns

▸ A2-I Nouns (Classes 5–6)

1. boxes
2. leaves
3. princess
4. bull
5. flock
6. abstract
7. children
8. uncountable

▸ A2-II Nouns (Classes 7–8)

1. mice
2. knives

3. sisters-in-law
4. deer — *same form in singular and plural*
5. collective
6. the children's toys
7. bravery
8. wisdom

▸ Topic 3: Pronouns

▸ A3-I Pronouns (Classes 5–6)

1. He
2. me
3. their
4. mine
5. We
6. its
7. herself
8. Who

▸ A3-II Pronouns (Classes 7–8)

1. me — *'between' is a preposition, so the object form is used*
2. I — *'than I am'*
3. whom
4. his — *'each' is singular*
5. emphatic
6. neither — *'neither' is used for two*
7. Which
8. that

▸ Topic 4: Determiners

▸ A4-I Determiners (Articles, Demonstratives, Quantifiers) (Classes 5–6)

1. an — *'honest' begins with a vowel sound*
2. an; The — *first mention then second mention*
3. The
4. an
5. X — *no article before meals*
6. a — *'European' begins with a 'yu' sound*
7. the
8. The

▸ A4-II Determiners (Articles, Demonstratives, Quantifiers) (Classes 7–8)

1. little — *money is uncountable*
2. a few
3. Many
4. Each
5. Either
6. Those
7. little — *negative meaning, almost none*
8. the — *a well-known great writer compared with another*

▸ Topic 5: Adjectives and Comparison

▸ A5-I Adjectives and Degrees of Comparison (Classes 5–6)

1. highest
2. taller
3. best
4. faster
5. most beautiful
6. hottest
7. narrower
8. costlier

▸ A5-II Adjectives and Degrees of Comparison (Classes 7–8)

1. He is taller than any other boy in the class.
2. Iron is not as precious as gold.
3. Iron is more useful than most other metals.
4. to — *senior, junior, superior, inferior take 'to'*
5. less
6. farthest
7. best
8. elder — *two persons — comparative*

▸ Topic 6: Adverbs

▸ A6-I Adverbs (Classes 5–6)

1. sweetly
2. quickly
3. soundly
4. never
5. soon
6. hard
7. always
8. too

▸ A6-II Adverbs (Classes 7–8)

1. too — *too = more than needed*
2. just
3. seldom (frequency)
4. attentively (manner)
5. hardly — *'hardly' means almost not*
6. up (place)
7. extremely (degree)
8. late

▸ Topic 7: Verbs: Kinds and Forms

▸ A7-I Verbs: Kinds and Forms (Classes 5–6)

1. rises
2. wrote
3. eaten
4. singing

5. go
6. played
7. broken
8. makes

▸ A7-II Verbs: Kinds and Forms (Classes 7–8)

1. brought / brought
2. began / begun
3. lay / lain
4. laid / laid
5. drove / driven
6. swam / swum
7. kicked — *it has an object 'the ball'*
8. intransitive

▸ Topic 8: Tenses

▸ A8-I Tenses (Classes 5–6)

1. goes
2. is smiling
3. visited
4. have finished
5. does not like
6. Did; see
7. was watching
8. shall/will go

▸ A8-II Tenses (Classes 7–8)

1. had started
2. has been living — *'since' + continuing action*
3. was having
4. had died
5. shall/will be flying
6. will have completed
7. had been reading
8. leaves — *timetable use of simple present*

▸ Topic 9: Subject–Verb Agreement

▸ A9-I Subject–Verb Agreement (Classes 5–6)

1. are
2. is
3. gets
4. is — *one dish, treated as a single unit*
5. is
6. are
7. has
8. are

▸ A9-II Subject–Verb Agreement (Classes 7–8)

1. is — *'one' is the subject*

2. are — *verb agrees with the nearer subject*
3. has submitted — *a group acting as one unit*
4. is
5. were
6. is — *a distance treated as one unit*
7. are
8. was — *nearer subject 'girl'*

▸ Topic 10: Modals

▸ A10-I Modals (Classes 5–6)

1. May
2. can
3. must
4. should
5. could
6. Could
7. cannot
8. will

▸ A10-II Modals (Classes 7–8)

1. must
2. used to
3. ought
4. must/have to
5. need not
6. might
7. would
8. had better

▸ Topic 11: Non-finites

▸ A11-I Non-finites: Infinitives, Gerunds, Participles (Classes 5–6)

1. to be
2. reading
3. Walking
4. to buy
5. hurt — *past participle used as adjective*
6. sleeping
7. collecting
8. to go

▸ A11-II Non-finites: Infinitives, Gerunds, Participles (Classes 7–8)

1. gerund
2. present participle
3. infinitive
4. gerund — *after the preposition 'of'*
5. infinitive
6. present participle
7. telling — *avoid takes a gerund*

8. to come — *promise takes an infinitive*

▸ Topic 12: Prepositions

▸ A12-I Prepositions (Classes 5–6)

1. on
2. in
3. at
4. with
5. into
6. for
7. since
8. from

▸ A12-II Prepositions (Classes 7–8)

1. at
2. of
3. with
4. because of — *'because of' is a compound preposition*
5. among — *more than two*
6. between — *two persons*
7. to
8. of

▸ Topic 13: Conjunctions and Connectors

▸ A13-I Conjunctions and Connectors (Classes 5–6)

1. so
2. because
3. or
4. but
5. If
6. but
7. until
8. Although

▸ A13-II Conjunctions and Connectors (Classes 7–8)

1. Although he is rich, he is not happy.
2. Unless you work hard, you will not pass.
3. She was tired, yet she kept working.
4. He did not study; therefore, he failed.
5. so
6. Because
7. but
8. Though

▸ Topic 14: Relatives

▸ A14-I Relatives (who, whom, whose, which, that, where) (Classes 5–6)

1. who
2. where

3. which
4. whose
5. whom
6. which
7. where
8. whose

▸ A14-II Relatives (who, whom, whose, which, that, where) (Classes 7–8)

1. I met a man who was a pilot.
2. This is the pen that/which I lost yesterday.
3. That is the boy whose kite is red.
4. The lady whom/that you saw is my aunt.
5. that — *after 'everything' use 'that'*
6. that — *'that' follows a superlative*
7. which — *non-defining clause with commas*
8. where

▸ Topic 15: Conditionals

▸ A15-I Conditionals (Classes 5–6)

1. shall/will stay
2. melts
3. could
4. will
5. would
6. were
7. will miss
8. rains

▸ A15-II Conditionals (Classes 7–8)

1. knew — *type 2 — unreal present*
2. would have passed — *type 3*
3. see
4. were
5. freezes
6. Unless you work, you will fail.
7. If he does not apologise, I will not forgive him.
8. had

▸ Topic 16: Active and Passive Voice

▸ A16-I Active and Passive Voice (Classes 5–6)

1. A letter is written by Ravi.
2. The milk was drunk by the cat.
3. Ice cream is loved by children.
4. A song is sung by her.
5. The food was cooked by mother.
6. Cricket is being played by them.
7. The work will be finished by me. — *'shall' becomes 'will' in the passive*
8. Anu has been praised by the teacher.

▸ A16-II Active and Passive Voice (Classes 7–8)

1. Sachin threw the ball.
2. Rani has posted the letter.
3. My aunt is baking a cake.
4. The police caught the thief.
5. People speak English all over the world. — *agent is general, so 'people' is supplied*
6. By whom was this poem written?
7. Let the door be opened.
8. Lies should not be told.

▸ Topic 17: Reported Speech

▸ A17-I Reported (Indirect) Speech (Classes 5–6)

1. He said that he was happy.
2. She said that she liked mangoes.
3. Ravi told me that he would help me.
4. The teacher said that the earth moves round the sun. — *universal truth — no change of tense*
5. Mother asked me where I was going.
6. He asked her if/whether she knew him.
7. The teacher ordered/told us to be quiet.
8. Sita said that she could swim.

▸ A17-II Reported (Indirect) Speech (Classes 7–8)

1. He told me that he had met my brother the day before.
2. She said that she would go there the next day.
3. The boy said that he was writing a letter then.
4. Mother advised/told him not to go out in the sun.
5. The officer asked the boy what his name was.
6. Rita exclaimed with joy that they had won.
7. He exclaimed with sorrow that he was ruined.
8. She said to him, "I have seen the film."

▸ Topic 18: Sentences, Clauses and Transformation

▸ A18-I Sentences, Clauses and Transformation (Classes 5–6)

1. imperative
2. exclamatory
3. interrogative
4. declarative
5. imperative
6. interrogative
7. declarative
8. interrogative

▸ A18-II Sentences, Clauses and Transformation (Classes 7–8)

1. He is so weak that he cannot walk.
2. No sooner did he come than I left.
3. None but a fool would say so.
4. He worked hard to succeed.
5. Although he is rich, he is unhappy.

6. What a sweet fruit it is!
7. Does she not know him?/Doesn't she know him?
8. noun clause — *'that he is honest' is the object of 'know'*

▸ Topic 19: Vocabulary and Word Usage

▸ A19-I Vocabulary and Word Usage (Classes 5–6)

1. large/huge
2. cold
3. late
4. weak
5. start/commence
6. sun
7. hear
8. ate

▸ A19-II Vocabulary and Word Usage (Classes 7–8)

1. author
2. blind
3. library
4. unhappy
5. kindness
6. to start a friendly talk
7. something very easy
8. accept

Part B — Exam-pattern Question Types

▸ B1 Gap Filling (Cloze with Options)

▸ B1.1 Gap Filling — A Day at the Zoo (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
(a)	(2) went
(b)	(2) reached
(c)	(3) bigger
(d)	(2) which
(e)	(3) jumping
(f)	(1) because
(g)	(3) but
(h)	(3) the

▸ B1.2 Gap Filling — Marie Curie (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	(2) was
(b)	(2) studied

No.	Answer
(c)	(2) discovered
(d)	(1) won
(e)	(1) received
(f)	(3) had attracted
(g)	(1) laid
(h)	(3) to

▸ B1.3 Gap Filling — Mobile Phones (Class 7)

No.	Answer
(a)	(1) should
(b)	(1) must
(c)	(2) to
(d)	(2) damages
(e)	(2) feels
(f)	(1) ought to
(g)	(1) use
(h)	(2) If

▸ B1.4 Gap Filling — Climate Change (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	(3) the
(b)	(2) releases
(c)	(1) Due to
(d)	(2) will
(e)	(3) using
(f)	(1) should
(g)	(2) has
(h)	(1) which

▸ B2 Editing

▸ B2.1 Editing — My Grandfather (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
(a)	live → lives
(b)	have → has
(c)	feed → feeds
(d)	read → reads

No.	Answer
(e)	loving → love
(f)	is → are
(g)	visit → visiting
(h)	happier → happiest

▸ B2.2 Editing — Plastic Pollution (Classes 7–8)

No.	Answer
(a)	material → materials
(b)	take → takes
(c)	dies → die
(d)	is → are
(e)	one → ones
(f)	stopped → stop
(g)	help → helps
(h)	try → tries

▸ B2.3 Editing — Annual Day (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	celebrate → celebrated
(b)	from → by
(c)	who → which
(d)	loud → loudly
(e)	give → given
(f)	or → nor
(g)	is → was
(h)	were → was

▸ B2.4 Editing — Simple Sentences (Class 5)

No.	Answer
(a)	is → are
(b)	have → has
(c)	goes → go
(d)	are → is
(e)	me → I
(f)	flies → fly
(g)	tallest → taller

No.	Answer
(h)	went → go

B3 Omission

B3.1 Omission — Ramu's Story (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
(a)	in — *lived in a small hut*
(b)	had — *He had very little money*
(c)	to — *determined to study hard*
(d)	at — *read them at night*
(e)	in — *best student in the class*
(f)	for — *praised him for his hard work*
(g)	became — *he became a famous doctor*
(h)	who — *those who helped him*

B3.2 Omission — A New Hospital (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	in — *hospital in the city*
(b)	has — *It has been built*
(c)	to — *treatment to poor patients*
(d)	a — *More than a hundred doctors*
(e)	to — *gathered to watch*
(f)	is — *health is the right*
(g)	be — *would be opened*
(h)	for — *thanked him for the gift*

B3.3 Omission — Anu's Parrot (Class 5)

No.	Answer
(a)	is — *It is a parrot*
(b)	is — *The parrot is green*
(c)	of — *fond of chillies*
(d)	a — *twice a day*
(e)	on — *sits on her shoulder*
(f)	to — *Her friends come to see it.*
(g)	the — *in the garden*
(h)	of — *takes good care of it*

▸ B3.4 Omission — Cricket (Class 7)

No.	Answer
(a)	in — *popular game in India*
(b)	in — *play it in streets*
(c)	by — *called ... by millions of fans*
(d)	a — *scored a hundred centuries*
(e)	and — *teamwork and discipline*
(f)	of — *victory of one player*
(g)	who — *Players who practise regularly improve fast*
(h)	is — *Cricket is a game*

▸ B4 Sentence Reordering

▸ B4.1 Sentence Reordering — Set 1 (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
(a)	Meena walks to school every day.
(b)	Mathematics is my favourite subject.
(c)	The birds are flying high in the sky.
(d)	The children were playing when it started to rain.

▸ B4.2 Sentence Reordering — Honey Bees (Class 7)

No.	Answer
(a)	Thousands of honey bees live in colonies.
(b)	Every worker bee collects nectar from flowers.
(c)	The nectar is stored as honey in the hive.
(d)	The queen lays all the eggs in the colony.

▸ B4.3 Sentence Reordering — Food Waste (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	Large amounts of food are wasted every year.
(b)	This food could feed millions of hungry people.
(c)	We should not take more food than we can eat.
(d)	The leftovers can be given to the needy at the end of the party.

▸ B4.4 Sentence Reordering — Questions (Classes 6–8)

No.	Answer
(a)	What do you want to be?
(b)	Have you finished your homework yet?

No.	Answer
(c)	How was the film?
(d)	Where is the nearest post office?

B5 Dialogue Completion

B5.1 Dialogue Completion — At a Shop (Classes 6–8)

No.	Answer
(a)	(1) Do you have school bags?
(b)	(2) How much does it cost?
(c)	(1) Can you reduce the price a little?
(d)	(1) In that case

B5.2 Dialogue Completion — At the Doctor's (Classes 7–8)

No.	Answer
(a)	(2) I have had a headache
(b)	(2) Have you taken
(c)	(1) should drink
(d)	(1) Shall I

B5.3 Dialogue Completion — A Phone Call (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	(1) Who is speaking, please?
(b)	(2) I am calling to inform you about the test.
(c)	(1) is not available
(d)	(1) Yes, please.

B6 Reported Speech: Dialogue to Paragraph

B6.1 Reported Speech Paragraph — Going to the Market (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
(a)	that he was going to the market
(b)	why he was going there
(c)	he needed to buy vegetables
(d)	if/whether she could go with him

B6.2 Reported Speech Paragraph — After Dinner (Class 7)

No.	Answer
(a)	if/whether he had finished his homework
(b)	he would finish it after dinner

No.	Answer
(c)	not to watch TV
(d)	he would not

▸ B6.3 Reported Speech Paragraph — The Shirt (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	how much that shirt cost
(b)	it cost four hundred rupees
(c)	that was too expensive
(d)	if/whether he would give a discount

▸ B6.4 Reported Speech Paragraph — The Coach (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	told/ordered the player to run faster
(b)	he was very tired
(c)	advised him not to give up
(d)	he was almost there

▸ B7 Newspaper Headlines

▸ B7.1 Newspaper Headlines — Set 1 (Classes 6–7)

No.	Answer
(a)	will inaugurate
(b)	have destroyed (also: destroyed)
(c)	have been arrested (also: were arrested)
(d)	will remain

▸ B7.2 Newspaper Headlines — Set 3 (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	destroyed
(b)	was hit (also: was affected)
(c)	will provide
(d)	demand (also: are demanding / have demanded)

▸ B7.3 Newspaper Headlines — Set 4 (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
(a)	saved
(b)	will be held
(c)	planted

No.	Answer
(d)	was rescued

▸ B8 Procedure Reporting (Passive)

▸ B8.1 Procedure — Making Tea (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
(a)	is boiled
(b)	are added
(c)	are added
(d)	is strained

▸ B8.2 Procedure — An Experiment (Class 7; past tense)

No.	Answer
(a)	was taken
(b)	was added
(c)	was stirred
(d)	was noted

▸ B8.3 Procedure — Making Lemonade (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	is squeezed
(b)	is added
(c)	is poured
(d)	is stirred
(e)	is served

▸ B9 Sentence Transformation

▸ B9.1 Sentence Transformation — Kinds of Sentences (Classes 5–6)

1. Is she a good singer?
2. Do they play cricket on Sundays?
3. He did not do his work.
4. Has she seen the Taj Mahal?
5. What a hot day it is!
6. How tasty the soup is!
7. You must not open the box.
8. Do not open the window.

▸ B9.2 Sentence Transformation — Degrees of Comparison (Classes 6–7)

1. Mount Everest is higher than any other peak.
2. Anita is the cleverest student.
3. Indore is one of the cleanest cities.

4. Silver is not as costly as gold.
5. Iron is more useful than all other metals.
6. That question is not as easy as this one.
7. Your bag is not as heavy as mine.
8. Neha is a better singer than any other in the school.

▸ B9.3 Sentence Transformation — too … to / so … that (Class 7)

1. He is so tired that he cannot walk.
2. The tea was so hot that I/we could not drink it.
3. She is too weak to lift the bag.
4. The boy is so intelligent that he can solve this.
5. She spoke too softly to be heard.
6. The news is so good that it cannot be true.
7. The bag is too heavy for the child to carry.
8. He ran too fast to be caught.

▸ B9.4 Sentence Transformation — Simple, Compound, Complex (Class 8)

1. Although he is poor, he is honest.
2. He was ill, so he stayed at home.
3. When the children saw the lion, they ran away.
4. If you do not work hard, you will fail.
5. He worked hard so that he might/could pass the exam.
6. I know where he lives.
7. He finished his work and went home.
8. She is both clever and hardworking.

▸ B10 Sentence Completion

▸ B10.1 Sentence Completion — Choose the Best Ending (Classes 6–8)

No.	Answer
1	(1) I would build a school.
2	(1) the bus had broken down.
3	(1) he finished the work.
4	(1) you will fail.
5	(1) the students stood up.
6	(1) won the race

▸ B10.2 Sentence Completion — Complete Meaningfully (Classes 7–8)

1. we shall cancel the picnic. (sample)
2. she danced with joy. (sample)
3. you return. (sample)
4. is my best friend. (sample)
5. drive a car. (sample)
6. it started raining. (sample)

▸ B10.3 Sentence Completion — Choose the Best Ending (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
1	(1) my sister does not like them.
2	(1) played football.
3	(1) where I was going.
4	(2) dangerous
5	(1) he was tired.
6	(1) father is a pilot.

▸ B11 Verb Forms in a Passage

▸ B11.1 Verb Forms in a Passage — The Picnic (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
(a)	went
(b)	drove
(c)	sat
(d)	reached
(e)	were playing
(f)	began
(g)	ran
(h)	reached
(i)	had become
(j)	was

▸ B11.2 Verb Forms in a Passage — The Earthquake (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	struck
(b)	were sleeping
(c)	collapsed
(d)	reached
(e)	began
(f)	had rescued
(g)	were set up
(h)	was distributed
(i)	will rebuild
(j)	are

▸ B12 Cloze: Prepositions and Determiners

▸ B12.1 Cloze — Determiners (Class 7)

No.	Answer
(a)	an
(b)	The
(c)	a
(d)	The
(e)	a
(f)	few
(g)	All
(h)	Each/Every

▸ B12.2 Cloze — Prepositions and Connectors (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	with
(b)	because/as/since
(c)	Although/Though
(d)	to
(e)	for
(f)	on
(g)	until/till
(h)	for

▸ B13 Spot the Error

▸ B13.1 Spot the Error — Set 1 (Classes 5–6)

No.	Answer
(a)	don't → doesn't
(b)	is → are
(c)	has → have
(d)	go → goes
(e)	foods → food
(f)	more taller → taller
(g)	good → well
(h)	is → are
(i)	at → to
(j)	am agree → agree

▸ B13.2 Spot the Error — Set 3 (Class 8)

No.	Answer
(a)	are → is
(b)	to go → on going
(c)	meet → meeting
(d)	do not work → work
(e)	teacher → teachers
(f)	whom → who
(g)	elder → older
(h)	are → is
(i)	start → started
(j)	what was my name → what my name was

Part C — Mixed Practice Tests

▸ C1-A Test 1, Section A — Fill in the blanks (5 marks)

1. plays
2. are watching
3. visited
4. written
5. was raining

▸ C1-B Test 1, Section B — Choose the correct option (5 marks)

No.	Answer
1	(1) on
2	(1) an
3	(2) are
4	(1) him
5	(1) taller

▸ C1-C Test 1, Section C — Spot the error (5 marks)

1. don't → doesn't
2. is → are
3. sweet → sweetly
4. cook → cooks
5. went → go

▸ C1-D Test 1, Section D — Rewrite as directed (5 marks)

1. A letter is written by Ravi.
2. He said that he was tired.
3. Is she a good singer?
4. Silver is not as costly as gold.
5. I know a girl who plays chess.

▸ C2-A Test 2, Section A — Tenses (5 marks)

1. had begun
2. has lived (also: has been living)
3. shall/will be travelling
4. works
5. has not seen

▸ C2-B Test 2, Section B — Choose the correct option (5 marks)

No.	Answer
1	(1) is
2	(3) whose
3	(2) meeting
4	(2) used to
5	(2) since

▸ C2-C Test 2, Section C — Editing (5 marks)

1. are → is
2. more taller → taller
3. suggested me to rest → advised/told me to rest (or suggested that I rest)
4. do not hurry → hurry
5. where was the station → where the station was

▸ C2-D Test 2, Section D — Transformation (5 marks)

1. The police caught the thief.
2. She said that she would help me/him/her.
3. He is so weak that he cannot walk.
4. It rained, so we stayed in.
5. The man whom you met is my uncle.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Check each wrong answer against the chapter rule, not just the key.
- For sentence transformation, any grammatically correct sentence with the same meaning earns credit.